ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

IMPACT, RISK AND OPPORTUNITY MANAGEMENT

Policies

Unilever's climate policies, which include policies related to our own operations and our value chain, are disclosed in our Environmental policies section on page 232. The table below demonstrates our policy positions on addressing our material climate-related impacts and risks.

	GHG emissions[a]	Land use regulation	Product regulations and claims	Energy transition
Unilever Environmental Policy	■		■	■
Responsible Partner Policy	■	■		
People & Nature Policy	■	■		
Sustainable Agriculture Code and Sustainable Agriculture Principles	■	■		
Hedging Policy[b]	■			■

(a) Includes GHG emissions in our own operations and value chain, and impacts relating to changing climate and extreme weather events and carbon taxes.
(b) Unilever's hedging policy is provided in note 16 of the Financial Statements on page 174. This forms part of the Treasury standards ultimately owned by the CFO.

Actions

The key actions we have taken in 2024 against each decarbonisation lever identified in our CTAP are set out below.

Our operations (Scope 1 and 2)

Reductions in our Scope 1 and 2 emissions are expected to account for approximately 1% of our targeted GHG emissions reductions to 2030. An increasing number of sites are electrifying thermal energy production by using heat pumps and electric boilers, and in 2024 we installed our first industrial-scale electric boiler at our Nepal factory.

Our Scope 1 and 2 emissions reductions include the impact of the GHG emissions from our significantly expanded operations at our Unilever Oleochemicals Indonesia (UOI) refinery. To help manage this impact, UOI has invested in sourcing biomethane, which is being produced from a waste product of the palm oil production process, from two palm mills to supply its energy needs. A roadmap is in place to do this for six other mills over the next three years and we plan to significantly increase our use of this renewable fuel by 2030.

Our focus in the coming years remains on implementing large-scale electrical and thermal energy efficiency initiatives, electrifying thermal processes, and sourcing sustainable biofuels. Each of our Business Groups has developed detailed roadmaps, considering the most appropriate low-carbon technologies and energy sources for our diverse range of manufacturing technologies and site locations.

Our value chain (Scope 3)

The table set out on page 242 demonstrates the contribution of our identified Scope 3 decarbonisation levers towards our targeted GHG emissions reductions to 2030.

Supplier Climate Programme

Our Supplier Climate Programme, launched in 2021, is focused on accelerating the transition of key suppliers to a position of climate leadership. We define this as suppliers setting their own science-based GHG reduction targets, publicly reporting progress against their targets, and having the capacity and capability to provide us with a Product Carbon Footprint (PCF) for the materials we buy.

In 2024, we engaged with 291 suppliers to accelerate their climate action and capabilities. These suppliers represent approximately 42% of Unilever's Scope 3 emissions from raw materials, packaging and collaborative manufacturing. Out of the 291 suppliers we approached, 181 are actively participating in the programme to date. In total, we have received almost 700 PCF data sets from suppliers, which form the basis for identifying, planning and delivering emissions reductions. Where these PCFs have been validated by our internal teams to be calculated in line with the PACT (Partnership for Carbon Transparency) methodology, they have been used in 2024 as part of our Scope 3 GHG emissions calculation. In 2024, we also focused on upskilling on climate action within our Procurement function.

Separately, our Business Groups have led the identification of strategic suppliers with whom we can create innovative and high-impact partnerships to reduce emissions. For example, Personal Care has established workstreams with two aerosol can suppliers to further explore GHG reduction opportunities through recycled and low-carbon aluminium.

In 2025, the focus for the Supplier Climate Programme will be to scale the initiative further, drive emission reduction plans for priority portfolios through decarbonisation roadmaps with suppliers, and to embed climate into key commercial processes and documents, including supplier contracts.

Reformulating products

This is one of our biggest opportunities to reduce emissions without compromising on product performance or consumer experience. In 2024, our Business Groups deployed several reformulated products with demonstrated GHG reductions in market. These products included Sunlight's 100% plant-based RhamnoClean technology and Persil's Wonder Wash detergent in our Home Care Business Group. Our Personal Care Business Group successfully launched soap bars with reduced fatty matter content delivering a superior consumer experience across two key brands in India, with plans to roll out to other markets from 2025 onwards.

Our Business Groups have now established detailed reformulation roadmaps across their portfolios to 2030, which will form the basis of innovation plans beyond 2024 to deliver superior products while reducing GHG emissions.

Forest-risk commodities

The GHG emissions from the production of our key forest-risk commodities (i.e. palm oil, paper and board, tea, soy and cocoa) arise from land use change (e.g. deforestation), agricultural practices and downstream processing. In 2024, we set a goal to maintain a 95% deforestation-free supply chain of these commodities in 2024.

Palm oil is the most material forest-risk commodity in our supply chain. To address this, we enrolled over 20 independent palm oil mills and tier two suppliers into our sustainability programme in 2024. We are making progress on our Good Palm strategy, which enrols new suppliers into our programme, including those we partner with to remediate past deforestation. We have mapped the locations of over 32,000 smallholder farms and are active in three palm oil smallholder development hubs with SNV, Widya Erti Indonesia (WEI) and the World Resources Institute (WRI). To drive improvements in the processing of forest-risk commodities and lower GHG emissions in the future, 336 palm oil mills in our supply chain now have methane capture in place.

Regenerative agriculture

In 2024, we raised our ambitions, committing to scale up regenerative agriculture practices across 1 million hectares by 2030 and implemented 17 new regenerative agriculture projects, bringing our total to 23 active projects covering a cumulative total of over 129,000 hectares since 2021. For further information on our regenerative agriculture programmes, refer to page 255 within our Biodiversity and Ecosystems disclosure.

Chemical ingredients

Two key chemical ingredients contribute a significant proportion of our Scope 3 GHG emissions: linear alkylbenzene sulphonate (LAS) and soda ash. To meet our Scope 3 reduction targets, we must reduce the GHG intensity of both LAS and soda ash production.

In 2024, we worked closely with our suppliers of these ingredients to reduce the GHG footprint of their LAS production and contracted for additional volumes of low-GHG soda ash. The latter includes lower-GHG synthetic soda ash manufactured with carbon capture of CO_2 emissions from processing, as well as natural soda ash. We will continue to scale these programmes in the period 2025-2027.

Packaging

Emissions from packaging predominantly arise from packaging production and at end of life through incineration or landfill. In 2024, we reduced our use of virgin plastics for the packaging of our products by 23% versus a 2019 baseline. We reported 57% of our plastic packaging to be reusable, recyclable or compostable, and that we collected and processed plastic waste equivalent to 93% of our plastic packaging sold. The focus of our future packaging plans will be to further increase recyclability, increase PCR inclusion and accelerate absolute virgin plastic reduction in all formats including flexibles.

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Logistics

We use logistics and distribution networks across the world to transport our raw materials and products, resulting in GHG emissions from fossil fuel use. In 2024, we achieved a 2% reduction in CO_2e per sold tonne compared to 2023. This improvement was primarily driven by reduced kilometres travelled due to operational efficiencies in North America. We also made good progress in our Ice Cream business in Turkey where we are using solar power for our fleet, which now includes 47 electric vehicles.

Ice cream cabinets

Ice Cream has a global cabinet fleet of close to 3 million point-of-sale ice cream freezers, all of which use electricity with associated GHG emissions. Renewable Energy Certificates (RECs) that were purchased in 2023 to offset a proportion of electricity used by these cabinets in Turkey and Indonesia were not renewed for 2024. The impact of this decision is reflected in our total 2024 Scope 3 GHG emissions.

In March 2024, Unilever announced the planned separation of the Ice Cream Business Group in 2025. As a result, a revised climate strategy for the standalone business will be developed in 2025.

Aerosol propellants

Outside of the US and Canada, Unilever uses natural hydrocarbon gases for these spray formats which are not classified as GHGs. However, in part due to historic restrictions in the US and Canada regarding volatile organic compound (VOC) regulations, our spray formulas in these markets use hydrofluorocarbon propellant which is classified as a GHG.

In 2024, we made further progress towards our key milestones on innovating for alternative propellant systems to replace hydrofluorocarbon propellants, with ongoing efforts focused on technology readiness and proposition testing ahead of product launches in future years.

Climate & Nature Fund

Our Climate & Nature Fund (CNF) supports the delivery of our sustainability goals and in 2024, our total CNF commitments since the Fund's launch in 2020 increased from €0.3 billion in 2023 to €0.7 billion. We added €0.4 billion in 2024 related to our upstream value chain investments, which contribute to Unilever's future fit operations and sustainability goals, including our NDPE palm value chain investments in UOI. In addition, we invested €23 million in a partnership with Nufarm, through which we are aiming to develop a variety of sugar cane to extract lower GHG intensity plant-based oils for use in cleaning ingredients. Cumulative spend by the Fund since 2020 is €0.4 billion.

Our wider influence on society

Policy advocacy

In 2024, we made progress on many of our climate policy advocacy priorities. Key actions included:

- **Nationally Determined Contributions:** We published a report on the importance of Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) in raising national climate ambition to align with a 1.5°C pathway, including via the implementation of robust carbon pricing mechanisms. It was promoted via social media and was the subject of a Climate Week event in New York, co-hosted with the Brazilian government.
- **Renewable energy capacity and fossil fuel phase-out:** As members of RE100, WBCSD and at global events such as Climate Week New York, Unilever has actively supported the global campaign to triple renewable energy capacity. In 2024, we joined the Asia Clean Energy Coalition (ACEC) and have been active in the Indonesia Working Group, co-developing research and a government engagement plan.
- **GHG Protocol standards to incentivise emissions reduction actions in value chains:** Through our participation in relevant WBCSD working groups and the Value Change Initiative, we are working collaboratively to tackle the challenge of quantifying the GHG emissions impact of interventions in our land-based value chain, and how to count that impact towards our sustainability goals.
- **Chemical ingredients:** We are engaged in two issues teams within Cefic, the European Chemical Industry Council, focused on market pull measures to support sustainable feedstocks, and a WBCSD working group established to drive alternative chemical feedstocks. Unilever now also chairs a cross-industry working group on the topic in India.

Trade associations and industry partnerships

In March 2024, we published our first Climate Policy Engagement Review, which included an independent review of the positions and engagement activities of our main industry associations, to determine whether they are consistent with Unilever's priority policy areas. We received a 100% (14/14) score for our disclosures on climate policy engagement from InfluenceMap, a global think tank providing open-source data on corporate influence on climate change to investors and other stakeholders.

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METRICS AND TARGETS

Targets

Our near-term 2030 targets to reduce our GHG emissions have been set in accordance with a cross-sector emissions pathway and the draft GHG Protocol Land Sector and Removals guidance and align with the near-term time horizon of 2030 considered in our resilience analysis. Our targets that relate to the risks associated with land use pressure and regulation and product regulations and claims are addressed within Biodiversity and Ecosystems on page 256.

We set our climate targets for the entities and activities that fall within the boundaries of our GHG inventory, as disclosed in our total GHG emissions on page 244. As part of our critical assumptions for setting our GHG emission reduction targets, our 2030 modelled outcomes include our 2030 growth trajectories and reflect the expected technology advances, product formulation changes and portfolio shifts in the period. Our GHG emissions for 2015 (Scope 1 and 2) and 2021 (Scope 3) were considered as representative of Unilever's typical GHG emissions profile and form the baselines for our targets.

The table below sets out our baseline emissions, the scope of our baseline emissions covered for each target and the absolute 2030 GHG emissions target value.

Climate targets (million tonnes CO_2e)	Baseline year	Total baseline emissions	Emissions in scope of 2030 target %	Baseline emissions in scope of target	Total emissions target reduction factor	2030 target absolute reduction
Scope 1 and 2	**2015**	**2.1**	95.6%[(a)]	2.0	**100.0%**	2.0
Total Scope 3	**2021**	**55.3**	71.8%	39.8	**39.5%**	15.7
Total Scope 3 FLAG	2021	10.2	81.9%[(b)]	8.4	30.3%	2.5
Total Scope 3 E&I	2021	45.1	69.6%[(b)]	31.4	42.0%	13.2

(a) Exceeds minimum coverage required by SBTi of 95%.
(b) Exceeds minimum coverage required by SBTi of 67.5%.

To meet our targets, our actions must deliver the planned reduction in our baseline emissions as well as 100% reduction in additional emissions from product volume growth between the baseline year and 2030. We have plans in place to cover 100% of our Scope 1 and 2 emissions in scope of our Scope 1 and 2 target through three priority decarbonisation levers of thermal and electrical energy, renewable power and refrigeration. The actions we have identified to reduce our Scope 3 emissions only partially address the total emissions in scope of our Scope 3 target. We have identified a scaling and innovation gap to reach our target which underscores the need to continually search for new solutions and ways to scale existing ones faster than is currently possible. Of the identified plans, we expect the most material reductions to come from Scope 3 FLAG and E&I emissions related to raw materials and ingredients.

The table below demonstrates the contribution of our identified decarbonisation levers towards reducing both our Scope 3 baseline emissions and our forecasted Scope 3 GHG emissions from volume growth in the period to 2030.

Scope 3 Decarbonisation lever	% contribution of targeted reductions (baseline plus growth)
Supplier Climate Programme	14%
Reformulating products	13%
Forest-risk commodities	10%
Regenerative agriculture	4%
Chemical ingredients	6%
Packaging	3%
Logistics	2%
Ice cream cabinets	19%
Aerosol propellants	7%
Sub total	**78%**
Scaling and innovation gap[(a)]	22%
Total[(b)]	**100%**

(a) The scaling and innovation gap represents the amount of GHG emissions for which we need to develop new or scale existing solutions.
(b) Represents 15.7m CO_2eT of total reductions by 2030 vs. 2021 baseline plus additional reductions to cater for emissions from growth in the period 2021–2030.

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Scope 1 and 2 target performance

The percentage change in Scope 1 and 2 market-based GHG emissions is the difference between the current reporting period and the 2015 baseline period (1 October 2014 to 30 September 2015). Gross Scope 1, 2, 3 and total GHG emissions calculation methodology is disclosed on page 244.

Exclusions: All emissions from biogenic fuels and owned or leased vehicles controlled by Unilever are excluded from the target scope in line with the SBTi minimum scope requirement.

Scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions – Unilever operations (million tonnes CO_2e)	2030 target % reduction	2015 baseline	2024 % change vs. 2015 baseline	2023 % change vs. 2015 baseline[a][b]	2022 % change vs. 2015 baseline[a][c]
Reduce absolute operational GHG emissions (Scope 1 and 2) by 100% by 2030 from a 2015 baseline	-100%	2.01	-72%	-70%	-63%

(a) 2023 and 2022 measured for 12-month period ended 30 September.
(b) Restated from 74% in 2023 due to change in measurement methodology (see below).
(c) Restated from 68% in 2022 due to change in measurement methodology (see below).

In 2023, we improved our GHG measurement methodology, with a more complete and accurate measurement of emissions categories previously deemed immaterial. In 2024, to comply with SBTi guidelines, some of these emission categories (e.g. small offices and small warehouses), have been included in our SBTi target emissions coverage, including our 2015 baseline, resulting in a restatement of performance for prior years. The 2% improvement in our target performance is driven by good progress on our Scope 1 emissions in 2024 related to continued energy efficiency measures, electrifying thermal energy production at several sites and our first industrial-scale electric boiler at our Nepal factory.

Our Sustainability Progress Index (SPI) climate goal (Scope 1 and 2) performance, for internal remuneration purposes, was 76.5% as detailed on page 105.

Scope 3 target performance

Scope 3 Energy and Industrial GHG target – 42% absolute reduction in SBTi Scope 3 E&I GHG emissions by 2030
The percentage change in Scope 3 Energy and Industrial (E&I) GHG emissions is the difference between the current reporting period and the 2021 baseline period (1 October 2020 to 30 September 2021).

Emissions are categorised according to the GHG Protocol Corporate standard and include those from ingredients and packaging purchased by Unilever, ingredients and packaging from collaborative manufacturing in India, fuel and energy activities, upstream transport and distribution, hydrofluorocarbon (HFC) propellants in sold products, end-of-life treatment of sold products manufactured by Unilever and by collaborative manufacturers in India, and downstream leased assets.

Exclusions: E&I emissions associated with collaborative manufacturers outside India, purchased goods and services outside of ingredients and packaging, capital goods, waste generated in operations, business travel, employee commuting, downstream transport and distribution, processing of sold products, use of sold products (water purifiers only), franchises and investments.

Scope 3 Forest, Land and Agriculture GHG target – 30.3% absolute reduction in SBTi Scope 3 FLAG GHG emissions by 2030
The percentage change in Scope 3 Forest Land and Agriculture (FLAG) GHG emissions is the difference between the current reporting period and the 2021 baseline period (1 October 2020 to 30 September 2021).

FLAG emissions relate to GHG Protocol Category 1 – ingredients purchased by Unilever and collaborative manufacturers in India.

Exclusions: FLAG emissions associated with collaborative manufacturers outside of India.

Gross Scope 1, 2 and 3 and total GHG emissions calculation methodology is disclosed on page 244.

Scope 3 GHG emissions – Unilever value chain (million tonnes CO_2e)	2030 targets	2024 emissions	2021 baseline	2024 % change vs. 2021 baseline
Reduce absolute Scope 3 energy and industrial (E&I) GHG emissions from purchased goods and services (associated with ingredients, packaging), upstream transport and distribution, energy and fuel-related activities, direct emissions from use of sold products (associated with HFC propellants), end-of-life treatment of sold products, and downstream leased assets (associated with ice cream retail cabinets) by 42% by 2030, from a 2021 baseline.	-42.0%	29.0	31.4	-8%
Reduce absolute Scope 3 forest, land and agriculture (FLAG) GHG emissions from purchased goods and services (associated with ingredients) by 30.3% by 2030, from a 2021 baseline.	-30.3%	7.2	8.4	-14%

In 2024, there were significant increases in emission factors across global databases for fossil-fuel-related materials and processes (e.g. plastics, chemicals, energy), which are reflected in our 2024 GHG emissions reporting and our Scope 3 E&I and FLAG target performance. Changes to emission factors of this nature are not within our control and over time will be adjusted in our target baselines so that we can report the impact of the actions we are taking. We included 512 supplier specific product carbon footprint (PCF) data points within our Scope 3 GHG measurement for the first time in 2024, which is a significant milestone towards improving the accuracy of our GHG data.

Scope 3 E&I: The reduction in E&I emissions since 2021, primarily relates to overall product volume decline including divestments in the period and logistics operational efficiencies. As set out in our CTAP, we expect progress against our E&I target to be more challenging given the significant contribution of chemicals from our Home Care business group. We are making progress to work with our suppliers to develop and increase the supply of lower GHG alternatives for these chemicals, the impact of which will be reflected in future years as we scale these programmes.

Scope 3 FLAG: The good progress we have made in reducing our FLAG emissions since 2021 is primarily driven by significant efforts to source deforestation-free palm and improved data from our suppliers through the Supplier Climate Programme. The impact of these programmes to date is a reduction of approximately 1.2 million tonnes CO_2e and has been reflected in our GHG emissions measurement in 2024. The most material change in PCF data reflects our sourcing of soy from regions with a lower GHG impact.

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Gross Scope 1, 2 and 3, and total GHG emissions

Total GHG emissions are calculated using the GHG Protocol Corporate Standard and relate to the activities reported in our consolidated accounting group (parent and subsidiaries). We do not have material emissions related to associates, joint ventures or unconsolidated subsidiaries and contractual arrangements where we have operational control. Total GHG emissions are the sum of Scope 1 and 2 activities within our operations and Scope 3 activities, covering upstream and downstream value chain.

Total GHG emissions include all seven greenhouse gases as required by the GHG Protocol standard, combined into a single CO_2-equivalent (CO_2e) unit using Global Warming Potential (GWP) values from the IPCC 6th Assessment Report for Scope 1 and 3, and market-based factors from the IEA (2021) for Scope 2. Data collection is from both internal and external sources, based on industry-accepted standards where available.

Scope 1 and 2 emissions
Scope 1 and 2 emissions are calculated as the sum of GHG emissions from energy used, energy sold and refrigerant use, reported in tonnes for all manufacturing sites and the majority of logistics and office sites.

Energy used and energy sold: Data is collected from meter readings and invoices for each site in GJ and includes combustion of fossil fuels (Scope 1), as well as purchased, generated and sold electricity, heat and steam (Scope 2). Carbon emission factors are used to convert energy (GJ) into greenhouse gases (GHG). Scope 1 factors are provided by the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) and Scope 2 factors are based on Renewable Energy Attribute Certificates or supplier data, following the GHG Protocol's Scope 2 Market-Based method. When Energy Attribute Certificates (EACs) are applied, electricity consumption is reported as renewable with an emission factor of zero.

Refrigerant use: HFC consumption data is taken from site maintenance records for each site, including Global Warming Potential (GWP) factors for each refrigerant type, which are converted from refrigerant losses (kg) to GHG emissions. GWP factors for HFC refrigerants are provided by the IPCC.

Sulphur hexafluoride (SF_6) emissions from high voltage equipment: Amount of SF_6 leaked from electrical insulators is calculated using an estimate of amount of SF_6 across our sites and an average SF_6 equipment leakage rate based on IPCC Guidelines multiplied by the GWP factors.

For logistics and office sites not reporting in Unilever systems, Scope 1 and 2 emissions are estimated based on measured sites and site headcount or pallet position.

Exclusions: CO_2 emissions from the combustion of biomass; the capturing of CO_2 by the vegetation during growth is considered to offset emissions from combustion.

Scope 3 emissions
The two most material categories of emissions are Category 1 – Purchased goods and services, and Category 11 – Consumer Use of Sold Products, which were estimated as follows.

Category 1 – Purchased goods and services
Ingredient and packaging emissions are calculated by multiplying the volumes of ingredients and packaging purchased by Unilever and collaborative manufacturers production volumes by emission factors.

Ingredients and packaging purchased by Unilever include emissions generated from production and transportation from 'cradle to gate' (farming/mining of raw materials to delivery at Unilever). We categorise transportation emissions from suppliers to Unilever under Category 1, instead of Category 4 as recommended by the GHG Protocol, as we cannot separate these from other transportation emissions. Emissions not directly related to raw material production, such as head office and marketing, are excluded.

Emissions from packaging materials are assumed to be E&I. Ingredient emissions are further categorised into:
- FLAG: Emissions from agricultural raw materials related to land use change and land management up to 'farm gate'.
- E&I: Emissions from converting or processing agricultural raw materials into purchased materials, from farm to Unilever site.

Emission factors for ingredients and packaging purchased by Unilever are obtained from two external sources:
1. Supplier product carbon footprint data: received annually directly from suppliers participating in the Supplier Climate Programme and internally validated.
2. 'Cradle to gate' emissions factors in $kgCO_2e$ per kg of material: calculated using Life Cycle Analysis (LCA) software, Life Cycle Inventory (LCI) databases such as Ecoinvent and the World Food Life Cycle database, supplemented with other models and supplier-specific data where available. Where no emission factors are available for specific ingredients or packaging materials, an average of known emission factors is used. Where emission factors do not include transport from the supplier to Unilever, these are separately estimated and added to total emissions.

Emission factors for ingredients and packaging purchased from collaborative manufacturers are calculated from the average emissions of the relevant product category and derived from Unilever's annual product footprint assessment covering 13 countries.

FLAG and E&I emission factors for relevant materials are obtained from the eQosphere database where available (provided by Quantis). Where not available, SEAC calculates and categorises relevant emission factors as FLAG and E&I based on external LCI data and assuming that emissions up to the 'farm gate' are FLAG (i.e., all land use change, land management, and all other production activities associated with agriculture and raw material extraction), with all remaining emissions assumed to be E&I.

Annual water consumption (m^3): Data is extracted from internal systems or estimated based floor area (m^2) for logistics sites or head count for office sites and is multiplied by emission factors in $kgCO_2e$ per m^3 of water consumed obtained from the UK government's Department for Environment, Food and Rural Affairs (DEFRA).

Indirect procurement: Scope 1, 2 and 3 emissions from purchased goods and services not for resale, such as media placement and IT services. We exclude emissions relating to trade spend, rent, employee salaries, memberships, tax, interest and depreciation. Annual spend by category is mapped to spend categories in the Extended Environmental Input Output (EEIO) model and multiplied by the relevant emission factor in $kgCO_2e$ per £1,000 spend by category in the EEIO model to calculate total emissions. The EEIO tool estimates carbon emissions based on spend using country- and sector-specific carbon conversion factors that combine economic trade data and national industry-level carbon emission data.

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Category 11 – Use of sold products
HFC propellant volumes for aerosol products produced by Unilever and collaborative manufacturers are multiplied by emission factors in $kgCO_2e$ per kg of HFC propellant obtained from the IPCC AR6 report. The quantity of water purifiers sold in India for the period to 30 October (date of sale of Pureit) is multiplied by lifetime electricity consumption in kWh per unit, obtained from an LCA study, and by the grid emission factor in $kgCO_2e$ per kW of electricity for India, obtained from IEA.

Indirect consumer use emissions are calculated for a representative sample of products, based on grouping of similar products within 13 key countries. Consumer use (i.e. the consumed amount per individual portion, single use or serving of a Unilever product by one person) is determined based on: consumer habits studies, on-pack recommendations or internal expert opinion. Consumer use is applied to the primary product e.g. dishwashing tablets, hence ancillary products are considered to have no impact. This data is consolidated and extrapolated across the sales of unclustered products at a category and country level to calculate total emissions of the 13 countries. The total Unilever emissions for indirect consumer use are calculated per Business Group by extrapolating total emissions of the 13 countries based on total sales per Business Group.

Other key assumptions
For subsidiaries that do not report in Unilever systems, we calculate total emissions (tCO_2e) for purchased goods and services per Business Group divided by total Unilever turnover per Business Group (excluding these entities), multiplied by turnover for these entities.

Exclusions: Scope 3 activities are estimated for 13 emission categories. Emission category 10 (Processing of sold products) and Emission category 15 (Investments) are not reported as they are not material.

Emissions (million tonnes CO_2e)	2024[a]	2023[a]	2022[a]	% change vs. 2023
Total Scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions (market-based)	**0.69**	**0.75**	**0.87**	**-8%**
Gross Scope 1 GHG[b][c]	**0.48**	**0.57**	**0.64**	**-14%**
Gross market-based Scope 2 GHG emissions[b]	**0.21**	**0.18**	**0.23**	**16%**
Gross location-based Scope 2 GHG emissions[b]	**1.26**	**1.16**	**1.26**	**9%**
Scope 3 GHG emissions in scope of our net zero ambition[c][d]	**53.80**	**52.13**	**52.82**	**3%**
Purchased goods and services	**41.79**	**41.47**	**41.15**	**1%**
Raw materials and ingredients	**26.88**	27.53	28.03	-2%
Packaging materials	**6.37**	5.60	5.84	14%
Indirect procurement	**8.54**	8.34	7.28	2%
Upstream transportation and distribution (logistics)	**1.61**	**1.57**	**1.81**	**3%**
Downstream leased assets (ice cream cabinets)	**2.79**	**2.30**	**2.93**	**21%**
Use of sold products (HFC propellants)	**1.60**	**1.48**	**1.46**	**8%**
End of life treatment of sold products	**3.70**	**3.25**	**3.32**	**14%**
Others[e]	**2.31**	**2.06**	**2.15**	**12%**
Total Scope 1, 2 and 3 GHG emissions in scope of net zero ambition (market-based)	**54.49**	**52.88**	**53.69**	**3%**
Scope 3 GHG emissions – indirect consumer use[f]	**51.35**	**47.07**	**57.54**	**9%**
Total Scope 1, 2 and 3 GHG emissions (market-based)	**105.84**	**99.95**	**111.23**	**6%**
Total Scope 1, 2 and 3 GHG emissions (location-based)	**106.89**	**100.93**	**112.26**	**6%**

(a) 2023 and 2022 measured for 12-month period ended 30 September, and include minor corrections to site data.
(b) Scope 1 emissions regulated by trading schemes amounted to 4.2% in 2024, 3.8% in 2023 and 4.18% in 2022.
(c) Biogenic emissions of CO_2 from the combustion or bio-degradation of biomass in our own operations are not reported as part of Scope 1 and 2 or Scope 3 emissions in line with GHG protocol. In 2024, Scope 1 and 2 emissions amounted to 468,432 tonnes CO_2 (Scope 1 and 2).
(d) 2.8% of our Scope 3 emissions have been calculated from primary data obtained from suppliers or other value chain partners.
(e) Others include capital goods, fuel and energy-related activities, waste generated in operations, business travel, employee commuting, downstream transport and distribution and franchises.
(f) Relates to emissions that typically arise from the heating of water needed to use our shampoos and shower gels. Excluded from the scope of our Net Zero ambition in line with GHG Protocol and SBTi guidelines.

The 6% increase in our total Scope 1, 2 and 3 GHG emissions in 2024 from prior year is partially driven by product volume growth in the period but primarily by the impact of changing emission factors across global databases for fossil-fuel-related materials and processes in 2024. This impacted our purchased goods and services, ice cream cabinets, end-of-life treatment of sold products, and indirect consumer use emission categories the most. The increase in emissions from ice cream cabinets further reflects our decision to discontinue the purchase of RECs in 2024. Use of sold product emissions from HFC propellants increased in 2024 reflecting product volume growth of aerosols in North America. The increase in our total Scope 1, 2 and 3 GHG emissions from 2023 is net of reduced emissions in the period from our FLAG raw materials and ingredients and the roll-out of reformulated products with a lower GHG intensity.

GHG intensity per net revenue

Total GHG emissions calculated on a location-based and market-based methodology are divided by total turnover for Unilever as disclosed in the financial statements on page 138. Total turnover equates to net revenue.

GHG intensity per net revenue (tonnes CO_2e/€ million)	2024
Total GHG emissions (market-based) per net revenue	**1,742**
Total GHG emissions (location-based) per net revenue	**1,759**

The variability in geographical regions, business sectors and brands in our business limits the relevance of using a single global measure such as GHG intensity per net revenue (turnover) as required by the ESRS.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Energy consumption and mix

Energy sourced from within the organisational boundary is not counted under 'purchased or acquired' energy. We consider 100% of our energy to be related to high climate impact sectors (manufacturing, transportation and storage), as listed in Sections A to H and Section L of Annex I to Regulation (EC) No 1893/2006 of the European Parliament and of the Council, as defined in Commission Delegated Regulation (EU) 2022/1288.

For sites reporting energy consumption in Unilever systems, consumption is calculated by consolidating data from fossil, nuclear and renewable sources based on meter readings and invoices, converted to common units of energy.

Unilever purchased Energy Attribute Certificates (EACs) are matched against electricity consumption and reported as renewable, following RE100 Reporting Guidance 2021. EACs are market-based instruments that authenticate the proportion of energy generated from renewable sources procured by consumers, including Renewable Energy Certificates (RECs), International Renewable Energy Certificates (IRECs), and European Guarantees of Origin (GOs). EACs are purchased in Q1 2025 once 2024 electricity consumption is complete.

For logistic and office sites not reporting energy consumption in Unilever systems, consumption is assumed to be non-renewable and is estimated for each utility type and regional cluster based on energy consumption per pallet position (storage capacity) and per headcount using consumption data from similar sites that do report in Unilever systems. For sites where pallet positions (storage capacity) and headcount data is not available, the average energy consumption reported in Unilever systems for logistics and office sites is used as a proxy for each site.

A small number of manufacturing sites generate electricity, heat and steam, which is classified as renewable energy if it is from a renewable source. This is classified as consumption of self-generated non-fuel renewable energy. Renewable energy generated which is sold to and used by a third party is not subtracted from energy generated or offset against energy consumption.

Exclusions: Our own operations does not include sites that are under commissioning and sites where decommissioning has started. Excludes energy consumption from collaborative manufacturers.

Energy consumption and mix (thousands MWh)	2024
Fuel consumption from coal and coal products	0
Fuel consumption from crude oil and petroleum products	461
Fuel consumption from natural gas	1,445
Fuel consumption from other fossil sources	0
Consumption of purchased or acquired electricity, heat, steam and cooling from fossil sources	775
Total fossil energy consumption	2,681
Share of fossil sources in total energy consumption (%)	41%
Consumption from nuclear sources	0
Share of consumption from nuclear sources in total energy consumption (%)	0%
Fuel consumption from renewable sources including biomass (also comprising industrial and municipal waste of biologic origin), biofuels, biogas and hydrogen from renewable sources	1,349
Consumption of purchased or acquired electricity, heat, steam and cooling from renewable sources	2,396
Consumption of self-generated non-fuel renewable energy	56
Total renewable energy consumption	3,801
Share of renewable sources in total energy consumption (%)	59%
Total energy consumption	6,482

Energy intensity

Energy intensity is calculated as total energy consumption in MWh for the reporting period divided by total turnover for Unilever as disclosed in the financial statements on page 138. Total turnover equates to net revenue.

Energy intensity per net revenue (MWh/€ million)	2024
Total energy consumption from activities in high climate impact sectors per net revenue from activities in high climate impact sectors[(a)]	107

(a) Total energy consumption excludes energy consumption from collaborative manufacturing. Net revenue includes net revenue from the sales of products produced for Unilever by collaborative manufacturers. This limits the relevance of this metric.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Analysis of renewable and non-renewable electricity in our operations

Renewable electricity (% of MWh)	2024
On-site renewable self generation	**2%**
Purchased renewable electricity	**83%**
On-site Purchase Power Agreements	0%
Off-site Purchase Power Agreements	9%
Green energy products from an energy supplier (green tariffs/bundled RECs)	14%
Green energy purchased in markets with greater than 95% renewable grid	0%
Unbundled RECs bought in market	60%
Total renewable electricity	**85%**

Non-renewable electricity (% of MWh)	2024
On-site non-renewable electricity generation (e.g. gas-fired on-site CHP)	8%
Purchased non-renewable electricity (e.g. non-grid transfer of CHP)	5%
Unbundled RECs bought in an adjacent market	2%
Total non-renewable electricity	**15%**

GHG removals and GHG mitigation projects financed through carbon credits

Our 2030 plans to reach our climate targets include limited removals within our value chain such as soil organic carbon (SOC) sequestration through our regenerative agriculture programmes, which will be counted towards achieving our 2030 Scope 3 GHG (FLAG) reduction targets in line with SBTi criteria. In addition, while the focus of our CTAP is on emissions reductions within our value chain, we will seek to balance any unabated emissions within the scope of our Net Zero 2039 ambition, with the same volume of purchased carbon removals from 2039.

No GHG removals nor carbon credits are reported for 2024 and we do not currently have plans to retire carbon credits in the future. Two of our Prestige brands made consumer-facing claims with reference to carbon credits in 2024.

Internal carbon pricing

We believe the practice of internal carbon pricing can be important in signalling support for carbon pricing as a policy instrument. In practice, however, as not many of our operations are particularly energy-intensive, our Scope 1 and 2 GHG reduction targets act as a more significant decision factor than the shadow carbon price.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Scenario analysis – supporting information

The selection of the most relevant key forces and drivers across the changing physical climate, policy and market landscape are outlined in the table below for each scenario considered in the scenario analysis.

Scenario	**1.5°C**	**<2°C**	**<3°C**	**>4°C**
Temperature: best estimate by 2100	Limit warming to 1.5°C (>50%) with no or limited overshoot	Limit warming to below 2°C (>67%)	Limit warming to 3°C (>50%)	Warming exceeds 4°C (>50%)
Temperature: very likely range by 2100	1.0-1.8°C	1.3-2.4°C	2.1-3.5°C	3.3-5.7°C
Global policy coordination	Globally coordinated policies with immediate action.	Globally coordinated climate policies with delayed action (i.e. after 2030).	No globally coordinated climate policy with current national mitigation efforts.	
Emissions	Reach net zero CO_2 emissions by approx. 2050.	Reach net zero CO_2 emissions by approx. 2070.	CO_2 levels don't peak until mid-century, and net zero not achieved before 2100.	CO_2 emissions approximately double by 2050.
Energy mix	Substantial energy system changes including use of carbon capture and storage, widespread electrification, use of alternative fuels such as hydrogen and sustainable biofuels, and improved energy efficiency.		Without additional policies, there is little change to the energy mix from present day.	Global energy mix prioritises fossil fuels, with an uptake of coal compared to present day.
Land use	The protection, improved management, and restoration of forests, peatlands, coastal wetlands, savannas and grasslands reduce emissions. Agriculture systems change from cropland and grassland to soil carbon management, agroforestry, use of biochar, improved rice cultivation, and livestock and nutrient management, etc.		Present day trends in land use continue, including deforestation rates and use of land for animal protein production.	
Consumption	Low material growth and lower resource- and energy-intensive consumption and lifestyles.		Gradual decrease in resource- and energy-intensive consumption and lifestyles.	Continued exploitation of fossil fuel resources, which supports an increase in resource- and energy-intensive consumption and lifestyles globally.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Pollution

IMPACT, RISK AND OPPORTUNITY MANAGEMENT

Our material Environmental impacts, risks and opportunities resulting from the double materiality assessment (DMA) and the process by which these were identified are detailed on page 230.

Non-biodegradable substances is identified as a material topic, and disclosures and metrics relating to biodegradability have been included accordingly. Unilever considers microplastics in our products to be a subset of substances which can be slow to biodegrade or are resistant to biodegradation, and not material on a standalone basis. Consideration of microplastics resulting from our packaging is detailed in our Resource Use and Circular Economy disclosures on page 258.

Unilever's ingredient portfolio includes some substances classified as substances of concern. However, we evaluate consumer, worker and environmental exposures through our ingredient and product safety risk assessments, alongside relevant hazard characterisation data, ensuring that our products and the ingredient levels we use are safe by design. Our evaluation approach is grounded in science and risk-based assessments, following the principle that exposure determines the safe use of hazardous materials. We update our ingredient and product standards, as well as our safety risk assessments, to reflect new scientific data and changes in regulatory positions. Our ingredient stewardship and product innovation programmes also enable us to identify, review and replace substances of concern when there are concerns about potential effects on human health or the environment. Substances of concern is therefore not identified as a material topic and no further disclosures have been included. For disclosures relating to product safety refer to page 284.

Policies

Unilever's environmental policies, which include those related to pollution, are disclosed on page 232. The table below demonstrates how these policies address our material impacts in relation to pollution.

	Pollution of air, water and soil	Non-biodegradable substances
Unilever Code and Code Policies		■
Unilever Environmental Policy	■	■
Environmental Care Framework Standard	■	
Responsible Partner Policy	■	■
Sustainable Agriculture Code and Sustainable Agriculture Principles	■	

In relation to substances that can be slow to biodegrade or resistant to biodegradation, our Responsible Innovation Code Policy outlines our commitment to conducting responsible, safe and sustainable research and innovation. This ensures that risks to consumer safety, occupational safety and the environment are properly assessed and managed. The implementation of this policy is supported by a standard that defines the approach to safety risk assessments, ensuring consumer, occupational, and environmental safety by design, which includes an understanding of biodegradability. We have set out further information regarding Unilever's Code and Code Policies on page 229.

Unilever's Environmental Care Framework Standards (ECFWS) requires sites to assess the potential for serious environmental incidents or emergency situations and implement comprehensive plans to prevent or mitigate the associated likely consequences. We do not have specific policies in relation to incidents and emergency situations in our value chain. However, our Responsible Partner Policy (RPP) requires our partners to put in place appropriate policies, processes and procedures to address environmental issues.

Actions

Within our own operations, Unilever drives continual improvement in relation to pollution through the ECFWS. For our manufacturing organisation, the Unilever Manufacturing System (UMS) provides an operational framework that supports the implementation of the ECFWS. It requires sites to follow a process to identify and implement actions addressing pollution-related impacts.

Each year, sites develop action plans to enhance compliance with the ECFWS, including pollution control. These plans are monitored throughout the year. We seek to minimise pollution by monitoring relevant pollutants to air, water and soil, and implementing both normal operating and emergency control measures, such as preventative maintenance and monitoring, alarm systems, and dedicated and secured secondary containment.

We require suppliers in our upstream value chain to meet or exceed the Mandatory Requirements of the RPP by implementing appropriate policies, management systems and practices. Unilever verifies compliance with the RPP's Mandatory Requirements and management systems through self-declarations, due diligence scanning, online assessments and third-party audits in high-risk sites.

We promote sustainable and regenerative agriculture practices in our supply chain, through the implementation of the Sustainable Agriculture Code (SAC), Sustainable Agriculture Principles (SAP) and regenerative agriculture projects. The SAC and SAP set out requirements for suppliers regarding water management, water quality, soil management and pollution control. We also require suppliers to have management plans for irrigation, pesticide and fertiliser use to avoid contamination and prevent damage to soils, ecosystems and waterways.

To manage potential pollution impacts caused by environmental exposure to ingredients following consumer use of our products, we conduct environmental risk assessments for all ingredients before they are marketed and for new ingredients prior to use. Each year, we assess the combined environmental exposure from individual ingredients across our product portfolio to ensure safety. Our commitment to producing environmentally safe products is core to our decision-making on product ingredients.

At a minimum, we ensure our products comply with regulations, such as restrictions on synthetic polymer microparticles, and monitor prohibited substances in regulatory lists, taking necessary actions as required. In some areas, our standards exceed regulatory requirements based on our environmental safety assessments or in regions where regulations are weak or poorly enforced.

We also consider evolving societal preferences in our ingredient management decisions. For example, we understand that consumers want more reassurance about the impact of our products on the environment, including on water and aquatic systems. After their use by consumers, 93% of organic ingredients in our products that enter water systems biodegrade within hours/days/weeks. We are focusing on the small volume of ingredients that are slower to biodegrade and working with suppliers to identify alternatives without compromising product performance.

In 2014, we were one of the first companies to stop using small plastic scrub beads, replacing them with alternative exfoliating ingredients such as apricot kernels, cornmeal, ground pumice, silica and walnut shells. We are now in the process of removing other solid polymers that are slow to biodegrade and replacing them with natural or more biodegradable alternatives.

Our actions on ingredient use are supported by the expertise of our Safety, Environmental & Regulatory Science group – our global centre of excellence in safety and sustainability science – as well as our Regulatory Affairs team.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

METRICS AND TARGETS

Targets

Unilever does not have formal targets for pollution emissions defined at a global level. Our approach is to monitor emissions from our sites at a local level to ensure compliance with local legal requirements and permits. We record any exceedance of local permit limits centrally, and put plans in place to remediate. As mentioned above, our manufacturing sites are also reviewed through Environmental Compliance Audits and audited by Corporate Audit, including assessing the robustness of their implementation of the ECFWS.

While Unilever has actions in place in relation to biodegradability, there is no formal target. However, we monitor the proportion of our ingredient portfolio that meets the Unilever Biodegradability Standard, as we seek to develop formulations with less environmental impact while continuing to deliver superior performance.

Pollution of air, water and soil in our own operations

Pollutants emitted are those contained in outflows from our operations, that may relate to pollutants generated from Unilever operations and/or chemical components that may enter our operations, such as chemical components already in the water or raw materials used in operations.

Each year, Unilever reviews the emissions volumes of pollutants listed in Annex II of Regulation (EC) No 166/2006 to ensure those near or above threshold levels are sampled and tested or estimated. For each manufacturing site where sampling and testing is conducted, pollutant emissions to air, water and soil are calculated using internal or certified external laboratories. For sites without sampled data, estimates are based on proxy data from sampled sites using statistical modelling reviewed by external experts or, for air pollutants from energy combustion, on published emission factors.

Emissions per pollutant per site are compared to Annex II threshold values of Regulation (EC) No 166/2006. Only sites exceeding these thresholds are consolidated and reported.

We have used direct measurement and periodic measurement i.e. sampling, to calculate pollutant emissions where possible, however in the first year of reporting, this has been constrained by the availability and capacity of suitable sampling capabilities. Where data was unavailable via direct measurement and sampling, we have employed representative data and a number of mathematical methods designed to produce a reasonable estimate. Emissions of hydrochlorofluorocarbons to air and asbestos to soil, via direct measurement, and emissions of Chemical Oxygen Demand, via sampling, are reported based on actual data only. Estimations make up circa 94% of the remainder of reported pollutant emissions. We aim to reduce the level of estimation, and hence the level of uncertainty in our data over time, as we continue to build our reporting capabilities.

Emissions are reported irrespective of any further downstream processing at treatment plants, such as municipal water treatment or certified waste management. For example, emissions of asbestos are directed to specialised waste landfills.

Emissions to air by pollutant

Pollutant volumes (kg/year)	2024
Carbon monoxide (CO)	9,146,961
Hydrochlorofluorocarbons (HCFCs)	725
Nitrogen oxides (NOx)	144,961
Non - methane volatile organic compounds (NMVOC)	839,375
Particulate matter (PM10)	192,336
Sulphur oxides (SOx)	150,855

Emissions to water by pollutant

Pollutant volumes (kg/year)	2024
Arsenic and compounds (as As)	–
Cadmium and compounds (as Cd)	11
Copper and compounds (as Cu)	–
Lead and compounds (as Pb)	166
Mercury and compounds (as Hg)	21
Nickel and compounds (as Ni)	2,843
Phenols (as total C)	8,615
Total organic carbon (TOC) (as total C or COD/3)	4,181,794
Zinc and compounds (as Zn)	2,461

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Emissions to soil by pollutant

Pollutant volumes (kg/year)	2024
Arsenic and compounds (as As)	596
Asbestos	32,176
Cadmium and compounds (as Cd)	355
Chlorides (as total Cl)	–
Chromium and compounds (as Cr)	19,973
Copper and compounds (as Cu)	28,421
Fluorides (as total F)	416,766
Lead and compounds (as Pb)	483
Mercury and compounds (as Hg)	10
Nickel and compounds (as Ni)	1,129
Total nitrogen	2,629,554
Total phosphorus	16,692
Zinc and compounds (as Zn)	5,117

Biodegradation

Biodegradability is assessed based on internationally recognised tests (OECD, ISO). The Unilever Biodegradability Standard classifies ingredients as 'Readily and Ultimately' and 'Inherently and Ultimately' biodegradable based on OECD 301, 310 and 302 tests. These classifications indicate that ingredients either completely biodegrade within water systems in hours/days (readily and ultimately) or days/weeks (inherently and ultimately).

Sales volumes and biodegradable volumes for the period 1 October to 31 December are extrapolated by ingredient, using the average quarterly volumes from 1 January to 30 September.

Exclusions: Inorganic ingredients that are not relevant for biodegradation; propellants that do not enter the water system after use; and products that are consumed by consumers, such as foods, vitamins, minerals and supplements; and products sold by businesses that are not fully integrated into Unilever's systems.

Metric	2024
Percentage of organic ingredients contained in products sold that are biodegradable	93%

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Water

IMPACT, RISK AND OPPORTUNITY MANAGEMENT

Our material Environmental impacts, risks and opportunities resulting from the double materiality assessment (DMA) and the process by which these were identified are detailed on page 230. Given the nature of our business, we do not consider marine-related resource commodities as a material topic.

Policies

Unilever's environmental policies, which include water-related policies, are disclosed on page 232. The table below demonstrates how these policies address water withdrawal from our own operations and upstream value chain leading to water shortages. These policies encompass water management and water consumption.

	Water withdrawal leading to water shortages
Unilever Environmental Policy	■
Environmental Care Framework Standard	■
Responsible Partner Policy	■
Sustainable Agriculture Code and Sustainable Agriculture Principles	■

There are no specific policies in place relating to product demand due to consumer awareness of water scarcity and water shortages, including product design (services are not applicable to Unilever). We consider product innovation as part of our business strategy, including innovations related to sustainability topics, which are supported by our Research & Development (R&D) science and technology programmes. For example, innovating water-smart products that help consumers use less water is considered as part of our Business Group R&D strategies.

Actions

Water consumption

Within our manufacturing operations, we drive continuous improvement through the implementation and monitoring of site-level water management plans. We seek to minimise water abstraction per tonne of production from shared resources, including reusing and recycling freshwater wherever practical. In 2024, we invested in rainwater harvesting facilities and other projects to reduce freshwater withdrawal at our sites.

Our business partners in our value chain are required to comply with the mandatory requirements of the RPP. This includes our water-related requirements. We verify RPP alignment through self-declarations upon registration, annual re-registration to our systems, routine due diligence and risk-based audits. We require business partners to create a Corrective Action Plan to address any issues identified during third-party audits and we encourage suppliers to contact the Unilever team for guidance where they face challenges in meeting our requirements.

We continue to implement water stewardship programmes in water-stressed areas where we have manufacturing sites, which aim to improve water security through collective action with other stakeholders in the shared water catchment:

- In 2024 we implemented eight additional water stewardship programmes, bringing our total to 21 active programmes in Brazil, Chile, Egypt, India, Indonesia, Mexico, South Africa and Turkey. These programmes are run in line with the Alliance for Water Stewardship Standard, an external global framework, or the Prabhat approach, our community development initiative in India. Each programme has its own time horizons and associated activities, informed by river basin studies (with four new studies completed in 2024) and local knowledge from regional implementation partners, such as DKM in Turkey and NBI in South Africa.
- In 2025, we will continue to onboard new sites in support of our target to implement water stewardship programmes in 100 locations in water-stressed areas by 2030.

Reducing product demand

To help our consumers conserve water and use our products in water-scarce conditions, we invest in water-smart products and formulations that deliver superior performance even in such environments. For example, many of our hair care products now have fast-rinse technology as standard. We also seek to minimise the impact of our products on water and aquatic systems by using ingredients that meet our Biodegradability Standard, as detailed in our Pollution disclosures on page 249.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

METRICS AND TARGETS

Targets

We do not have formal targets on water withdrawal in our own operations and we do not define targets for our upstream value chain or on water-smart product design. Water withdrawal from our own operations and water-smart product design are addressed through our manufacturing processes and product innovation plans, rather than through global targets. Within our upstream value chain, we manage water risk through our RPP and verify compliance with the RPP's Mandatory Requirements and management systems through self-declarations, due diligence scanning, online assessments and third-party audits in high-risk sites.

Unilever's target is to implement water stewardship programmes in 100 locations in water-stressed areas by 2030, in line with our Environmental Policy. These stewardship programmes involve working with others to address shared water challenges within water-stressed areas where Unilever has manufacturing operations. This is a voluntary target and ecological thresholds and allocations of impacts to Unilever have not been applied when setting the target. Our target of water stewardship programmes in 100 locations represents all of our manufacturing sites in water-stressed areas.

Implement water stewardship programmes in 100 locations in water-stressed areas by 2030
Locations refer to Unilever manufacturing sites.

Water-stressed areas are those with 'high' or 'extremely high' baseline water stress, as determined based on the WRI Aqueduct Water Risk Atlas Tool, or, by exception, based on Unilever's additional review of site-specific factors and localised water risks to complement the WRI data and ratings.

Programmes must be implemented within the catchment of a Unilever water-stressed location, operate in line with either the Alliance for Water Stewardship Standard or the Prabhat approach, and be approved by a Unilever authority. Programmes must also consist of a material Unilever commitment and be created, facilitated or provided by Unilever or by a third party under a contractual commitment with Unilever.

Programmes must be implemented between 1 January 2020 and 31 December 2024, with activities either ongoing or completed during the reporting period, and at least six months having elapsed since the contract was signed. Locations are not counted in the metric if programme activities were completed in prior periods and have not been extended or renewed.

Water target	Goal	2024	2023	2022
Implement water stewardship programmes in 100 locations in water-stressed areas by 2030 (number of water stewardship programmes)	100	21	13	8

Water consumption in our own operations

Water consumption is calculated as the difference between water withdrawal and water discharge. This is measured using invoices and/or meter readings. For sites where this information is not collected (representing 4% of water consumption), consumption is estimated based on site headcount, pallet positions and proxy data.

Unilever sites in areas at water risk, including areas of high-water stress, are identified using the World Resources Institute (WRI) Aqueduct Water Risk Atlas tool. These include sites where the weighted aggregate total water risk is classified as 'high' or 'extremely high', as well as sites with high or extremely high baseline water stress, or, by exception, sites may be identified based on Unilever's additional review of site-specific factors and localised water risks to complement the WRI data and ratings.

Water intensity is calculated as total water consumption in thousands m^3 divided by turnover in € million. Total turnover equates to net revenue.

Water recycled and reused is measured via meter readings (62%) or through a water mass balance (38%) at all manufacturing sites and the majority of logistics and other sites. Where data is unavailable, the amount of water recycled and reused is assumed to be zero given the non-manufacturing nature of operations at these sites.

For all manufacturing sites and the majority of logistics sites with water storage capacity, the stored water is recorded as the maximum capacity of the storage facilities. Where data is unavailable, water stored is assumed to be zero given the non-manufacturing nature of operations at such sites.

Water consumed, recycled, reused and stored (millions m^3)	2024
Total water consumption	17
Total water consumption in areas at water risk, including areas of high-water stress (based on ESRS definition)	11
Total water consumption in areas at water risk, including areas of high-water stress (based on Unilever definition)[(a)]	11
Total water recycled and reused	2
Total water stored	1
Water intensity ratio: water consumption per turnover (m^3/€ million)	281

(a) Includes an additional two sites based on Unilever's additional review of site-specific factors and localised water risks.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Biodiversity and Ecosystems

STRATEGY

Interaction of material impacts and risks with strategy and business model

Our material Environmental impacts, risks and opportunities (IROs) resulting from the double materiality assessment (DMA) and the process by which these were identified are detailed on page 230. Impacts on desertification and soil sealing were not assessed within our value chain. No biodiversity and ecosystem-related opportunities were identified during the DMA process.

Impacts and risks in our own operations

Our double materiality assessment concluded that our own operations, covering more than 600 sites globally, do not collectively have a material impact on nature. At a local level, we have identified 22 sites that operate within or near biodiversity-sensitive areas, where Unilever may contribute to negative effects on biodiversity. To reach this conclusion, we identified sites within a 1km radius of biodiversity sensitive areas to capture Unilever's likely direct and indirect impacts and allow for comparability across our sites.

Each site was then assessed using two indicators:
- The Biodiversity Intactness Index (BII); and
- Water stress assessment according to WRI Aqueduct Tool, supplemented with Unilever's localised water stress assessments.

We selected these indicators due to their global scope, their relevance to Unilever's operations and recognition by frameworks such as Taskforce on Nature-related Financial Disclosures (TNFD). We then engaged with sites to understand the local environment, our activities, and current land and environmental classifications.

The indicators used identified potential negative impacts, but they risk over and under-reporting due to being outdated and the inaccuracy of global biodiversity data sets. Consequently, we are unable to directly attribute Unilever's operations to negative impacts on biodiversity and ecosystems. For example, many identified sites are in industrial zones with multiple companies. While we know threatened species exist near our operations, we have not assessed if our operations specifically affect them. Material impacts from desertification and soil sealing were not identified in our operations.

Establishing and attributing negative impacts requires local analysis and community engagement. In 2025, we will enhance our site-specific assessment capabilities with new datasets, indicators, and guidance to evaluate impacts, risks, dependencies, and identify the necessary mitigation measures.

Impacts and risks in our value chain

Our double materiality assessment identified several nature-related risks in our value chain. Our business both depends on and impacts nature, including land, forests and water systems. We recognise the loss of biodiversity within these systems as a principal risk (Climate and Nature), so protecting them is important to ensure the resilience of our business and the communities where we operate.

To help inform the development of our strategy, we performed a review of our most material biodiversity and ecosystems, physical, transition and systemic risks under two possible nature scenarios aligned with TNFD scenarios over the medium to long term as follows:

The High Nature Degradation scenario (aligned with the TNFD 'Sand in the Gears' scenario) assesses business resilience to high ecosystem service degradation and the physical and systemic risks associated with continued environmental decline. It assumes fragmented global efforts and insufficient climate policies drive temperatures above 2°C by 2050, worsening biodiversity loss and environmental decline, and escalating risks for businesses and communities.

The High Nature Preservation scenario (aligned with the TNFD 'Ahead of the Game' scenario) focuses on high transition risks and the implications of a resilient economy transitioning to a world with lower ecosystem degradation. It assumes strong COP15-aligned policies and coordinated global climate efforts limiting warming to well below 2°C, reducing biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation.

Resilience of our strategy and business model to biodiversity loss and ecosystem degradation

The results of the review demonstrate that a high nature degradation scenario results in the physical risks of soil depletion and declining yields for high-risk crops like tea and soy. Rising temperatures, water shortages and the loss of pollinators further reduce yields, limiting the supply of key crops. Shock events from systemic risks, such as pest outbreaks, and extreme weather, increase in frequency and magnitude impacting the agriculture sector directly in some regions initially and subsequently cascade through the wider economy. This scenario may further lead to transition risks from increased activism against companies seen as having a negative environmental impact and reputational damage.

Where a high nature preservation scenario is achieved, driven by public awareness and political coordination on biodiversity, protective legal frameworks (e.g. expansion of legislation similar to EUDR), may evolve faster, increasing the likelihood of transition risks from nature-related fines and litigation. Our actions or those of actors in our value chain that may cause harm to biodiversity and ecosystems, could further lead to increased public scrutiny, legal claims or potential non-compliance incidents resulting in fines and penalties and loss of market share due to negative stakeholder perception.

Our business model integrates various strategies to address these risk, enhancing resilience and increasing the organisation's capacity to respond as follows:

Responsible sourcing: Our regenerative agriculture and sustainable sourcing programmes address the impact of our sourcing on ecosystem degradation and services, particularly in key sourcing locations. Our regenerative agriculture programmes build on our sustainable sourcing programme, strengthening practices within the supply base of key agricultural suppliers, and improving the resilience of agricultural systems, which helps address our dependencies on agricultural commodities. Our actions to stop deforestation and conversion are also crucial for addressing the impacts and risks associated with ecosystem degradation.

Protect and Restore: We take action to protect and restore ecosystems within and surrounding our key sourcing locations to help address the wider system risk of biodiversity failure and address the impact that our sourcing has on ecosystem degradation and services.

Stakeholder engagement: We engage with a diverse range of stakeholders, including local communities and Indigenous knowledge holders, in our sustainability initiatives.

Given the significant potential challenges to the agricultural sector from high nature degradation, our nature advocacy agenda is not just critical to supporting the achievement of our nature targets but is also key to driving systemic global initiatives to limit the possible impacts of this scenario.

We do not have a specific nature transition plan. However, the Unilever Climate Transition Action plan set out on page 233 recognises the interconnected challenges of climate change and biodiversity loss.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

IMPACT, RISK AND OPPORTUNITY MANAGEMENT

Policies

Unilever's environmental policies, which include nature-related policies in our own operations and our value chain, are disclosed on page 232. The table below demonstrates how these policies address our material nature-related impacts, risks and dependencies, which are focused on our upstream value chain. Unilever does not have a dedicated biodiversity and ecosystem protection policy which focuses specifically on impacts from operational sites in or near biodiversity sensitive areas.

	Ecosystem degradation and service failure	Ecosystem degradation leading to crop yield reduction	Systemic risk of biodiversity collapse	Increased activism, legal or non compliance costs
Unilever Code and Code policies				■
Unilever Environmental Policy				■
People & Nature Policy	■		■	■
Sustainable Agriculture Code and Sustainable Agriculture Principles	■	■	■	■

As described in our People & Nature Policy and the Sustainable Agriculture Principles, we set requirements for traceability and the management of production and sourcing to help maintain biodiversity in our upstream value chain. We also consider the social consequences of biodiversity loss and ecosystem-related impacts through these policies.

We do not have specific sustainable oceans/seas practices or policies. Based on our materiality assessment, this is an area of low impact on nature for our business, as we source only very low volumes of commodities from the oceans/seas.

Actions

Our actions and resources are focused in four priority strategic areas and address our material nature-related impacts, dependencies and risks. We do not use biodiversity offsets within any of our actions.

Regenerative agriculture

In 2024, we implemented 17 new regenerative agriculture projects, bringing our total to 23 active projects that collectively cover almost 130,000 hectares since 2021. The programme has in-field implementation in 11 countries: Argentina, France, Germany, India, Indonesia, Italy, Mexico, Spain, Thailand, the UK and the US. We have plans in place to increase the implementation of our regenerative agriculture programmes to more than 200,000 hectares in 2025. Each project starts with a context analysis of the local environment, in partnership with the participating farmers, and draws on the expertise of local agronomists. The projects are designed to address the most material environmental and climate issues faced by farmers, with practices selected to fit the local context and farmer knowledge. Every project is designed to address a range of relevant metrics covering biodiversity, climate and other ecosystem changes via our Measure, Report, Verify (MRV) framework, which generates output- and outcome-level data annually.

Sustainable sourcing

In 2024, we sourced 79% of our key crops sustainably, with 63% sourced using physically sustainable sources and 16% using sustainability credits. Our goal is to source 95% of our key crops sustainably by 2030. The practices codified in our Sustainable Agriculture Principles (SAP) (previously, the Sustainable Agriculture Code (SAC)) enable us to identify and benchmark codes, standards and assessments that meet our sustainable sourcing requirements. This action has incorporated local and Indigenous knowledge and nature-based solutions through the requirements encoded within our SAP. In 2024, we updated our SAC to lift our requirements for environmental management, human rights, climate compliance and traceability and to introduce regenerative agriculture practices more clearly.

Deforestation-free supply chains

In 2024, we have maintained 95% order volumes of palm oil, paper and board, tea, soy and cocoa as deforestation-free, based on Unilever's requirements. Since 2021, we have supported the large-scale transformation of our palm supply chain through investing €218 million in Unilever Oleochemical International (UOI). This will further expand our independent mills and direct sourcing associated with smallholder programmes.

We have continued to invest in the verification of suppliers against our Independent Verification Protocols, expanding the implementation of our deforestation-free sourcing programme, addressing risk, and ensuring the resilience of our supply chain and supporting ecosystems.

Our deforestation-free landscape strategy also includes empowerment and inclusion of smallholders in our supply chain, which we seek to do through direct sourcing approaches as well as working across landscapes. In 2024, Unilever's palm oil smallholder hub programme trained around 12,500 smallholders in multiple provinces across Indonesia. Complementary to the programme, Unilever is onboarding more than 20 independent mills to ensure linkage between smallholders to our supply chain. Local and Indigenous knowledge is incorporated into our smallholder programme at all stages, from programme design to smallholder engagement, to enable land mapping and evaluation process.

In 2025, we will continue to expand our deforestation-free verification programme to new sources and suppliers.

Protect and Restore

In 2024, we implemented three new protection and restoration programmes closely associated with our sourcing locations. We have implemented 13 programmes in total since 2021, covering around 425,000 hectares cumulatively. The programmes are geographically focused in South East Asia. Our programmes incorporate Indigenous knowledge by partnering with local communities, through activities including but not limited to joint programme design, mapping customary areas and supporting traditional forest management practices.

All actions are tracked against our cumulative conservation target of protecting and restoring 1 million hectares by 2030. We select landscapes based on our commodity footprint, operational presence, and need for additional support from Unilever in the area. Some of our existing long-term landscape partnerships are located across three provinces that are the supply bases of our palm oil processing facility in North Sumatra. We actively support programmes in which multi-stakeholder collaboration is leveraged to scale up efforts to protect and restore critical ecosystems. Alongside the Rimba Collective, which is designed to provide conservation finance and project implementation across Indonesia, we collaborate to protect both the Leuser Ecosystem and the Tapanuli Selatan region, which are critical forest ecosystems for Sumatran tigers and orangutans.

Working in landscapes allows us to engage stakeholders within a jurisdiction on sustainable development plans, considering factors like land and labour rights. We also invest in innovations to drive large-scale impacts.

Specific actions for 2025 include expanding protection work with forest management units and scaling local farmer group engagement. We have plans in place for projects of up to 600,000 hectares by 2027 that include expanding our programming with the Rimba Collective and Conservation International.

Advocacy

In 2024, we made progress on our nature policy advocacy priorities. Key actions included:

- **Nature and biodiversity:** We supported the Business for Nature coalition's Call to Action to governments ahead of UN Biodiversity COP16 in Cali, Colombia, asking them to adopt, implement or strengthen the policies and legislation needed to halt and reverse nature loss by 2030. We reinforced our support for the Call to Action with a joint statement with Business for Nature, which highlighted the importance of nature to our business but laying out why voluntary action is insufficient. We then attended the COP to advocate for ambitious National Biodiversity Strategies and Action Plans (NBSAPs), integrated with countries' NDCs.
- **Regenerative agriculture:** We attended New York Climate Week and the UN General Assembly (UNGA) 2024 to advocate for the scaling of regenerative agriculture via the creation of a regulatory landscape that supports farmers to transition to, and maintain, regenerative approaches. We also attended COP29 in Baku to advocate for NDCs that support the scaling of regenerative agriculture.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

METRICS AND TARGETS

Targets

We have set targets to reduce our impacts on and risks associated with biodiversity and ecosystems, and to help protect, restore and regenerate nature in those locations where we have a material impact. We have updated our targets to focus on allocating resources towards our material sustainability matters. Our sustainable sourcing and regenerative agriculture targets address the impact of ecosystem degradation, potential crop yield reduction, and biodiversity loss or collapse within our value chain. Our protect and restore and deforestation-free targets represent a unified approach to ecosystem intervention, aiming to address biodiversity loss risks and potential regulatory or activist challenges in areas surrounding our value chain.

In 2024, we reset our sustainable sourcing target to 95% of procured volume with third-party verification by 2030, which allows for new supplier and programme expansion, as well as additional third-party verification. We also split our previous 'protect and restore 1.5 million hectares of land, forest and oceans' target into two separate targets related to regenerative agriculture and natural ecosystem protection.

We set our targets for both our regenerative agriculture and protect and restore programmes based on exposure to land and our key crops sourcing footprint, which we estimate at 4 million hectares. By 2030, our regenerative agriculture programme aims to cover approximately 25% of the land required to grow the agricultural raw materials associated with our key crops, for Unilever's products. Our protect and restore target, which focuses on ecosystems within and around our key crops sourcing footprint, also aims to cover approximately 25% of our land footprint. After achieving our no deforestation target in 2023, we set a new goal to maintain 95% deforestation-free sourcing for palm oil, paper and board, tea, soy and cocoa. Continued implementation of our commitment to deforestation-free sourcing aims to prevent ecosystem destruction and mitigate legal and reputational risks associated with biodiversity degradation.

Ecological thresholds and allocations of impacts to Unilever have not been applied when setting targets. Target-setting was informed by, but not aligned with, the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework, and all our targets can be allocated to the avoidance, minimisation, restoration, and rehabilitation layers of the mitigation hierarchy. Stakeholders in our value chain have not been formally involved in our target setting.

Our targets and progress against these targets are set out below:

Implement regenerative agriculture practices on 1 million hectares of agricultural land by 2030, and help protect and restore 1 million hectares of natural ecosystems by 2030
Regenerative agriculture activities eligible for support through Unilever's programmes must contribute to at least two of the five impact areas outlined in our Regenerative Agriculture Principles: climate, soil, water, livelihoods or biodiversity.

Protect and restore activities eligible for support through Unilever's programmes are those designed to either conserve areas of natural ecosystem or improve ecosystem quality.

Eligible programmes must operate within a defined geographical area, be approved by Unilever authority, be operational between 1 January 2021 and 31 December 2024, and be run directly by Unilever or by a third party under a contractual commitment with Unilever. Where a programme is phased over multiple years, only the share of newly operational between 1 January and 31 December 2024 will be eligible. A programme is considered operational if at least one activity has commenced, as demonstrated by the use of budgeted financial or in-kind resources.

95% volume of key crops to be verified as sustainably sourced by 2030
Key crops include cereals and starches, cocoa, coconut oil, dairy, palm oil, paper and board, rapeseed oil, soy oil, sugar, tea, vanilla, and vegetables and herbs, and account for over 75% of our agricultural sourcing by volume.

Sustainable sources are defined as raw materials that are either produced according to third-party certification and aligned with Unilever's Sustainable Agricultural Principles or purchased from non-sustainable sources but matched with credits representing verified sustainably sourced raw materials. Examples include soy (RTRS credits), cane sugar (Bonsucro credits), and palm oil and palm kernel oil (RSPO credits).

Measuring performance against this target includes the partial use of credits to address the unavailability of physically sustainable (certified) sources in some markets. These credits are compensatory and not associated with providing biodiversity improvements.

Exclusions: crops purchased by third parties, those used in agricultural production of other purchase materials or those included in the manufacturing process of purchased materials, and where the volume is <1,000 tonnes.

Maintain no deforestation across our primary deforestation-linked commodities
Performance is measured as the percentage of purchase order volumes of palm oil, paper and board, tea, soy and cocoa that meet Unilever's deforestation-free requirements in the period from 1 January to 31 December 2024.

Materials are determined to be deforestation-free through one of the following means:
- The materials are in compliance with the European Union Regulation on Deforestation-Free Products (EUDR);
- An independent third-party certification body has provided confirmation to Unilever that the supplier meets the requirements of the Unilever Deforestation-Free Verification protocols;
- The supplier has received a third-party certification from one of a list of approved certification bodies that meet Unilever's Deforestation-free requirements; or
- The materials come from locations or countries considered to have had a negligible risk of recent deforestation as per the Negligible Risk Protocol.

Exclusions: Materials purchased by third-party companies supplying finished products for Unilever, materials purchased for collaborative manufacturing, materials included as an ingredient or used in the process of purchased materials or produced with multiple interchangeable feedstocks, small volume materials for palm oil and small volume suppliers where the aggregated volumes are <5% of total purchased volumes.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Nature targets	Goal	2024	2023	2022
Implement regenerative agriculture practices on 1 million hectares of agricultural land by 2030 (millions of hectares)[(a)]	1m	**0.13m**	0.06m	0.05m
Help protect and restore 1 million hectares of natural ecosystems by 2030 (millions of hectares)[(a)]	1m	**0.43m**	0.29m	0.20m
95% volume of key crops to be verified as sustainably sourced by 2030 (% purchased)[(b)(c)]	95%	**79%**	79%	81%
Maintain no deforestation across our primary deforestation-linked commodities (% palm oil, paper and board, tea, soy and cocoa order volumes that are deforestation-free)[(d)]	95%	**97%**	98%	–

(a) These results are from projects funded by Unilever and our partners. Unilever has an agreement with our project partners that allows all parties to make public statements on the total impacts of these projects provided they acknowledge the role of the other party.
(b) Raw materials produced according to third-party certification and aligned with Unilever's SAP were 63% in 2024, 66% in 2023 and 71% in 2022.
(c) Raw materials purchased from non-sustainable sources but matched with credits representing verified sustainably sourced raw materials were 16% in 2024, 13% in 2023 and 10% in 2022.
(d) 2023 performance measured for all commodity volumes ordered for three-month period October to December, except for palm oil in India measured only for December.

The change to our goals in 2024 reflects our commitment to expand and stretch our sustainability requirements, and has impacted our 2024 performance on our sustainably sourced and no deforestation goals. Our updated sustainable sourcing goal requires that all materials be verified, and we are transitioning suppliers and programmes to verification through 2024. In addition, having reached 97.5% deforestation-free sourcing in 2023 for palm oil, paper and board, tea, soy and cocoa order volumes, we set our target at 95% on an ongoing basis for the same commodities in 2024, to ensure we can expand the scope of our programme by onboarding new suppliers and materials. This expands our deforestation-free sourcing and provides better resilience and greater scale. The scope of this target covers more than 65% of Unilever's impact on land used to grow our key crops, and focuses on those commodities that are most often linked to deforestation and conversion of natural ecosystems to farmland.

Impact metrics related to biodiversity and ecosystems change

The Integrated Biodiversity Assessment Tool (IBAT) contains global biodiversity datasets and derived data, including the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) Red List of Threatened Species™, the World Database on Protected Areas (WDPA) and the World Database of Key Biodiversity Areas (WDKBA).

Biodiversity-sensitive areas (BSAs) are defined as the Natura 2000 network of protected areas, UNESCO World Heritage sites and Key Biodiversity Areas (KBAs), as well as other protected areas, as referred to in Appendix D of Annex II to Commission Delegated Regulation (EU) 2021/2139.

A Key Biodiversity Area (KBA) is a site that contributes significantly to the global persistence of biodiversity in terrestrial, freshwater and marine ecosystems. Sites qualify as global KBAs by meeting one or more of 11 criteria in five categories: threatened biodiversity; geographically restricted biodiversity; ecological integrity; biological processes; and irreplaceability.

A Protected Area (PA) is a clearly defined geographical space, recognised, dedicated and managed through legal or other effective means to achieve the long-term conservation of nature, along with associated ecosystem services and cultural values. These areas are obtained from the WDPA.

Unilever site geo-coordinates are assessed using the IBAT to identify those within 1km of a BSA. For each site that is identified as in or within 1km of a BSA, Unilever assess where there is a negative change in the Biodiversity Intactness Index (BII) and if this is greater than zero between 2017 and 2020; and a water-stressed area according to WRI Aqueduct Water Risk Atlas Tool. For sites where there is both water stress and a negative change in BII, Unilever includes this site in the metric and obtains the site size (in square metres) from Unilever's site surface land area reports. Site areas reported in square metres are converted to hectares and summed to give a total area in hectares.

Sites that were initially identified as being in biodiversity-sensitive areas but are located within highly urbanised regions were excluded from the final list, as their proximity to biodiversity-rich locations is limited.

Exclusions: Smaller offices, logistics and GBU sites that do not report in Unilever systems.

Impact metrics related to biodiversity and ecosystems change	2024
Number of Unilever sites in or near (i.e. within 1km) of biodiversity-sensitive areas, that are negatively affecting biodiversity	**22**
Area of Unilever sites in or near (i.e. within 1km) of biodiversity-sensitive areas, that are negatively affecting biodiversity (hectares)	**322**

While the indicators used may identify potential negative impacts, they risk over- and under-reporting due to outdated and inaccurate global biodiversity data sets. Consequently, we are unable to directly attribute Unilever's operations to negative impacts on biodiversity and ecosystems.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Resource Use and Circular Economy

IMPACT, RISK AND OPPORTUNITY MANAGEMENT

Our material Environmental impacts, risks and opportunities resulting from the double materiality assessment (DMA) and the process by which these were identified are detailed on page 230.

Policies

Unilever's environmental policies are disclosed on page 232. The table below demonstrates how these policies address our material risks and impacts in relation to resource use and circular economy.

	Plastic pollution	Hazardous waste	EPR schemes and other plastic-related taxes
Unilever Environmental Policy	■	■	■
Environmental Care Framework Standard	■	■	
Responsible Partner Policy	■	■	

Our approach to plastic packaging is embedded in our overall business strategy and product innovation cycles. Our policies in relation to plastic packaging encompass the reduction in our use of virgin plastics, and our policies in relation to hazardous waste encompass waste management.

Unilever's policies and other disclosures regarding the sustainable sourcing of raw materials are detailed in our Biodiversity and Ecosystems section on page 254.

Actions

Plastic pollution, extended producer responsibility (EPR) schemes for packaging and other plastic-related taxes

Unilever is working to end plastic pollution through reduction, circulation and collaboration. We aim to reduce virgin plastic use by switching to recycled plastic, designing lighter packaging, and developing alternative packaging materials, formats and models. We have also introduced new packaging solutions, like laundry sheets and capsules in cardboard boxes, to reduce or remove plastic. To help find new ways for our consumers to shop and use our products, since 2021, we have conducted over 50 reuse-refill pilots around the world, testing and learning from different approaches. Because we recognise that collaboration and regulation are key to scaling reusable packaging models, we are also participating in industry-wide initiatives led by the World Economic Forum, the Ellen MacArthur Foundation and the Consumer Goods Forum.

To help keep plastic packaging in circulation and out of the environment, we are developing next-generation packaging materials that are reusable, recyclable or compostable. We split rigid packaging from hard-to-recycle flexible packaging in recognition of the unique challenges linked to each format and the different solutions required. In 2024, we introduced a new recyclable pump for Vaseline bottles in North America. Through our Future Flexibles programme, we are exploring alternatives to plastic, such as recyclable and compostable paper-based materials. While we develop and scale these new materials, we are moving some of our products' packaging to paper-plastic solutions, such as Knorr bouillon cubes in the UK. Additionally, we are supporting initiatives to collect and process plastic, which helps to scale waste management systems, prevent plastic pollution in the environment, and reduce the leakage of microplastics.

Tackling plastic pollution requires cross-industry collaboration and policy to drive systemic change and ensure that all businesses play by the same rules. We co-chair the Business Coalition for a Global Plastics Treaty, campaigning for a legally binding UN plastics treaty that addresses the full lifecycle of plastic and creates a level playing field for all businesses. We also advocate for mandatory, well-designed extended producer responsibility (EPR) schemes to hold businesses accountable for their packaging choices. In 2020, we endorsed the Consumer Goods Forum's position on EPR scheme design, and in 2021, we signed the Ellen MacArthur Foundation's public statement supporting the use of EPR, alongside industry peers.

Waste management, including hazardous waste

We drive continuous improvement in waste management at our sites, including hazardous waste, through the Environmental Care Framework Standard (ECFWS). For our manufacturing organisation, the Unilever Manufacturing System (UMS) provides an operational framework to support the implementation of the ECFWS. Our sites follow a framework to identify and implement actions addressing negative waste-related impacts. Each year, all sites develop action plans to further enhance ECFWS compliance, including waste management, with progress monitored throughout the year to ensure the timely closure of actions.

In 2024, we introduced a global Waste Standard, effective 1 January 2025, mandating minimum requirements for the management of hazardous and non-hazardous waste at all Unilever sites. The standard mandates the application of the waste hierarchy, employee engagement on waste management principles and regular audits of our waste service providers. To reduce our waste footprint, the standard also requires sites to maintain zero non-hazardous waste from manufacturing to landfill or incineration without energy recovery, which Unilever has maintained since 2015. In 2024, we supported this by collaborating with governments and waste service providers in countries where this approach is not widely available.

Within our value chain, our business partners are required to comply with the mandatory requirements of our Responsible Partner Policy (RPP), including our hazardous waste management requirements. We verify RPP alignment through self-declarations upon registration, annual re-registration to our systems, routine due diligence and risk-based audits. We require business partners to create a Corrective Action Plan to address any issues identified during third-party audits and we encourage suppliers to contact the Unilever team for guidance where they face challenges in meeting our requirements.

METRICS AND TARGETS

Targets

Our plastic packaging targets focus on the areas we know will have the most impact such as reducing our use of virgin plastic and developing solutions for hard-to-recycle flexible plastic packaging materials, like plastic sachets.

We aim to address plastic pollution, including microplastics pollution, by reducing our virgin plastic usage and increasing circular plastic packaging design. These voluntary targets are in line with Unilever's Environmental Policy. Ecological thresholds and allocations of impacts to Unilever have not been applied when setting targets. Consideration of microplastics in our products is detailed on page 249.

Making progress on our targets to address plastic packaging is relevant to EPR schemes, taxes or bans related to packaging; however, we do not have specific targets in place for such schemes, taxes or bans.

We do not have formal waste targets in place in our own operations. However, waste generation and waste routes are monitored at a local level to ensure compliance with Unilever standards and local legal requirements. Our global Safety, Health and Environment (SHE) team also monitors the compliance of our manufacturing sites with respect to our aim to send zero non-hazardous waste to landfill or incineration without energy recovery, and site-level plans are developed to remediate any identified instances of non-compliance.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

The scope of our plastic packaging targets includes plastic packaging in 26 countries, which account for approximately 82% of Unilever's sales. Packaging materials comprise of a range of different plastics, including:

- Rigids – plastic packaging materials that are sturdy, inflexible and maintain their shape even when empty, such as bottles, jars and tubs.
- Flexibles – plastic packaging materials that can be easily moulded, folded or shaped, adapting to the product's form, such as pouches, sachets, overwraps and tubes.

Where packaging components are made of multiple materials, those that are predominantly plastic by weight are defined as plastic packaging. Conversely, if plastic is not the single greatest material by weight within a packaging item, the whole item is not considered 'plastic packaging'.

Exclusions: All targets exclude plastic packaging purchased/sold (as applicable) by businesses that are not fully integrated into Unilever's SAP system and transport packaging, also known as tertiary packaging.

Reduce our virgin plastic footprint by 30% by 2026, and 40% by 2028, from a 2019 baseline; and Use 25% recycled plastic in our packaging by 2025
Virgin plastic packaging is derived from fossil fuels and/or bio-based sources and has not been recycled. 2024 virgin and recycled plastic packaging volumes are recorded based on supplier invoices and product specification information. 2019 plastic packaging volumes are estimated by country and Business Group, based on the volume of plastic purchased in 26 countries in 2023 and the ratio of 2019 and 2023 total product sales volumes. The 2019 recycled plastic purchased is estimated based on monthly demand by region.

Other exclusions: Plastic packaging purchased by collaborative manufacturers of Unilever products is not included, representing approximately 11% of plastic packaging purchased in the 26 countries.

100% of our plastic packaging to be reusable, recyclable or compostable by 2030 (for rigids) and 2035 (for flexibles); and Collect and process more plastic packaging than we sell by 2025
Plastic packaging volumes are based on plastic packaging used in products sold. Approximately 6% of products have incomplete information, which is extrapolated from the average of the most similar products available with complete data. To estimate the total tonnes of plastic packaging used in products sold for the reporting year, the plastic packaging used in products sold for the 12 months to 30 September 2024 is multiplied by the ratio of sales volumes for the 12 months to 30 September 2024 compared to the 12 months to 31 December 2024.

- Recyclable plastic packaging: technically possible to recycle and has proven commercial viability for plastics processors to recycle the material in the region where it is sold.
- Reusable plastic packaging: designed to be used, then refilled more than once and used again for the same purpose; it must also be recyclable at the end of its life and is therefore not assessed separately to recyclability.
- Compostable plastic packaging: meets international standards and definitions for compostability, and local country infrastructure exists to enable composting to take place.

Recyclability and compostability are assessed based on information gathered from various sources, such as governmental organisations (for recycling and recovery rates), industry consortiums and packaging recycling organisations.

Plastic packaging collected for processing is calculated by country and consists of:

- Post-consumer recycled plastic purchased by Unilever, recorded based on supplier invoices and product specification information.
- Plastic packaging collected through activities directly funded by Unilever, tracked by country through invoices, contracts or other written confirmation from the relevant supplier organisations. Where it is collected and processed in partnership, we will only count Unilever's share.
- The tonnes of Unilever product packaging recycled, reused or recovered in countries where Unilever funds municipal recycling through EPR schemes are estimated using country-specific Recycling and Recovery Indices (RRI). These estimates rely on government or industry data, or on internal expert opinions when external data is unavailable or unreliable. Bottle collection is excluded to prevent double-counting with post-consumer recycled plastic packaging purchased by Unilever.

Plastics targets	Goal	2024	2023	2022
Reduce our virgin plastic footprint by 30% by 2026, and 40% by 2028, from a 2019 baseline[(a)]	-30%	-23%	-21%	-21%
100% of our plastic packaging to be reusable, recyclable or compostable[(b)]		57%	53%	55%
by 2030 for rigids (% of total tonnes of reusable, recyclable or compostable plastic packaging used)	100%	76%	–	–
by 2035 for flexibles (% of total tonnes of reusable, recyclable or compostable plastic packaging used)		13%	–	–
Use 25% recycled plastic in our packaging by 2025 (% of total used in packaging)[(c)]	25%	21%	20%	18%
Collect and process more plastic than we sell by 2025 (tonnes of plastic packaging collected and processed, % of tonnes of plastic sold)[(d)]	100%	93%	68%	61%

(a) Restated from -18% in 2023 and -13% in 2022 due to change in measurement methodology (see below).
(b) 2023 and 2022 measured for 12-month period ended 30 September.
(c) Restated from 22% in 2023 and 21% in 2022 due to change in measurement methodology (see below).
(d) Restated from 61% in 2023 and 58% in 2022 due to change in measurement methodology (see below).

In 2024, Unilever implemented improvements in the measurement of our virgin plastic and recycled plastic packaging, as part of our continuous efforts to enhance the quality of our reporting. Measurement is now based on more accurate, granular and automated purchases data, and allows for improved consistency within our calculations. We have therefore restated our 2022 and 2023 virgin plastic (including the baseline), recycled plastic, and collect and process performance metrics to reflect these measurement improvements.

We have made progress across all our plastic goals in 2024. We increased our use of recycled plastic, driven by new innovation launches including Dove and Lux body washes in China and Cif cream cleaner in Turkey, as well as volume growth in our Power Brands, which already use higher levels of recycled plastic. The increase in recycled plastic use in our packaging contributed to the reduction in our virgin plastic footprint, alongside innovation projects such as the roll out of new lightweight Rexona and Axe roll-on and stick deodorant designs in our largest deodorants markets.

The proportion of our plastic packaging that is reusable, recyclable or compostable increased, driven by innovations including the launch of recyclable pumps for Vaseline bottles in North America and by the availability of more accurate data on recycling infrastructure. In 2024, we updated our 100% recyclable, reusable and compostable goal by splitting it into rigid packaging and flexible packaging. This was in recognition of the unique challenges linked to each format and therefore the different solutions required. Flexible plastic packaging remains an industry-wide challenge, with collection, processing and recycling infrastructure underdeveloped in many markets. Developing alternatives to flexible plastic packaging is our priority. This includes alternative packaging materials, formats and models. We know that alternative packaging formats and models, like reuse-refill, will take more time and systemic change to scale, which is why we are also developing material alternatives to flexible plastic. For this, we are increasing investment in materials science and technology, boosting our in-house expertise to develop new sustainable packaging materials and technologies, and working with our supply chain partners to bring these solutions to market.

In 2024, we helped to collect and process 93% of our plastic packaging footprint, representing significant progress towards our 2025 goal. The improvement was achieved through scaling up and broadening our collection and processing activities across markets, including onboarding new waste management partners in Brazil and expanding our existing partnership on community waste banks in Indonesia. Key markets driving our progress include Brazil, India, Indonesia, Thailand and Vietnam.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Resource Inflows

Description of resource inflows
The material resource inflows used in our own operations and upstream value chain are raw materials, packaging materials, and water:

- Raw materials used to produce our products include materials originating from agriculture and forestry, including palm-based oleochemicals and food ingredients, as well as chemicals which may originate from fossil fuels, minerals or metals extracted from the earth. Unilever's raw materials include biological materials which are derived from or produced by living organisms (e.g. crops, animals, bacteria and fungi).
- Packaging materials include plastic, paper and board, glass and aluminium, and both virgin and secondary materials (materials that are derived from the recycling of primary materials which are reprocessed and then reused).
- Water is used as an ingredient in our products and for our manufacturing processes.

Inflows of property, plant and equipment are not considered to be material.

Resource inflows metrics: Products and technical and biological materials used, including secondary materials
Measured based on tonnes of raw and packaging materials purchased for Unilever operations and collaborative manufacturing, and water consumed in Unilever operations.

Raw and packaging materials purchased by Unilever and packaging materials purchased by collaborative manufacturers supplying Unilever's Business Groups, are recorded based on supplier invoices and product specification information. Where supplier invoices or product specification information are not available for packaging materials purchased by third parties, volumes are estimated using extrapolation of existing data (representing circa 1% of total raw and packaging materials purchased by Unilever and third parties).
For water consumption volumes, refer to Water Consumption metrics on page 253.

Resource inflows metrics: Biological materials that are sustainably sourced
Measured based on tonnes of biological raw and packaging materials purchased by Unilever. Biological material volumes are calculated based on supplier invoices, and then mapped to tonnes of feedstock material e.g. chocolate is decomposed into x% cocoa, y% dairy and z% sugar. Water consumed in Unilever operations is not included in the measurement.

Sustainable sources are defined as either raw materials which are produced according to third-party certification and aligned to Unilever's Sustainable Agricultural Principles (48%); or purchased from non-sustainable sources but matched to credits which represent verified sustainably sourced raw materials (12%) e.g. soy (RTRS credits), cane sugar (Bonsucro credits) and RSPO credits for palm oil and palm kernel oil.

Resource inflows metrics	2024
Total weight of products and technical and biological materials used (million tonnes)[(a)]	32
Biological materials used that are sustainably sourced as a percentage of biological materials used (%)	60%
Total weight of secondary materials used (million tonnes)	1
Secondary material used as a percentage of total weight of products and technical and biological materials used (%)	2%

(a) Comprises 47% tonnes of raw and packaging materials purchased for Unilever operations and collaborative manufacturing and 53% water consumed in operations.

Resource Outflows

Products and materials

Description of resource outflows
Resource outflows include consumer products, the packaging materials used to contain or protect them, and waste materials. Consumer products include food, beauty, personal care and home care products. Packaging materials include plastic, paper and board, glass and aluminium.

Exclusions: Our products are designed to be consumed, such as food, or to deliver benefits to the consumer and then pass into wastewater, such as shampoo or laundry detergent. As such, repairability and durability are not relevant concepts.

Product and material metrics
Measured based on tonnes of packaging materials purchased for Unilever operations and collaborative manufacturing.

Packaging materials purchased by Unilever and collaborative manufacturers supplying Unilever's Business Groups are recorded based on supplier invoices and product specification information. Where supplier invoices or product specification information are not available for packaging materials purchased by third parties, volumes are estimated using extrapolation of existing data (representing circa 6% of total packaging materials purchased by Unilever and third parties).

Recyclability is assessed using data from various sources, such as governmental organisations (for recycling and recovery rates), industry consortiums and packaging recycling organisations. This reflects the technical potential to recycle a packaging material.

Exclusions: Product recyclability is not a materially relevant concept for our consumer products and is therefore excluded from the metric.

The percentage of our packaging that is recyclable using existing technology is set out below. Not all packaging that is technically recyclable will actually be recycled, due to a lack of infrastructure. Our goal relating to the 'actual recyclability' of plastic packaging is included on page 259 and our plastic packaging actions are outlined on page 258.

Product and material metrics	2024
Rate of recyclable content in packaging materials used by Unilever (%)	78%

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Waste

Description of waste composition
Waste streams relevant to the consumer goods sector include wastes from industrial processes, food waste and packaging waste.

Materials present in the waste generated by Unilever include raw materials used to manufacture products in various stages of processing, such as food ingredients; packaging materials, such as plastic and paper; and waste from production processes, such as boiler ash.

Waste metrics
Waste is measured for all manufacturing sites and the majority of logistics and other sites. This is based on documentation, provided by waste service providers, which breaks down the type of waste that has been collected, the amount, and the waste management route.

For the remaining sites, representing 5% of volumes, estimates are made for hazardous and non-hazardous waste based on measured sites and site headcount or pallet position. It is assumed that all estimated hazardous waste is directed to disposal by incineration without energy recovery and all estimated non-hazardous waste is directed to disposal by landfill.

Waste generated in own operations (thousands tonnes)	2024
Total waste generated	**731**
Hazardous waste diverted from disposal	25
For preparation for reuse	4
For recycling	11
For other recovery operations	10
Non-hazardous waste diverted from disposal	699
For preparation for reuse	196
For recycling	337
For other recovery operations	166
Hazardous waste directed to disposal	6
By incineration without energy recovery	4
By landfilling	2
By other disposal operations	0
Non-hazardous waste directed to disposal	1
By incineration without energy recovery	0
By landfilling	1
By other disposal operations	0
Non-recycled waste	**183**
Percentage of non-recycled waste (%)	25%
Total hazardous waste including radioactive waste	**31**

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Potential financial effects

We have considered our most material resource use and circular economy-related risks under two nature scenarios: High Nature Degradation and High Nature Preservation. Further detail on these scenarios is set out on page 254. The approach taken to this analysis is the same as the process set out in our climate scenario analysis on page 235, with the exception of the specific nature scenario selection.

The outcomes from this analysis are set out below.

EPR for packaging (transition risk)

Expansion of EPR schemes and plastic tax

				€bn impact on net profit (as a % of net revenue)		
Description	**Assumptions**	**Scenario**	**Risk type**	**2030**	**2039**	**2050**
The expansion of EPR schemes, globally or to countries currently considering a scheme. Additionally, within a High Nature Preservation scenario, the introduction of a global plastic tax.	**Gross risk** The costs relating to EPR schemes apply to all plastics within our packaging; plastic tax applies to virgin plastic only. ▪ High Nature Preservation: EPR schemes expand to all countries by 2030 and a global plastic tax is levied on virgin plastic production, growing from USD 0 per tonne in 2030 to USD 1,000 per tonne in 2050. ▪ High Nature Degradation: EPR schemes expand only to countries currently considering a scheme. **Net risk** ▪ Achieving our plastic goals reduces exposure to EPR costs and the volume of virgin plastic exposed to a potential tax.	**High Nature Preservation**	**Gross**	-0.5 (-0.8%)	-1.2 (-1.5%)	-2.8 (-2.6%)
			Net	-0.4 (-0.7%)	-0.9 (-1.1%)	-1.9 (-1.7%)
		High Nature Degradation	**Gross**	-0.4 (-0.7%)	-0.7 (-0.9%)	-1.5 (-1.4%)
			Net	-0.4 (-0.6%)	-0.7 (-0.8%)	-1.3 (-1.2%)

EPR for packaging (transition risk)

Increased bans on plastic packaging

Description	**Assumptions**	**Risk type**	**Description**
Increased bans on plastic packaging, affecting all markets in the High Nature Preservation scenario and some markets in the High Nature Degradation scenario.	**Gross risk** Plastic packaging bans are introduced in certain markets: ▪ High Nature Preservation: Global initiatives to phase out and ban some types of packaging, with viable alternatives made available. ▪ High Nature Degradation: Introduction of bans for some types of packaging before viable alternatives exist, in countries with high plastic pollution. **Net risk** ▪ Achieving our goals to reduce plastic packaging use, enhance recyclability, and improve waste collection, recycling, and reuse infrastructure.	**Gross**	**High Nature Preservation:** Global initiatives for the management of waste streams via EPR schemes are implemented by 2030. From 2030 onwards, additional global criteria to define bans for some types of packaging are established, increasing packaging costs where viable alternatives remain more expensive. **High Nature Degradation:** Country policies are fragmented; packaging bans are more likely in nations affected by high plastic pollution, reducing revenues in these markets.
		Net	**Both scenarios:** We achieve 100% reusable, recyclable or compostable plastic packaging goals by 2035 for flexibles, minimising exposure to bans and protecting revenues, while advocating for global rules and harmonised regulation.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

EU Taxonomy Disclosures

OVERVIEW

The EU Taxonomy regulation sets out the reporting obligations to be included in the sustainability statement. The regulation outlines certain activities, referred to as 'eligible' and 'aligned' activities. For the financial year 2024, businesses need to assess whether they have eligible and aligned activities within each of the six environmental objectives: i) climate change mitigation, ii) climate change adaptation, iii) sustainable use and protection of water and marine resources, iv) transition to a circular economy, v) pollution prevention and control, and vi) protection and restoration of biodiversity and ecosystems.

If the eligible activities are considered to make a substantial contribution to an objective and do no significant harm in accordance with the criteria set out in the regulations, then they are designated as 'aligned' as long as the business also meets a minimum set of criteria with respect to human rights, bribery and corruption, taxation and fair competition. Using the current list of eligible activities and the alignment criteria, we have reviewed the Group's turnover, capital expenditure and operating expenditure (as defined by the EU Taxonomy) to identify the extent of any eligible and aligned activities within our business. The outcome of our review is presented below.

The EU Taxonomy remains a work in progress and in creating the current list of environmentally sustainable activities, the European Commission has not yet considered the FMCG industry in which the Group operates, focusing instead on the more carbon-intensive industries where it believes there is the most potential for climate change mitigation or adaptation.

TURNOVER KPI

For the year ended 31 December 2024, none of our turnover related to eligible activities, as detailed in our consolidated income statement on page 138. Therefore, none of our turnover can be classified as aligned.

OPERATING EXPENDITURE KPI

As per the EU Taxonomy, operating expenditure is defined as directly incurred, non-capitalised costs relating to research and development, building renovations, short-term leases, or the repair and maintenance of property, plant and equipment. For the year ended 31 December 2024, we did not identify any material operating expenditure in respect to eligible activities. As a consequence, none of our operating expenditure can be classified as aligned.

CAPITAL EXPENDITURE KPI

For the year ended 31 December 2024, as set out in our consolidated financial statements, 15.1% of our capital expenditure related to eligible activities. This includes all additions to intangible assets as detailed in note 9 on page 160 and all additions to tangible assets (both leased and owned) as detailed in note 10 on page 163. Those additions include those resulting from business combinations and are before depreciation, amortisation and any re-measurements.

We have identified eligible activities that relate to i) climate change mitigation, iii) sustainable use and protection of water and marine resources and iv) transition to a circular economy. The majority of this relates to the acquisition of buildings as shown in the tables below. There are no eligible activities in respect of v) pollution prevention and control, and vi) protection and restoration of biodiversity and ecosystems.

We have determined that none of this eligible capital expenditure can be classified as aligned as they do not make a substantial contribution to climate change mitigation objective. The principal reason is that we do not have sufficiently detailed documentation to support the criteria.

We meet the minimum set of criteria with respect to human rights, corruption and bribery, taxation and fair competition. This has been determined by assessing our internal policies against the minimum criteria and reviewing any breaches or violations identified in the reporting period.

Taxonomy-eligible but not Taxonomy-aligned activities

	€ Million
Climate change mitigation	
4.1 – Electricity generation using solar photovoltaic technology	5.7
4.16 – Installation and operation of electric heat pumps	1.9
4.24 – Production of heat/cool from bioenergy	1.1
5.2 – Renewal of water collection, treatment and supply systems	1.0
6.5 – Transport by motorbikes, passenger cars and light commercial vehicles	3.1
7.1 – Construction of new buildings[(a)]	8.6
7.2 – Renovation of existing buildings[(a)]	21.6
7.3 – Installation, maintenance and repair of energy efficiency equipment	6.8
7.7 – Acquisition and ownership of buildings	385.4
8.1 – Data processing, hosting and related activities	1.3
Sustainable use and protection of water and marine resources	
2.1 – Water supply	1.3
Transition to a circular economy,	
5.1 – Repair, refurbishment and remanufacturing	0.9
Total Taxonomy-eligible but not Taxonomy-aligned activities	**438.7**

(a) Capital expenditure for those eligible activities are also eligible under the objective 'Transition to a circular economy' however they are all allocated to Climate Change to avoid double counting.

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Proportion of capital expenditure from products or services associated with Taxonomy-aligned economic activities – disclosure covering the year ended 31 December 2024

Financial year		2024		Substantial contribution criteria						DNSH criteria ('Does Not Significantly Harm')									
Economic activities (1)	Code (2)	Capital expenditure (3)	Proportion of capital expenditure, year 2024 (4)	Climate Change Mitigation (5)	Climate Change Adaption (6)	Water (7)	Pollution (8)	Circular Economy (9)	Biodiversity (10)	Climate Change Mitigation (11)	Climate Change Adaption (12)	Water (13)	Pollution (14)	Circular Economy (15)	Biodiversity (16)	Minimum safeguards (17)	Proportion of taxonomy aligned (A.1.) or eligible (A.2.) Capex 2023 (18)	Category enabling activity (19)	Category transitional activity (20)
		€ Million	%	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	in %	E	T
A. TAXONOMY-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES																			
A.1. Environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned)																			
Capital expenditure of environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned) (A.1)		0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	-%		
Of which enabling		0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	-%	E	
Of which transitional		0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	-%		T
A.2. Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities)																			
				N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL										
4.1 – Electricity generation using solar photovoltaic technology	CCM 4.1	5.7	0.2%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL								0.6%		
4.16 – Installation and operation of electric heat pumps	CCM 4.16	1.9	0.1%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL								0.1%		
4.24 – Production of heat/cool from bioenergy	CCM 4.24	1.1	0.1%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL								0.2%		
5.2 – Renewal of water collection, treatment and supply systems	CCM. 5.2	1.0	—%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL								—%		
6.5 – Transport by motorbikes, passenger cars and light commercial vehicles	CCM 6.5	3.1	0.1%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL								0.1%		
7.1 – Construction of new buildings	CCM 7.1, CE 3.1	8.6	0.3%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	EL	N/EL								—%		
7.2 – Renovation of existing buildings	CCM 7.2, CE 3.2	21.6	0.8%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	EL	N/EL								0.2%		
7.3 – Installation, maintenance and repair of energy efficiency equipment	CCM 7.3	6.8	0.2%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL								0.4%		
7.7 – Acquisition and ownership of buildings	CCM 7.7	385.4	13.3%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL								16.1%		
8.1 – Data processing, hosting and related activities	CCM 8.1	1.3	—%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL								—%		
2.1 – Water supply	WTR 2.1	1.3	—%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL								—%		
5.1 - Repair, refurbishment and remanufacturing	CE 5.1	0.9	—%	EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL								—%		
Capital expenditure of Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities) (A.2)		438.7	**15.1%**	**%**	**—%**	**%**	**—%**	**%**	**%**								17.7%		
A. Capital expenditure of Taxonomy-eligible activities (A.1+A.2)		**438.7**	**15.1%**	**%**	**—%**	**%**	**—%**	**%**	**%**								17.7%		
B .TAXONOMY-NON-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES																			
Capital expenditure of Taxonomy-non-eligible activities		2,464.1	**84.9%**																
TOTAL		2,902.8	**100%**																

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Proportion of operating expenses from products or services associated with Taxonomy-aligned economic activities – disclosure for the year ended 31 December 2024

Financial year	2024			Substantial contribution criteria						DNSH criteria ('Does Not Significantly Harm')									
Economic activities (1)	Code (2)	Operating expenses (3)	Proportion of operating expenses, year 2024 (4)	Climate Change Mitigation (5)	Climate Change Adaption (6)	Water (7)	Pollution (8)	Circular Economy (9)	Biodiversity (10)	Climate Change Mitigation (11)	Climate Change Adaption (12)	Water (13)	Pollution (14)	Circular Economy (15)	Biodiversity (16)	Minimum Safeguards (17)	Proportion of Taxonomy -aligned (A.1.) or -eligible (A.2.) operating expenses 2023 (18)	Category enabling activity (19)	Category transitional activity (20)
		€ Million	%	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	%	E	T
A. TAXONOMY-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES																			
A.1. Environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned)																			
Operating expenses of Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities) (A.2)	0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	-%		
Of which enabling	0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	-%	E	
Of which transitional	0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	-%		T
A.2. Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities)																			
				N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL										
Operating expenses of Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities) (A.2)	0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%										
A. Operating expenses of Taxonomy-eligible activities (A.1+A.2)	0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%										
B. TAXONOMY-NON-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES																			
Operating expenses of Taxonomy-non-eligible activities	1,546.0	100%																	
TOTAL	1,546.0	100%																	

ENVIRONMENTAL DISCLOSURES

Proportion of turnover from products or services associated with Taxonomy-aligned economic activities – disclosure for the year ended 31 December 2024

Financial year		2024		Substantial contribution criteria						DNSH criteria ('Does Not Significantly Harm')									
Economic activities (1)	Code (2)	Turnover (3)	Proportion of turnover 2024 (4)	Climate Change Mitigation (5)	Climate Change Adaption (6)	Water (7)	Pollution (8)	Circular Economy (9)	Biodiversity (10)	Climate Change Mitigation (11)	Climate Change Adaption (12)	Water (13)	Pollution (14)	Circular Economy (15)	Biodiversity (16)	Minimum Safeguards (17)	Proportion of Taxonomy -aligned (A.1.) or -eligible (A.2.) operating expenses, 2023 (18)	Category enabling activity (19)	Category transitional activity (20)
		€ Million	%	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y; N; N/EL	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	%	E	T
A. TAXONOMY-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES																			
A.1. Environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned)																			
Turnover of environmentally sustainable activities (Taxonomy-aligned) (A.1)		0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	-%		
Of which enabling		0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	-%	E	
Of which transitional		0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	-%		T
A.2. Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities)																			
				N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL	N/EL										
Turnover of Taxonomy-eligible but not environmentally sustainable activities (not Taxonomy-aligned activities) (A.2)		0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%								-%		
A. Turnover of Taxonomy-eligible activities (A.1+A.2)		0	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%	-%								-%		
B .TAXONOMY-NON-ELIGIBLE ACTIVITIES																			
Turnover of Taxonomy-non-eligible activities		60,761	**100%**																
TOTAL		60,761	**100%**																

Nuclear and fossil gas-related activities – disclosure for the year ended 31 December 2024

Nuclear energy-related activities		
1.	Unilever carries out, funds or has exposures to research, development, demonstration and deployment of innovative electricity generation facilities that produce energy from nuclear processes with minimal waste from the fuel cycle.	No
2.	Unilever carries out, funds or has exposures to construction and safe operation of new nuclear installations to produce electricity or process heat, including for the purposes of district heating or industrial processes such as hydrogen production, as well as their safety upgrades, using best available technologies.	No
3.	Unilever carries out, funds or has exposures to safe operation of existing nuclear installations that produce electricity or process heat, including for the purposes of district heating or industrial processes such as hydrogen production from nuclear energy, as well as their safety upgrades.	No
Fossil gas-related activities		
4.	Unilever carries out, funds or has exposures to construction or operation of electricity generation facilities that produce electricity using fossil gaseous fuels.	No
5.	Unilever carries out, funds or has exposures to construction, refurbishment and operation of combined heat/cool and power generation facilities using fossil gaseous fuels.	No
6.	Unilever carries out, funds or has exposures to construction, refurbishment and operation of heat generation facilities that produce heat/cool using fossil gaseous fuels.	No

Social Disclosures

Our business is supported by over 120,000 individuals working in factories, offices, distribution warehouses, R&D centres and customer-facing roles. The scope of our Social disclosures includes:

- **Own workforce:** Unilever employees, i.e. those in a direct employment relationship with Unilever according to national law or practice, and non-employees, i.e. contractors working for Unilever, such as self-employed individuals or those provided by employment agencies.
- **Value chain:** People employed by Unilever's business partners, as detailed in our general information on page 224.
- **Affected communities:** Individuals and local communities, including Indigenous people, living or working in areas impacted by Unilever's operations or value chain activities.
- **Consumers and end-users:** The 3.4 billion people who use our products every day.

SOCIAL MATERIAL IMPACTS, RISKS AND OPPORTUNITIES

The process for assessing and identifying our material impacts, risks and opportunities (IROs) is informed by our double materiality assessment as detailed in our general information on page 226.

In identifying our material IROs, we have considered all groups of people who are in the scope of our disclosures, as set out above, and considered all topics connected to our strategy and business model. The Board engages regularly with our workforce and Unilever's Supply Chain and Procurement teams maintain communication with our business partners, including those communities that may have been affected by Unilever operations or value chain. This feedback provides a key input into our double materiality assessment.

In March 2024, Unilever announced a comprehensive productivity programme, which is expected to affect 7,500 office-based roles globally. The programme aims to reduce complexity and drive efficiencies through technology-led interventions, process standardisation and centralisation. The impacts of this programme have been considered through our double materiality assessment as we recognise that the retention of talent throughout this period is an important factor when considering the risks to our workforce.

For each of our principal risks, including those relating to talent and the quality and safety of our products, we reviewed the risk management frameworks detailing risk descriptions and mitigating controls in place. These frameworks are updated annually and monitored throughout the year to identify changes in the risk profile.

When reviewing the social matters that are most material to us, we consider the concept of impact materiality to be interchangeable with saliency. Therefore, the identification of our material IROs considers our human rights impacts based on our salient human rights issues. These are defined by the United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights (UNGPs) as 'the human rights that are at risk of the most severe negative impacts through a company's activities or business relationships'.

In 2023, we completed an external review working with a human rights management consultancy, in consultation with our key stakeholder groups, including our affected communities, to assess both existing and emerging human rights issues. This review concluded that our salient human rights issues are:

- Bullying and harassment;
- Discrimination;
- Fair wages and income;
- Forced labour;
- Freedom of association and collective bargaining;
- Health;
- Land rights (including Indigenous rights); and
- Working hours.

Each of these issues is viewed through multiple lenses, including gender, climate transition impacts and type of operations, to understand the influence that these have on access to human rights. We aim to identify, understand and assess potential and actual impacts to people, as well as the root causes of impacts, so that these are effectively addressed. We also work to prevent potential impacts from becoming actual impacts, while monitoring for new and emerging human rights issues. This is detailed further in our approach to human rights section on page 270.

We regularly review human rights issues to ensure our approach remains focused on saliency. While child labour is not one of Unilever's global salient human rights issues, it remains a key focus at a regional and commodity-specific level, such as child labour prevention initiatives in our cocoa supply chain in Ghana and Côte d'Ivoire.

Our Business Group strategies incorporate processes for identifying potential impacts, risks and opportunities related to our consumers. These strategies are supported by our Unmissable Brand Superiority framework and the 6Ps – product, packaging, proposition, promotion, place and pricing – which drive brand innovation. Product safety is fundamental to our business and is governed by our Safe Product Framework. This framework includes assessing raw materials, product design and development, and manufacturing processes, with special consideration for vulnerable populations where relevant. Customer, channel (including marketing) and regulatory risks (e.g. sugar taxes) are also identified and managed through our enterprise risk processes.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

The output of our 2024 DMA for our social impacts, risks and opportunities is included below:

OWN WORKFORCE AND WORKERS IN THE VALUE CHAIN

Material impact, risk or opportunity		Description
Talent	Risk (OO)	Unilever's success depends on our ability to attract, develop and retain diverse talent, especially in competitive emerging markets. It is crucial to maintain a skilled and adaptable workforce. Failure to do so could make it more difficult to manage the business and could adversely affect operations and financial results. We recognise the importance of cultivating a strong reputation for skills development to help position Unilever as a top employer.
Capability building across our value chain to improve livelihoods †	Positive Impact (VC)	Unilever supports people in our value chain, including smallholder farmers, to improve their livelihoods. This includes building capability around employment practices and income diversification.
Salient human rights issues		
Bullying and harassment	Negative Impact (OO) (VC)	Bullying and harassment are more likely to arise where there is an imbalance of power in a relationship or where people are in a situation of vulnerability. In addition, this may happen where the prevailing culture, context or law discriminates against certain groups. Bullying and harassment may occur within our own operations and value chain, which could have a significant negative impact on an individual's physical and mental wellbeing, their families and the wider community.
Discrimination	Negative Impact (OO) (VC)	Discrimination is the absence of equality of opportunity and treatment, and occurs when a person is treated differently on the basis of protected characteristics.[1] Discrimination may occur in our own operations and value chain. In workplaces, discrimination may occur in the processes leading up to hiring and following termination of employment, as well as during employment. Along with significant impacts on the individual, discrimination has wider social and economic consequences.
Forced labour	Negative Impact (OO) (VC)	Forced labour is defined as 'all work or service which is exacted from any person under the threat of a penalty and for which the person has not offered himself or herself voluntarily'. While some situations are immediately identifiable as forced labour (such as being forced to work through the use of violence), others are more subtle (such as debt bondage, retention of identity papers or involuntary overtime). Forced labour has significant physical, mental and economic impacts on individuals and could occur in our own operations or value chain, in particular where workers utilise the services of recruitment agencies to secure a job.
Fair wages[2] and income	Negative Impact (OO) (VC)	Without receiving a fair wage or income, people are unable to meet their basic needs. Providing employees and workers in the value chain with fair wages or incomes, including payment of a living wage, can have a significant impact on their livelihoods.
Working hours	Negative Impact (OO) (VC)	The number of hours worked, the way in which they are organised, and the availability of rest periods can significantly affect not only the quality of work, but also mental and physical health as well as income. Workers in our own operations or our value chain may be impacted by longer working hours. Workers in our value chain may be particularly impacted by longer working hours, especially where wages are low and the work is performed on an informal or seasonal basis (such as agriculture).
Health	Negative Impact (OO) (VC)	Everyone has the right to a clean, healthy and sustainable environment. Negative impacts on health may occur within our own operations, value chain and communities in which we operate, including from poor health and safety processes and unsafe working conditions.
Freedom of association and collective bargaining	Negative Impact (OO) (VC)	All workers should be free to form or join a union of their choice, seek representation and collectively bargain, all without the fear of intimidation, harassment or obtaining prior approvals. Lack of freedom of association may occur within our own operations and value chain, particularly where there are local laws restricting these rights.

1. Protected characteristics include race, age, role, gender, gender identity, colour, religion, country of origin, sexual orientation, marital status, dependents, disability, social class, political views or any other class protected by law.
2. A fair wage or income supports an individual's right to adequate living standards. Fair wages are determined using multiple dimensions, including consideration of the hours worked, the pay systems used, the information workers receive in advance about their pay, and how this information is communicated. A living wage is the remuneration a worker receives for a standard working week in a particular location, sufficient to afford a decent standard of living for the worker and their family.

OO Own Operations
VC Value Chain
† Entity-Specific Disclosure

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

AFFECTED COMMUNITIES

Material impact, risk or opportunity		Description
Salient human rights issues		
Land rights, including Indigenous rights	Negative Impact (OO) (VC)	Land is a source of livelihood for many and is also linked with people's identities, culture and social status, which are protected by legal or customary rights. Communities connected to the areas where we operate, source, and conduct business may be affected by land rights issues. Our operations or our value chain actors could be associated with land transactions involving land appropriation or insufficient consultations with rightsholders.

CONSUMERS AND END-USERS

Material impact, risk or opportunity		Description
Safe products	Risk (OO) (VC)	Unsafe products could result in financial loss as a result of: ▪ Product formulation and packaging not meeting Unilever's safety standards; ▪ Formulation ingredients and packaging being accidentally or maliciously contaminated, compromising product integrity and potentially impacting the consumer; or ▪ Product labelling not aligning with laws and regulations, or lacking transparency, resulting in consumers not having the relevant information to make decisions about our products or being at risk of harm to their health.
Marketing to children	Negative Impact (VC)	Inappropriate marketing to children can lead to children increasingly being exposed to advertising of foods high in sugar, fat or salt, particularly through children's widespread use of social media. This may contribute to childhood obesity epidemic.
Nutritional product quality †	Risk (VC)	Regulatory restrictions may be imposed on the sale and marketing of food products that do not meet certain nutritional requirements. In many markets, consumers are also increasingly focused on products that combine great taste and health with limited salt, sugar, saturated fats and calories, as well as provide positive nutrition such as proteins, vitamins and minerals, fibre and vegetables. While we are diversifying our product portfolio to respond to new demands and increased restrictions, this could impact our revenue growth in the short term.
Product innovation as a response to changing demand †	Opportunity (VC)	Consumers are becoming more aware of sustainability issues and there is a growing demand for sustainable products that do not compromise on performance or affordability. Unilever's Research and Development function continues to focus on and innovate products that respond to these challenges, which provides an opportunity to create a competitive advantage and revenue growth.

OO Own Operations
VC Value Chain
† Entity-Specific Disclosure

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

APPROACH TO HUMAN RIGHTS

Our commitment to respect human rights extends across our operations and value chain. Following the operational principles of the UNGPs, we seek to identify, address and remediate potential and actual human rights impacts.

Our human rights due diligence considers where potential or actual impacts are most severe, and encompasses a wide range of rightsholders including:

- Our employees and workers at our own sites, including factories, offices, warehouses and research and development laboratories (own workforce).
- Workers employed by our business partners, including manufacturing facilities, laboratories and refineries, as well as professional service providers (value chain).
- Agricultural workers and smallholder farmers growing and harvesting crops as ingredients in our products (value chain).
- Drivers and transport operators who ensure our products reach our customers (value chain).
- Retail employees selling our products to customers (value chain).
- Individuals and communities that live in and around our own sites and those of our business partners (affected communities).
- Those impacted by our brands and our products (consumers).

Human rights policies

Unilever's Human Rights Policy Statement is a comprehensive framework developed in line with the UNGPs, the International Bill of Human Rights,[1] and the principles concerning fundamental rights set out in the International Labour Organization's (ILO) Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work. We support the OECD Guidelines for Multinational Enterprises, which provide voluntary principles and standards for responsible business conduct, including employment and industrial relations and guidance on effective human rights due diligence.

Our Human Rights Policy Statement outlines our approach to embedding respect for human rights into how we operate and recognises the importance of engagement with rightsholders, particularly those who may be at greater risk of negative human rights impacts. This includes women, migrant workers, under-represented communities and human rights defenders.

Own workforce

As detailed in our general information section on page 229, Unilever's Code and Code policies apply to all material sustainability matters, including Human Rights.

Our Respect, Dignity and Fair Treatment Code policy sets out how we will respect employees' human rights by:

- Recruiting, employing and promoting employees on the sole basis of the qualifications and abilities needed for the work to be performed.
- Not engaging in any direct or indirect behaviour that could be construed as harassment or bullying.
- Providing employees with a living wage, ensuring that they can meet their everyday needs.
- Not using any form of forced, compulsory, trafficked or child labour.
- Respecting the dignity of the individual and the right of employees to freedom of association and collective bargaining.

Our Occupational Health & Safety Code policy sets out our individual and shared responsibilities for health and safety. Team leaders have overall operational responsibility for health and safety and must:

- establish and maintain appropriate systems;
- identify and manage hazards and risks;
- report incidents in line with mandatory KPIs (incident reporting, process safety incidents, fire incidents and safe travel); and
- ensure appropriate communications and training is provided to our own workforce.

We expect all employees to take responsibility for their safety and those around them by acting in accordance with the Code.

Value chain

Unilever's business partners are required to follow a supplier code of conduct, outlined in the Responsible Partner Policy (RPP). This includes meeting or exceeding integrity and ethics, human rights and environment-related requirements, and addressing any negative impacts that are identified. The Human Rights Principles of the RPP are aligned with the relevant ILO Conventions and include requirements that cover all of our salient human rights issues, including forced labour (human trafficking), and child labour. The RPP also requires that business partners have systems and processes in place to ensure they are not at risk of breaching the RPP.

Business partners are mandated to cascade equivalent requirements within their supply chain and carry out their own human rights due diligence. In addition to the RPP, Unilever's People & Nature Policy requires in-scope third parties to:

- Conduct human rights due diligence (HRDD) within their own operations and supply chains.
- Develop and embed effective management systems to meet the requirements of the RPP and People & Nature Policy.
- Demonstrate compliance with the policy's principles through independent verification.

Further information on the policies that apply to our business partners is included in our Environmental policies section on page 232.

Affected communities

The RPP sets out our expectations of business partners regarding the rights and title to the property and land of individuals and local communities, including Indigenous peoples. Our People & Nature Policy outlines our recognition of Indigenous peoples and local communities, and our support for open dialogue and communication channels enabling all voices to be heard.

In 2023, we published our Principles in Support of Human Rights Defenders (HRDs), acknowledging their important role, particularly those active in the communities where we operate and source from. These principles recognise the vulnerability of HRDs to potential and actual impacts and the need for safe and meaningful dialogue with them.

Human rights governance

Our approach is to embed respect for human rights across our business by implementing the UNGPs. Our human rights governance and policy implementation is led from the top, overseen by our CEO and supported by the ULE. The ULE is consulted on human rights issues where the severity of a potential or actual impact is high, where a business-critical decision needs to be taken, or where substantial financial investment may be required to address an impact.

The Unilever Board of Directors oversees policies in relation to the Company's due diligence actions and considers inputs from various stakeholders. Additional board-level oversight of the Responsible Partner Policy is provided by the Corporate Responsibility Committee.

We continue to embed responsibility for our human rights commitment across all parts of our business. Central business functions, including the Sustainability, Procurement and Legal teams, provide guidance and support to respond to our salient human rights issues. This includes capability building, as well as identifying potential and actual human rights impacts, and creating action plans to prevent, mitigate and remediate potential and actual impacts. We also collaborate with business partners, peers, industry associations, civil society and others to coordinate efforts and promote collective industry change.

Engaging on human rights impacts

Engagement with rightsholders and relevant stakeholders is an essential part of our approach to identifying and assessing potential and actual human rights impacts both within our own operations and our value chain. We engage with stakeholders in a variety of ways, both directly and through credible proxies, including conducting interviews with direct and third-party workers during site audit processes and human rights impact assessments. Further information on engagement with rightsholders is included on page 74.

We also use technology solutions, including mobile-hosted apps such as diginex and Quizrr, to gather workers' views, provide value chain workers with access to learning materials, and help them become more aware of their rights. In addition, we engage with rightsholders via grievance mechanisms to understand concerns and issues and, where appropriate, provide remedy.

We work extensively with trade unions (IUF and IndustriAll), including through joint working groups and formal consultations, as well as through the day-to-day interactions that our leadership teams have with union representatives in the workplace. The Memorandum of Understanding that we have with the IUF and IndustriAll confirms our commitment to biannual meetings and communications between meetings as required. These meetings are an engagement between Unilever's senior executives, industrial relations leaders and union representatives, and allow us to address human and trade union rights arising within our operations and set the tone for local management/trade union relations.

1. Consisting of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights, and the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

Human rights due diligence

We apply a standard approach to human rights due diligence for all our operations. In cases where issues of violence and conflict are identified, we carry out heightened human rights due diligence. We have adopted elements of the Voluntary Principles on Security and Human Rights and are signatories to the UN Global Compact Business for Peace Initiative. We adhere to strict security standards for our facilities and have performance measures in place to ensure that our approach is appropriate for the situation. Where there is a risk of Unilever causing, contributing to, or being linked to potential or actual impacts to both people and conflict situations, we carry out heightened human rights due diligence. This follows established internal processes to determine the most appropriate course of action, including escalating recommendations to senior leaders when required.

Where issues are identified at a business partner level, we engage with them to create and implement corrective action plans and build their awareness and capability on the relevant issue in line with the UNGPs. However, there are cases where Unilever will cease sourcing from a business partner if they are unwilling or unable to address the issue. In 2024, we developed internal guidelines for responsible disengagement as a reference document that teams across the business can use when making commercial decisions. The guidelines, which align with the OECD Guidelines for Multinational Enterprises, includes tools that ensure consideration is given to the potential impacts to people in our value chains when considering exiting a country, region or sector.

Human rights due diligence is also integral to our mergers and acquisitions process. During the pre-acquisition phase, we assess the robustness of policies, processes and management systems to ensure respect for human rights both within the entity's operations and throughout its value chain. Post-acquisition, we conduct onboarding processes that include developing a corrective action plan with the new entity to address gaps identified during the pre-acquisition phase and integrating the new entity into Unilever's compliance systems.

Taking action to address potential and actual human rights impacts

Unilever responds to identified negative human rights impacts with consideration of several factors, including the location of the issue (own operations or value chain) and our leverage. Our actions to address potential human rights impacts, often carried out in partnership with peer companies and expert partners, include:

- Embedding effective management systems across our own operations;
- Delivering training and capability building; and
- Participating in advocacy and multi-stakeholder collaborations to address root causes and promote systemic change.

We have created a structured approach to addressing our salient human rights issues through our framework on salient issues. The purpose of the framework is to:

- Ensure our approach to each salient issue follows a similar model;
- Provide a global framework for each issue from which local approaches can be adapted;
- Enable us to address issues in a consistent manner with consolidated reporting;
- Define clearer articulation and coordination across issues and areas of intervention;
- More easily prioritise action and resources; and
- Share clear impact assessment metrics and KPIs internally and measure/report on progress.

For each issue identified, the framework captures who is impacted, how many people are affected, the root cause of the issues, the vision and outcome we want to deliver, and the targeted area of intervention. Examples of actions taken in 2024 include:

- Partnering with an external provider to develop a programme aimed at strengthening business partners' human rights due diligence and improving workers' access to their rights. The programme was launched in Thailand, India, Mexico, and Brazil. We partnered with &Wider and 60 decibels to collect baseline data so we can track improvements over time.
- Collaborating with other brand members of the AIM-Progress Responsible Recruitment Working Group and human rights consultancy Embode to continue executing the Ganapati Project. This included providing training and advisory services to help suppliers manage and update recruitment practices and improve communication channels.
- Partnering with Coca-Cola, the International Organization for Migration, and diginex, supported by the Bonsucro Impact Fund, to gather insights from sugarcane sector workers on their experiences and day-to-day work life. Using this data, diginex aims to understand workers' challenges and influence policy development, helping to identify how factors such as gender, migration status and other variables may influence their potential exploitation.

Monitoring actions relating to human rights

We publish regular updates on our actions to manage potential and actual human rights impacts through our website, Unilever.com. Additionally, we publish business partner audit reports to track the progress of our value chain monitoring activities.

We take steps to monitor the effectiveness of our policies in embedding respect for human rights both within our own operations and across our value chain. This is managed through a number of programmes and committees, including the Global Code and Policy Committee for our own operations, and the Procurement Business Integrity Committee for our supply chain.

We have established a human rights impact measurement framework to consistently report on the impact of our work and the effectiveness of our human rights due diligence approach. We are also an active member of the AIM-Progress Impact Measurement Working Group, with the goal of aligning on common impact KPIs to simplify reporting and reduce the burden on suppliers for data collection. Data will be published regularly through our human rights reporting to show progress against these impact measures.

Modern slavery

To meet the requirements of the Modern Slavery Act 2015, we publish our Modern Slavery Statement annually, which is approved by the Board. This statement explains the steps taken to prevent, detect and respond to modern slavery impacts in our business and value chain. We take a multidimensional approach to identifying and understanding potential and actual forced labour impacts considering several sources, including: external risk indicators calculated by Verisk Maplecroft based on country-level analysis of forced labour risk; insights from teams in local markets; supplier self-assessments through our Responsible Sourcing Programme; and from carrying out heightened human rights due diligence where appropriate. In 2024, our work was mainly focused in Malaysia and Thailand, in addition to continuing projects in India and Indonesia. We also began developing action plans for Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates, which we are implementing in 2025.

We disclose data about audit findings concerning potential and actual modern slavery and forced labour impacts at our business partners' sites in our annual Modern Slavery Statement. Additionally, we publish audit findings related to indicators of child labour identified at Business Partner sites in our Responsible Partner Policy audit update. This is discussed further on page 280 in the Workers in the Value Chain section.

Metrics relating to severe human rights incidents in our own operations, including incidents of forced labour, are included in our Own Workforce disclosures on page 278.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

Own Workforce

IMPACT, RISK AND OPPORTUNITY MANAGEMENT

Our material Social impacts, risks and opportunities resulting from the double materiality assessment (DMA) and the process by which these were identified are detailed on page 267.

Policies

Unilever's Code and Code Policies set out the global standards of behaviour that we expect all employees to adhere to. They emphasise our belief in a workplace where there is mutual trust and respect for human rights and include specific non-retaliation policies for anyone who raises concerns or alleged breaches of the Code. We cover this in more detail in our Governance disclosures on page 287.

The Code Policies also detail how we manage our material IROs. In particular, the Respect, Dignity and Fair Treatment, and Occupational Health and Safety Code policies set out how we respect our employees and their responsibilities towards each other. Further information is available in the Human Rights policies section on page 270.

Non-employees (excluding contractors covered under the Code) are required to adhere to Unilever's Responsible Partnership Policy (RPP).

Engaging with own workforce and workforce representatives

Engaging with our own workforce

Unilever is committed to proactively engaging with our employees globally. We recognise that our people have first-hand knowledge of our business, as well as direct contact with our stakeholders. As a result, our people are well positioned to give valuable insights and feedback on all elements of our business, including identifying impacts on the workforce, and business risks and opportunities.

As set out in the Board's Workforce Engagement Policy, we strive to ensure engagement with our people is strategic and meaningful. This means workforce engagement activities:

- are planned in advance for the year to align with the agenda for Board meetings;
- cover our entire workforce demographic in terms of geography, Business Group, function, length of service, diversity and work level/ seniority;
- provide opportunities for employees to engage directly with senior leaders, including our Non-Executive Directors;
- use a variety of methods, including face-to-face sessions, employee representatives, surveys and town hall meetings;
- focus on Unilever's strategic priorities and associated policies (i.e. sustainability, living wage, flexible employment models, skills training and diversity goals); and
- provide an opportunity for our people to raise matters that are relevant to them.

The ULE and the Board actively participate in workforce engagement sessions, listening to employees and discussing focus topics. In 2024, Non-Executive Directors participated in six workforce engagement events covering a wide range of topics, including reward and performance culture, inclusion, sustainability, and Unilever as an employer of choice. In addition, around 50 employee events were led by the CEO and Unilever Leadership Executive (ULE), as well as by business unit, regional or functional leaders. These included regular interactive global 'town hall' sessions with our CEO and ULE members, in which our senior leaders inform our employees about our Growth Action Plan and our progress during the year, and answer questions on issues of concern to our workforce, such as the productivity programme. Leaders also make periodic in-person visits to our sites around the world to meet with our people and seek their feedback. At a market level, we hold regular local leader-led virtual town hall meetings to engage with employees on relevant topics and issues.

Our annual UniVoice survey is a key tool to understand employee sentiment. It covers a broad range of topics including engagement, leadership, line management, business integrity, growth mindset, purpose and inspiration, wellbeing, career development and learning, operational effectiveness, and diversity and inclusion. Almost 100,000 employees took part in our UniVoice survey in 2024 (75% engagement in offices and 83% in factories). We publish highlights of the UniVoice survey in our Annual Report, and leaders within the business are responsible for taking follow-up actions. We also undertake a more frequent interim 'UniPulse' survey, allowing more focused enquiry around key themes, such as the ongoing productivity programme.

Engaging with workers' representatives

As set out in our approach to human rights on page 270, we work extensively with trade unions through joint working groups and formal consultations.

We have both formal and informal consultations with unions and works councils, in addition to the day-to-day interactions our leadership teams have with union representatives in our factories. During 2024, the main topics of discussion with our employee representatives, including with the Unilever European Works Council, have been focused on the company's Growth Action Plan, embedding the performance edge to our culture, and the planning and preparation for the separation of our Ice Cream business, as well as wider restructuring to achieve productivity gains. There have also been specific consultations on some changes to the European factory network and the divestment of Elida Beauty.

Effectiveness of engagement

We regularly report workforce engagement activities at Board meetings to ensure feedback is factored into decision-making where appropriate. This includes the completion rate and outcomes of key engagement surveys, how such engagement informs the decisions it takes, and informal feedback from employees on the effectiveness of engagement sessions. A summary of Unilever's workforce engagement activities for 2024 is set out in our Governance Report on page 72.

Processes to remediate impacts and channels to raise concerns

Unilever's Speak Up processes and remediation mechanisms are detailed in our Governance section on page 288. This includes the channels for our own workforce to raise concerns, the investigation and resolution processes in place, as well as non-retaliation policies. In addition to the Speak Up channels, we have established formal processes globally to handle HR grievances relating to a variety of workplace concerns. All material issues are channelled through the Speak Up process and tracked to closure. Any HR grievances that are not escalated through the Speak Up channels, i.e. not a breach of the Code and Code policies, are not considered in scope for this disclosure.

Information regarding our approach to identifying and remediating actual or potential human rights impacts is included on page 271.

Managing impacts and risks related to own workforce

Talent

We are the FMCG employer of choice for graduates and early career talent in nine of our 19 biggest markets, as well as having the highest number of followers on LinkedIn for our industry by the end of 2024. This ability to attract, develop and retain a diverse range of skilled people is critical in the delivery of our strategy and failure to do so could impact the continued success and growth of our business. To maintain this talent pipeline and our reputation as an employer of choice, we believe it is critical for Unilever to continue focusing on the area outlined below.

Building an inclusive and diverse workforce

Our goal is to foster an inclusive workplace culture that unlocks the potential of diverse teams to deliver high performance. To advance this goal among our people, we are:

- building a workforce that represents the communities we serve;
- designing policies, processes and practices such as our Framework for Fair Compensation policy; and
- creating a culture where everyone belongs.

In 2024, our efforts have focused on three key areas:

- Advancing our diversity and inclusion practices: We have developed compelling engagement to celebrate International Awareness Days that support Unilever's culture and enable us to continue to build core diversity and inclusion capabilities. We continue to build employee networks across markets and functions to enable effective collaboration internationally, such as proUd.
- Focus on women representation at senior levels: Our talent commitment is always ensuring we have the best talent for the role. We continue our focus on increasing women's representation at senior leadership levels through having a balanced slate of candidates in our appointments process as called out in our Talent Appointment Principles.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

- Commitment to complying to our core regulatory obligations: We are building on our core regulatory reporting in this area through key external indices, such as the Parker Review and FTSE Women Leaders Review, under which we disclose the number of the Board, ULE and ULE direct reports who identify as ethnic minorities.

Employee wellbeing

We support our employees' purposeful, physical, mental and emotional wellbeing through a variety of programmes. A localised network of trained Mental Health Champion volunteers is in place and all employees have access to a confidential Employee Assistance Programme. We consider flexible working to be another lever to improve the health and wellbeing of our workforce while managing business demands. Our approach is a combination of global and local initiatives, supported by local flexible working policies that embed geography-specific legislation and cultural working styles.

Examples of wellbeing initiatives we run to support employees are:

- Psychological safety training: We consider psychological safety to be a key enabler in dialling up a performance culture and a fundamental driver of wellbeing. We developed training for line managers to build awareness of psychological safety. In 2024, over 2,500 line managers and 1,900 employees completed the training. Our psychological safety score remains steady at a healthy 79% favourability in our annual UniVoice employee survey.
- Healthier U programme: Our global health programme supports our employees' whole-person health and wellbeing. This data-driven approach offers tailored interventions and activities aimed at building healthy habits to support employees in addressing health risks. To date, Healthier U has reached over 50,000 employees across 56 countries.
- Hybrid working: In 2023, we launched our Intentionally Hybrid programme, which translates the core principles of trust, flexibility, moments that matter and performance into actions that ensure effective hybrid working, benefiting both Unilever and its employees. Through this programme, we provide guidelines and toolkits to help teams agree effective hybrid ways of working and be intentional about flexible work patterns.
- U-Work: The U-Work model offers flexible employment arrangements, giving employees the freedom associated with contract roles while still providing the security and benefits typically linked to permanent roles. This allows us to access a pool of skilled people familiar with Unilever without the hidden costs that often come with finding freelance workers. The U-Work model has now been launched in ten countries, and we plan to expand it during 2025, as well as introducing other new employment models to meet different needs.

Competitive reward

To attract and retain skilled people, Unilever offers competitive reward packages. Annually, we conduct a total reward benchmarking exercise in the countries where we operate. This process involves reviewing our pay and benefits against external peer groups, primarily consisting of other FMCG, as well as industries from which we aim to attract talent, such as technology and pharmaceuticals. This helps to ensure our reward packages remain competitive against the market for pay, benefits, short-term incentives (annual bonus) and long-term incentives (share plans).

Learning

Unilever's strategy relies on a skilled workforce, making continuous upskilling and reskilling essential for business success and talent risk mitigation. In 2024, we have continued to focus on developing critical business skills to manage risks and build a strong talent pipeline, including:

- Customer Strategy & Planning (CSP): Through the CSP Accelerator, we identified four key skills to better enable CSP teams to succeed – digital commerce, commercial strategy, data literacy and category growth management. Upskilling of the CSP teams was provided through a global CSP knowledge programme. Additionally, top CSP leaders underwent individual assessments to create personalised development plans based on skills, performance, experience and leadership. Informed by the collective results of these assessments, we established the CSP Nexus programme to address common skill gaps and provide a leadership forum to enable global CSP leaders to connect and learn from each other.
- For office-based teams, we continued to develop stronger data sets on employee skills (our 'skills signal') by inferring skill levels through successful completion of flagship learning programmes, skills development discussions during quarterly check-ins with line managers, and regularly updating skills profiles. This data helps identify suitable opportunities, shape development plans, and future-proof the employability of our people.
- To strengthen leadership, we launched two new Accelerator Programmes: the work level (WL) 2C Accelerator for those with potential to step into WL3 roles and the General Manager (GM) Accelerator for leaders with potential for a GM role within the next 18 months. We launched our WL3 coaching programme, with over 1,600 directors completing a six-month coaching programme since it started. Our flagship WL4+ programme has engaged 180 leaders since 2019, incorporating real-world business challenges and market visits to enhance leadership skills
- AI and data skills: In 2024, we invested significantly in AI and data skills, with nearly 20,000 employees engaging with AI learning programmes.

Bullying and harassment, discrimination, forced labour and working hours

Unilever's Respect, Dignity and Fair Treatment Code policy sets out our commitments in relation to bullying and harassment, discrimination, forced labour and working hours. Any allegations of breaches regarding these commitments would be treated as a Code breach.

As described in our Governance disclosures, we conduct annual mandatory Code training for all employees. This regularly includes training on how to recognise bullying and harassment, discrimination, forced labour and working hours breaches. We have further mandatory training (such as sexual harassment training) in a number of countries in which we operate, in response to regulatory requirements. Training is also made available to employees on subjects such as how to recognise forced labour, our working hours policy, gender diversity, unconscious bias, and race and ethnicity inclusion. This is delivered through various mechanisms, including cross-function 'learning hours' and our Degreed global learning platform.

Fair wages and income

Unilever's Respect, Dignity and Fair Treatment Code policy codifies that all employees should be paid a fair wage. In 2016, Unilever committed to pay a living wage to employees by 2020. By the end of 2020, all direct employees i.e. those on our global HR system, were paid at or above a certified living wage level. In 2021, we were awarded our first global accreditation as a living wage employer from the Fair Wage Network, achieved again in 2024.

To maintain this standard, Unilever annually reviews direct employees' pay and benefits against a certified independent living wage calculation. If any employees are found to be below the living wage, we review and work with local leaders to correct this. Additionally, Unilever continuously evolves its policies and practices to promote living wages within the broader business environment.

The Unilever Framework for Fair Compensation 2022, governed by the Chief People Officer, outlines the company's position on wages for direct employees globally. It includes principles such as fair and liveable compensation, market-based compensation, and non-discrimination in compensation. This framework is publicly available and applied through various compensation policies and procedures in the countries where we operate.

We also provide training opportunities through platforms like Degreed to help employees understand the company's approach to the living wage, why it is important and how it is implemented within Unilever.

Health

Unilever is committed to providing healthy and safe working conditions for all its global employees. Health and safety is a key part of our Code and integral to our way of working. It is deeply embedded in our culture, governance and operating structures, with accountability at all levels. In our own operations, we aim for Zero Harm, which underpins everything we do as a business.

Safety standards and communications

Unilever is committed to continuously improving health and safety performance, with strong safety leadership being key. In 2024, our Together for Safety programme continued, inviting our CEO and top leaders to visit our manufacturing sites with a specific focus on safety. These visits demonstrate our leadership's commitment to safety and encourage people to speak up about unsafe behaviour.

Our 'Safety First' culture is embedded through activities like our annual Safety Day, the Safety Moments programme (building safety into our employees' day-to-day work lives), and our annual Global Safety Awards, which celebrate the outstanding work of our teams across the world. The 2024 Safety Day campaign focused on our safety on the road and raised awareness for how being tired, in a rush or frustrated impacts our safety. The campaign reached over 83,000 employees via our internal communications platform, with approximately 72,000 employees reached through the CEO's Safety Day video. In line with our ambition to have impact beyond our borders, we promoted our safety values on LinkedIn.

Compliance with all applicable legislation and regulations is a mandatory minimum, with our safety standards aligning with obligations set out in the international standard for occupational

health and safety management, ISO 45001. Safety in our manufacturing sites is critical for us and therefore our safety guidance is built into our Unilever Manufacturing System. Manufacturing sites develop individual plans that drive improvements based on their particular risk profile, such as hazardous substances, and electrical or mechanical risks. Following any incident or the identification of a hazard or risk, follow-up communications, lessons learned, and training are also shared with our employees and third parties.

Freedom of association and collective bargaining

As set out in our approach to human rights section on page 270, our Code reflects our commitments with regard to freedom of association and collective bargaining and, in practice, we work extensively with trade unions, through joint working groups and formal consultations, on a multitude of different topics that impact our employees. Any allegation of a breach of our commitment in this area would be dealt with as a Code breach.

METRICS AND TARGETS

For metrics relating to our own workforce, employee data captured in the global HR system is extracted as at 31 December 2024. Additional data points (headcount data for approximately 5% of employees plus manual data points) have been collected as at 31 October 2024; any significant changes to 31 December 2024 are reviewed.

Targets

No formal targets have been defined for our own workforce with respect to the impacts, risks and opportunities identified in our sustainability statement. Instead, Unilever measures progress against our actions through a series of internal measures, including the use of oversight committees such as the Corporate Responsibility Committee, Audit Committee, the ULE, and the Global Code and Policy Committee which has visibility of Code breaches. Progress is also assessed through our UniVoice scores in areas such as diversity and inclusion, safety and wellbeing (see Engaging with our own workforce). Where relevant, progress against our actions has been included in the sections above.

Characteristics of the undertaking's employees

Employee headcount by geography, gender and type

All Unilever employees are categorised into the following types, applying the following definitions in the absence of national law or practice:
- Permanent employee: A full-time or part-time employee who works for and is paid directly by Unilever without a set end date of employment.
- Temporary employee: An employee who works for and is paid directly by Unilever for a defined period, i.e. is on the payroll. This includes temporary and fixed-term workers, interns, apprentices, and seasonal or casual employees.
- Non-guaranteed hours employee: Those employed without a guarantee of a minimum or fixed number of working hours. Examples may include casual employees, those with zero-hour contracts, and on-call employees.

The total number of Unilever employees is classified using the year-end headcount by:
- Employee type: recorded as of the hire date or when there is a change in type.
- Gender: based on official identification or self-assignment. 'Not reported' includes those categorised as 'Other', 'Unspecified' or 'Prefer not to say'.

The total headcount per country is compared to the total headcount of Unilever employees to identify any countries of significant employment (>50 employees that represent more than 10% of headcount).

As at 31 December 2024, Unilever had 120,040 employees by headcount. The tables below show the breakdown of Unilever's employees by geography, gender and employee type.

Employee headcount by geography	2024
Asia Pacific Africa	58,026
The Americas	37,304
Europe	24,710
Total Headcount[(a)]	120,040

(a) Please refer to note 4 of the Financial Statements on page 149 for equivalent headcount data.

Employee headcount by gender and type	Female	Male	Not reported	2024
Permanent	42,513	73,418	33	115,964
Temporary	1,675	2,063	164	3,902
Non-guaranteed hours	125	49	0	174
Total Headcount	**44,313**	**75,530**	**197**	**120,040**

The only country of significant employment (>10%) is India, which has a total of 20,363 employees.

Total employee turnover

Employee start and exit dates are based on employment dates. Temporary employees (those working for a defined period) are excluded as they have come to the end of their contract rather than leaving voluntarily or due to dismissal, retirement, or death in service.

Average headcount is calculated as the sum of weighted monthly headcount from December of the previous reporting period to December of the current reporting period, with the following weighting:
- January to November 2024: Weighting of 1
- December 2023 and December 2024: Weighting of 0.5

Employee turnover rate is calculated as a percentage of the number of Unilever employees who have left in the reporting period over the average headcount.

Employee turnover	2024
Total turnover of employees in year (headcount)	17,334
Rate of employee turnover (%)	14.5%

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Collective bargaining coverage and social dialogue

Unilever does not have any EEA countries that meet the criteria of significant employment. Therefore we do not report (i) collective bargaining by region within the EEA, or (ii) in relation to social dialogue, the percentage of employees covered at the establishment level by workers' representatives by country.

Employees covered by collective bargaining agreements	2024
Total percentage of employees covered by collective bargaining agreements	54.6%

Percentage of Unilever employees covered by collective bargaining agreements by region

Collective bargaining coverage rate	Number of non-EEA countries	Non-EEA countries
0-19%	39	Azerbaijan, Cambodia, China, Costa Rica, Cuba, Djibouti, Dominican Republic, Ecuador, Egypt, El Salvador, Ethiopia, Guatemala, Honduras, Iran, Jordan, Kazakhstan, Republic of Korea, Kuwait, Lao, Lebanon, Malaysia, Myanmar, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Panama, Paraguay, Peru, Puerto Rico, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Serbia, Singapore, Trinidad and Tobago, Uganda, Ukraine, United Arab Emirates, United States of America, Uruguay, Zimbabwe
20-39%	7	Colombia, Ghana, Philippines, South Africa, Tunisia, Turkey, United Kingdom
40-59%	12	Algeria, Australia, Bolivia, Canada, Chile, Côte d'Ivoire, India, Kenya, Mexico, Morocco, Pakistan, Venezuela
60-79%	7	Bangladesh, Israel, Japan, Nepal, Nigeria, Sri Lanka, Switzerland
80-100%	5	Argentina, Brazil, Indonesia, Thailand, Vietnam

Unilever confirms that it has agreements in place with its employees for representation by a European Works Council (EWC).

Diversity metrics

Top management level: Unilever Leadership Executive (ULE) and employees in senior management roles one level below ULE.

Age: age is determined by the employee's date of birth, based on official identification.

The tables below show the gender distribution in terms of number and percentage at the top management level and the diversity of employees by age group.

Gender distribution of top management	Female	Male	Not reported	2024 Total
Top management level headcount[(a)]	35	74	0	109
Percentage	32%	68%	0%	100%

(a) Unilever Leadership Executive (Female: 4, Male: 9) and Senior Management (Female: 31, Male: 65). Refer to Employee Diversity table on page 50.

Diversity of employees by age group	2024	Percentage
<30	21,635	18%
30–50	78,113	65%
>50	19,970	17%
Unknown[(a)]	322	0%
Total Headcount	**120,040**	**100%**

(a) Anyone for whom we do not have an age or date of birth, e.g. for short-term employees.

Adequate wages

Adequate wage is defined as a wage that provides for the satisfaction of the needs of the employee and their family in the light of national economic and social conditions. This is either the applicable legal living or legal minimum wage, the minimum wage set by applicable collective bargaining agreements, or where neither exists, either an appropriate alternative adequate wage benchmark (as set out in AR73) or the voluntary living wage.

For all countries, where not specified, 'wage' refers to the gross wage, excluding variable components such as overtime and incentive pay, and excluding allowances unless they are guaranteed.

For non-EEA countries, we have not considered any official norms in determining the adequate wage level due to the lack of guidance in the ESRS around the correct interpretation of this term. For EEA countries, we have applied the ESRS definitions.

As at 31 December 2024, 100% of Unilever employees were paid an adequate wage.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

Social protection

If one or more Unilever employees in a country are not covered by social protection against loss of income for one or more of the specified major life events, we disclose the countries to which this applies, the types of Unilever employees not covered, and the major life events not covered. Major life events include sickness, unemployment, employment injury and acquired disability, parental leave, and retirement (either by company or public programmes).

As at 31 December 2024, all Unilever employees are covered by social protection against loss of income due to one or more major life events, through public programmes or through benefits offered by Unilever. However, due to different legal systems and employment laws, the employee groups covered by social protection for the different major life events vary across the nearly 100 countries in which Unilever has employees.

The tables below set out, for each type of specified major life event, in which countries employees do not have social protection and, for each of those countries, the types of employees who do not have such protection.

Sickness

Country	Type of employees not covered by protection
None	n/a

Unemployment

Country	Type of employees not covered by protection
Bahrain	All employees
Egypt	Temporary/fixed-term employees
India	Office-based employees and any manufacturing employees not meeting the requirements for protection under the Industrial Disputes Act or a voluntary retirement scheme
Kuwait	All employees
Oman	All employees
Qatar	All employees
Singapore	Temporary/fixed-term employees and employees of Paula's Choice
Tunisia	Temporary/fixed-term employees

Employment injury and acquired disability

Country	Type of employees not covered by protection
None	n/a

Parental leave

Country	Type of employees not covered by protection
United States of America	Employees of Dermalogica USA - employees who have not worked at least 30 hours per week in the year preceding leave. Other employees - Non-birthing parents working less than 20 hours a week and not eligible for parental leave under federal, state or local law.

Retirement

Country	Type of employees not covered by protection
None	n/a

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

Health and safety metrics

Work-related injury is defined as any personal injury or disease resulting from a single instantaneous exposure due to an unexpected or unplanned occurrence, which is found to have occurred in a work environment and to be work-related (either caused or contributed). Based on Unilever's definitions, an incident resulting in injury is often referred to as an 'accident'. Unilever does not refer to incidents resulting in ill health as an 'accident'.

Work-related ill health (as a result of a work-related incident) is defined as a disease, abnormal condition or disorder contracted as a result of an exposure over a period of time to risk factors arising from the work environment and work exposures. Work-related illnesses require exposure over time and cannot be the result of a single exposure.

Fatality is defined as death as a result of work-related injury or work-related ill health, suffered by Unilever's own workforce while they are on duty, both on-site and off-site on Unilever business or other workers (also referred to as value chain workers), while working on Unilever sites.

Days lost is defined as the number of days lost to employee absence related to injuries and fatalities across all Unilever sites, counted on a calendar-day basis, i.e. weekends and public holidays are counted as lost days, and where the first full day and last day of absence are included. Days lost on account of 'work-related ill-health' are excluded from this metric.

Unilever's health and safety management system applies to all of our own workforce. In the first year of reporting, Unilever is applying a partial phase in of these metrics as allowed by the ESRS and is not disclosing the number of cases of recordable work-related ill health.

Fatalities

In 2024, there were no fatalities in Unilever's own workforce as a result of work-related injuries or work-related ill-health, or of other workers while working on Unilever sites. In 2023, there were no fatalities in Unilever's own workforce, however a value chain worker sadly passed away while working at one of our factories. We performed a full investigation and applied the lessons learned to sites worldwide to prevent a similar reoccurrence.

Work-related accidents

Own workforce worker type	2024 Number of work-related accidents	2024 Total Recordable Frequency Rate (TRFR)[a]
Employees	152	0.58
Non-employees	13	0.35
Total	**165**	**0.55**[b]

(a) Rate of recordable work-related accidents per 1 million worked hours.
(b) 2023: 0.58.

Days lost

Worker type	Number of days lost in 2024
Employees	2,946

Remuneration metrics

Gender pay gap

Gross hourly pay per employee is calculated, where applicable, as the sum of gross annual salary and gross annual benefits divided by annual hours (52 * weekly hours). Male and female mean gross hourly pay is calculated as the total gross hourly pay for all male or female Unilever employees divided by the total number of male or female Unilever employees.

	2024
Gender pay gap (%)	**-49%**

This table shows that the average (mean) pay level is 49% higher for female employees than male employees. The scale of the difference between the male and female pay is strongly influenced by the prevalence within the business of male manufacturing workers, who are typically on lower pay grades than many office-based workers, and often in countries where pay levels overall are lower. 63% of our workforce are men, which reflects that men continue to fulfil a high proportion of manufacturing roles within the company. Among our female employees, a higher proportion are in professional roles at higher pay grades, meaning that women earn more on average, than men.

Total remuneration ratio

Unilever considers the ESRS definition of pay to be equivalent to total annual remuneration. The median employee total annual remuneration for all Unilever employees (excluding the highest-paid individual) is identified as the employee with total annual remuneration in the middle of the full list of employees by total annual remuneration.

Non-equity incentive plan compensation and non-qualified deferred compensation earnings are not applicable to Unilever.

	2024
Total remuneration ratio	**225.7:1**

As at 31st December 2024, the highest-paid individual (former CEO Hein Schumacher) was paid more than 225 times the median of all employees. This number is driven by several factors:
1. A high proportion of our employees work in manufacturing roles which are towards the lower end of our pay scale – this reduces the median annual total remuneration of our employees.
2. As we are a global organisation covering nearly 100 countries, with a strong emerging market footprint, we see a wide range in our pay levels across countries. In 2024, our highest-paid individual is based in the UK (a higher-paying country). In comparison, a significant proportion of our other employees are located in countries with lower absolute salaries, such as Argentina, Brazil, China, India, Indonesia and Mexico. Note that salaries in these countries are not necessarily lower relative to the local cost of living.
3. The former CEOs long-term incentive package included shares that had not vested during the reporting period (given he joined Unilever in July 2023). However, as shares do form part of the CEO's long-term incentive package, we expect to see the ratio change next year when the highest paid employee will have shares already vesting.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

Incidents, complaints and severe human rights impacts and incidents

Complaints

Complaints are defined as matters relating to working conditions, equal treatment and opportunities for all, or other work-related rights that are reported, investigated and closed potential breaches to the Code of Business Principles, breaches to the Responsible Partner Policy, or complaints about a Unilever company raised to the National Contact Points (NCP) for OECD Multinational Enterprises. NCP complaints are reviewed to identify whether they pertain to work-related human rights. Substantiation is determined through review by the relevant Unilever Business Integrity Officer and/or Responsible Business Manager and the management of the Third-Party Service Provider, where applicable.

Exclusions: Substantiated incidents of discrimination, including harassment.

	2024
Total number of complaints closed[(a)(b)(c)(d)(e)]	652

(a) The total number of complaints raised in 2024 was 619.
(b) The number of complaints closed in 2023 was 235, and the total number of incidents and complaints closed in 2024 was 417.
(c) The number of substantiated complaints in 2024 was 193.
(d) The number of unsubstantiated complaints, including discrimination and harassment, was 459.
(e) There have been no fines, penalties, or compensation for damages recorded as a result of the complaints disclosed above.

Incidents of discrimination, including harassment

An incident is a legal action or complaint registered with Unilever or competent authorities through a formal process, or an instance of non-compliance identified by Unilever through established procedures. Established procedures to identify instances of non-compliance can include audits, formal monitoring programs, or grievance mechanisms.

Incidents of discrimination, including harassment, are defined by Unilever as matters that are either substantiated (i.e. sufficient evidence to determine an incident has occurred) Discrimination and Harassment Code of Business Principles Cases; or substantiated Discrimination and Harassment Responsible Partner Cases as pertaining to non-employees.

	2024
Incidents of discrimination, including harassment[(a)(b)]	74

(a) As at 31 December 2024, 16 matters were under investigation, which may be determined as incidents of discrimination and harassment.
(b) There have been no fines, penalties, or compensation for damages recorded as a result of the incidents disclosed above.

Severe human rights incidents

Severe human rights incidents are issues, with respect to forced labour, human trafficking or child labour, and the facts of the incident are not disputed by Unilever. A matter will be considered an incident if there is a related legal action, substantiated breach of Unilever's Code of Business Principles, NCP complaints, finding from a third-party audit of a Unilever manufacturing site, or a serious allegation in public reports or the media. In determining these incidents, Unilever considers, in particular, any human rights impacts experienced by rightsholders.

Given the nature of severe human rights incidents, any identified incident is considered to be a case of non-respect of the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights, ILO Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work, or OECD Guidelines for Multinational Enterprises.

	2024
Total number of severe human rights incidents connected to our own workforce[(a)(b)]	0
Those incidents that are cases of non-respect of the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights, ILO Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work, or OECD Guidelines for Multinational Enterprises	0

(a) As at 31 December 2024, three issues were under investigation, which may be determined as severe human rights incidents connected to our own workforce.
(b) There have been no fines, penalties, or compensation for damages recorded as a result.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

Workers in the Value Chain

The focus of this disclosure is the workers of our business partners, i.e. individuals performing work upstream or downstream within Unilever's value chain, regardless of the existence or nature of any contractual relationship with Unilever. This includes all workers within the value chain who may be materially impacted by Unilever or its business partners, and their actions.

Examples of workers in Unilever's value chain are:
- Smallholder farmers who grow the ingredients we use in our products.
- Employees of enterprises in our retail value chain who sell our products.
- Employees of suppliers that provide services such as logistics, marketing and professional services to Unilever.

IMPACT, RISK AND OPPORTUNITY MANAGEMENT

Our material Social impacts, risks and opportunities resulting from the double materiality assessment (DMA) and the process by which these were identified are detailed on page 267.

Policies

The requirements for our business partners are set out in a supplier code of conduct, Unilever's Responsible Partner Policy (RPP). The scope of the RPP is explained in the Environmental policies on page 232, and how the policy addresses our approach to human rights is set out on page 270.

Engaging with value chain workers

We require business partners to declare their compliance with the RPP upon registration and annual re-registration to our systems based on self-assessments, including routine due diligence and risk-based audits. This process helps us identify approved partners for the products and services we procure, while also assessing risks based on the goods or services sourced and the geographies in which our partners operate. Information from the self-assessments helps determine which business partners require external auditing and specific engagement. For high-risk sites, either a site audit or an EcoVadis desktop assessment verifies compliance with the RPP.

We conduct supply chain mapping to identify sourcing areas and suppliers that may increase risk within our supply chain. We use tools to perform risk analysis at both country and commodity levels to better understand potential impacts on value chain workers. This data helps predict where impacts are more likely to occur and determine where additional checks, such as desktop or on-the-ground audits, are required.

Technology is a key enabler for improving visibility of our value chain and identifying potential impacts, particularly for vulnerable groups at higher risk of discrimination, harassment and exploitation, such as women and migrant workers. In July 2023, we began a collaborative project funded by the leading global sustainability platform and standard for sugarcane, Bonsucro. This project aims to utilise apps and learning platforms made available on mobile devices to engage with rightsholders and gather their views.

We also use tools like diginexAPPRISE, which allows workers to anonymously raise concerns, particularly those difficult to identify through traditional audits, such as forced labour and gender-based violence. Quizrr is used to enhance managers' understanding of these issues and the necessary management systems to prevent them. We are developing impact measures to evaluate the effectiveness of these tools in enabling workers to raise concerns and understand their rights.

Processes to remediate impacts and channels to raise concerns

Once an actual impact is identified, we review it to establish the root cause, contributing factors and whether we have caused, contributed to or are linked to the impact. We work to address the impact, verify remediation of the impact and implement processes to prevent reoccurrence, in collaboration with business partners and other stakeholders where appropriate. As part of our remediation approach, we seek to engage with rightsholders to improve our understanding of the impact to them and the remediation that most appropriately meets the needs of the individual/community that is affected.

Where an impact is linked to a business partner, we require them to create a Corrective Action Plan (CAP) to address the issues identified. A follow-up audit, carried out by an independent third-party auditor, is required within 90 days to confirm that the actions taken have been sufficient to remediate the identified issues. In some cases, the nature of the incident means that it is not possible to close within 90 days, for example where capital investment or significant changes in working practices are required. Where this is the case, the supplier is expected to develop an interim plan to reduce the risk until a permanent solution is put in place.

We support business partners in addressing issues and have developed the RPP Implementation Guidance, which includes resources and checklists for preventing and remedying impacts and establishing management systems to prevent recurrence.

Examples of remediation of identified impacts in 2024 include:
- Commissioning an independent consultant to verify repayments made by a supplier to workers to reimburse them for recruitment fees paid.
- Partnering with a human rights consultancy to evaluate the impact that reimbursing recruitment fees has had on workers and their families.
- Continuing to collaborate with the International Cocoa Initiative (ICI) and Afrique Secours et Assistance (ASA) to implement Child Labour Monitoring and Remediation Systems (CLMRS) across our cocoa production supply chain in Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana.

While we have mechanisms in place to enable third parties to raise concerns, grievances are best addressed close to where the impact occurred. Consequently, our approach is to work with our partners to ensure they have effective and trusted grievance mechanisms for their workers. Our Responsible Partner Policy (RPP) requires business partners to have grievance mechanisms aligned with the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights. We monitor workers' awareness and trust in these mechanisms through audit findings.

The RPP also includes leading practice that grievance mechanisms are widely communicated and accessible to enable local communities to report issues. In addition, business partners, their workers, communities, and other stakeholders may report actual or suspected breaches of the RPP (including any failure by a Unilever worker or anyone acting on behalf of Unilever) by phone or online via a third-party hosted system. Reports can be submitted confidentially and anonymously, where permitted by law, and are assessed to determine the appropriate steps.

All investigations of suspected Code breaches are conducted by a Business Integrity Officer. We aim to provide the reporter with an anticipated timescale for completion. An investigation report summarising the evidence, findings, corrective measures and recommended sanctions (where appropriate) is submitted to the Business Integrity Committee for review and conclusion. We have a zero-tolerance policy on retaliation and will not tolerate any form of retaliation against anyone who reports a concern. Unilever's Speak Up processes and remediation mechanisms are detailed further in our Governance section on page 288.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

Managing impacts on value chain workers

Addressing our salient human rights issues

Actions to address our salient human rights issues are detailed in the approach to human rights section on page 270. Additionally, Unilever collaborates with various third parties to deliver training and capability-building programmes aimed at raising awareness of human rights issues and strengthening action to prevent and mitigate potential and actual impacts.

We engage in multiple platforms and forums, such as AIM-Progress, to bring stakeholders together to collectively tackle issues. Through the AIM-Progress membership working groups, we collaborate with peers to address systemic challenges, including living wages, responsible recruitment, effective grievance mechanisms and impact measurement. Other partnerships we are part of include:

- **Bullying and harassment, and health:** In 2020, Unilever and IDH, in partnership with others, launched The Women's Safety Accelerator Fund (WSAF) to create safer workplaces for women working in our tea supply chain in India. We have engaged with nearly 300,000 tea estate workers (both women and men) across more than 300 tea estates in India since the programme launched.
- **Discrimination, fair wages and income:** We continue to be an active member of the Fair Circularity Initiative (FCI), which Unilever co-founded and launched with Coca-Cola, Nestlé, PepsiCo, and the NGO Tearfund in 2022. This commits us to advancing and adopting the 10 Fair Circularity Principles, which focus on placing the views, interests and concerns of rightsholders at the centre of business decision-making and policy development.

Delivering positive impacts across our value chain

To address barriers to decent livelihoods we are collaborating with partners to promote systemic change. Our actions, which are delivering positive impacts to our value chain, include:

- Supporting suppliers in identifying and closing wage gaps.
- Helping smallholder farmers to improve their productivity and farming practices by enrolling them in certification schemes and providing access to income growth and regenerative agriculture programmes.
- Providing small retailers with tools and training to foster their growth. We support small to medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) in our retail value chain by expanding our digital commerce platforms, enabling SMEs to buy directly from us and easily access financial services. We are also continuing to scale our last-mile distribution programmes, enabling us to reach consumers in remote areas. For instance, our Shakti programme supports around 200,000 women sales agents in rural Asia and Africa with access to finance and business training.
- Advocating for higher farmer incomes, private sector initiatives and government policy changes through local and global coalitions to ensure fair wages for all. We are also advocating for change through industry forums like the UN Global Compact and supporting the availability of free, publicly accessible living wage data.

Tracking and monitoring effectiveness

As detailed in 'Monitoring actions relating to Human Rights' on page 271, we are an active member of the AIM-Progress Impact Measurement Working Group, with the goal of aligning on common impact KPIs to simplify reporting and reduce the burden on suppliers for data collection. We will publish data regularly through our human rights reporting to show our performance against these impact measures.

Our approach to identifying, understanding and actioning potential and actual forced labour impacts in our business and value chain is covered in our section on modern slavery on page 271. We also have processes that alert us to potential and actual human rights impacts in our value chain via public reports and media coverage. We identified two instances of child labour, one of which related to a supplier no longer supplying to Unilever. We are also currently investigating three further allegations that relate to severe human rights issues in our value chain within the example categories of forced labour, human trafficking and child labour identified in the ESRS.

In addition, business partners are required to demonstrate compliance with our RPP. Unilever verifies RPP alignment through self-declarations upon registration, annual re-registration to our systems, routine due diligence and risk-based audits of business partner factories, which is carried out by an independent third party. During these audits, cases of non-respect of the UNGPs are identified in line with our RPP Fundamental Principles. We classify the most serious audit non-conformances as 'key incidents', which represent significant contraventions in relation to health and safety, labour rights and business conduct. This definition, which aligns with the Sedex SMETA methodology criticality ratings, includes forced labour, human trafficking and child labour (which are identified as example categories of severe human rights issues in the ESRS) as well as other issues.

Based on our 2023 RPP audit update, which is the latest full-year data available at the time of reporting, the following key incidents were identified:

- 155 health and safety issues representing a threat to life or imminent risk of injury.
- 28 labour rights issues relating to excessive working hours, contravention of minimum wages, indicators of forced labour and indicators of lapses in processes to verify age. This included the 2 instances of child labour mentioned above.
- 9 business conduct issues relating to conducting business with integrity and in accordance with relevant legal requirements.

All key incidents are required to be escalated by the auditors within 24 hours to Unilever. We then require the business partner to provide a Corrective Action Plan (CAP) addressing the issues within seven days. As with all non-conformances, a follow-up audit is required within 90 days to confirm that the actions taken have been sufficient to remediate the identified issues.

In 2025, Unilever will continue to keep under review its processes to identify and track cases of severe human rights in our value chain, as we continue to build our reporting capabilities.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

METRICS AND TARGETS

Targets

Unilever is committed to respecting and promoting human rights across our operations and value chain. However, due to the nature of human rights, we do not define formal targets.

Our ambition is to help the people who grow, make and sell our products have a decent livelihood, including by earning a living wage – so they can afford the essentials of daily life and have work that is secure, dignified and fair.

As part of Unilever's 15 sustainability goals, we have set three short-term targets with the aim of delivering long-term impact to the livelihoods of workers in our value chain;

- We are working with smallholder farmers to improve their livelihoods and agricultural practices. Our goal is to help 250,000 smallholder farmers in our supply chain access livelihoods programmes by 2026.
- We are also encouraging our suppliers to sign our Living Wage Promise, kickstarting the journey to pay their employees a living wage. Our goal is to ensure that suppliers representing 50% of our procurement spend sign the Living Wage Promise by 2026.
- We are helping small businesses in our retail value chain grow. Our goal is to help 2.5 million SMEs in our retail value chain grow their business by 2026.

We have engaged in a number of forums and initiatives that provide insight and expertise from the perspective of people in our value chain to help develop these targets, including extensive engagement with the International Labour Organization (ILO) and the World Business Council for Sustainable Development (WBCSD).

Targets relating to sustainable sourcing and regenerative agricultural practices in our value chain are detailed in our Biodiversity and Ecosystem disclosures on page 256.

Suppliers representing 50% of our procurement spend to sign the Living Wage Promise by 2026
A living wage promise is a commitment made by a supplier to progress towards paying a living wage to workers in their own business operations, either through signing a Living Wage Special Terms Contract (STC) with Unilever or by signing Unilever's Living Wage Promise document. Unilever's definition of a living wage is included on page 268.

Performance is measured as the percentage of total procurement spend from 1 January to 31 December for suppliers that have signed the Living Wage Promise divided by the total procurement spend for the reporting year.

Help 250,000 smallholder farmers in our supply chain access livelihoods programmes by 2026
Unilever defines a smallholder farmer as a person who rears livestock and/or cultivates crops on one or more plots of land that, individually or in aggregate, is the larger of: up to and including 10 hectares (only counting farmed land), in line with the United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization's definition of a smallholder farmer, or the size defined by an official regional and/or sector body. Supply chain refers to a farmer group or individual farmer, within a defined geographical area, providing functionally equivalent feedstocks to those that can be demonstrated to be within Unilever's supply chain.

Eligible livelihoods programmes must include activities and/or inputs designed to deliver improved livelihoods through positive outcomes on Unilever accepted certification and/or incomes, be approved by Unilever authority, within a signed contract between 1 January 2024 and 31 December 2024, and be run directly by Unilever or a third party under a contractual commitment with Unilever.

Performance is measured as the cumulative total number of smallholder farmers in Unilever's supply chain who have received help from Unilever to access livelihoods programmes in the reporting period. Access is defined as either:

- attending face-to-face training;
- receiving intended subsidies, financial services, farm input, labour or technologies; or
- being certified by the livelihoods programme.

Help 2.5 million SMEs in our retail value chain grow their business by 2026
Small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) in our retail value chain include businesses selling Unilever goods to consumers in one of the following countries: Bangladesh, Brazil, Ecuador, India, Indonesia, Pakistan, the Philippines, Thailand, Turkey and Vietnam. These businesses have historically been serviced by a distributor, wholesaler, or cash and carry; or in Mexico, where servicing with Unilever has been enabled by the digital platform.

Performance is measured as the number of SMEs in Unilever's retail value chain that have used a Unilever digital platform (mobile app or website) to purchase at least one product in the reporting period from 1 January to 31 December 2024.

Livelihoods targets	Goal	2024	2023	2022
Suppliers representing 50% of our procurement spend to sign the Living Wage Promise by 2026 (% of procurement spend)	50%	32%	–	–
Help 250,000 smallholder farmers in our supply chain access livelihoods programmes by 2026 (number of smallholder farmers)	0.25m	0.08m	–	–
Help 2.5 million SMEs in our retail value chain grow their business by 2026 (number of SMEs)[(a)]	2.5m	2.58m	1.91m	1.83m

(a) 2023 and 2022 measured for the three-month period October to December.

We are making good progress towards delivering all of our livelihoods targets. We have seen an increase in the number of active SMEs by over 600,000 in 2024, which has resulted from the change in the reporting period, which now means we include seasonal SMEs who were previously not in scope; and principal markets continue to grow organically, enrolling more retailers and improving the functionality of their apps to ensure that more retailers remain active.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

Affected Communities

IMPACT, RISK AND OPPORTUNITY MANAGEMENT

Our material Social impacts, risks and opportunities resulting from the double materiality assessment (DMA) and the process by which we identified these are detailed on page 267.

Policies

Unilever's Code and Code policies sets out our commitment to the communities where we operate, and our local businesses drive our community engagement strategy. Our approach to affected communities is covered through a number of additional policies as follows, the scope and governance of which are outlined on page 232:

- Unilever's People & Nature Policy sets out our commitments to respecting and advancing the human rights of all people in line with the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights. Specifically, it includes the rights of Indigenous peoples and local communities with respect to livelihoods, food security and resources, as well as our commitments that land rights are respected and promoted.
- Unilever's Responsible Partner Policy and its Fundamental Principle set out that the rights and titles to the property and land of individuals and local communities, including Indigenous populations, are respected, and that we have a zero tolerance policy for land grabbing. It also requires suppliers to consider Indigenous people and local communities when conducting impact and risk assessments.
- The Sustainable Agriculture Code and Sustainable Agriculture Principles set out that land tenure rights must be respected, there is a zero tolerance policy for land grabbing, that local communities should be informed of planned activities that affect them, and disturbances to local communities must be minimised.

In addition to our policies, we have published Unilever's Principles in Support of Human Rights Defenders and implementation guidance to our business partners, which outline our commitment to respecting human rights defenders (HRDs). Indigenous people and local communities may act as HRDs and are often vulnerable to human rights violations, including breaches of land rights. These Principles are based on the International Bill of Human Rights and the fundamental rights and principles set out in the ILO's Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work. They are also guided by the UN Declaration on the Right and Responsibility of Individuals, Groups and Organs of Society to Promote and Protect Universally Recognized Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms, the UNGPs, and the UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples.

Further details on our approach to human rights and the associated policies are set out on page 270.

Engaging with affected communities

Land rights

We have a defined process for conducting due diligence on land transactions, which must be followed and documented for each transaction to proceed to completion. This process includes carrying out Environmental and Social Impact Assessments (ESIAs) when additional information is required, conducting consultations that adhere to the principles of Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC), and is supported by internal approval gateways overseen by the Responsible Business team.

Other processes

We have recently developed a rightsholder engagement playbook that establishes clear and consistent processes for engaging with rightsholders, including local communities, regarding opportunities as well as potential and actual human rights impacts. It guides our teams on the importance of engagement, how to identify rightsholders, the steps for effective engagement (including making rightsholders aware of engagement processes), and how to monitor and evaluate the uptake and impact of these engagements. The playbook was trialled in our plastics value chain in 2024, with feedback being sought from the implementing teams on its effectiveness before wider implementation.

Processes to remediate impacts and channels to raise concerns

Affected communities may report concerns to us confidentially and anonymously, where permitted by law, through our Speak Up hotline. This includes potential cases of non-respect of the UNGPs. Unilever will investigate any concerns raised and discuss findings with the relevant business partner, including issues related to land rights. Unilever's Speak Up processes and remediation mechanisms are detailed in our Governance section on page 288, including our zero tolerance policy on retaliation. Within our value chain, issues impacting affected communities may also be identified through business partner factory audits, which are described in more detail on page 280.

At a commodity level, our People and Nature Grievance Mechanism provides a framework for investigating and resolving potential and actual social and environmental impacts, including those raised by rightsholders in the communities where we operate or source from. The process includes acknowledging the grievance and reviewing it to determine if the issue is applicable to our supply chain. If linked to our supply chain, we conduct an in-depth review, working with the supplier and an independent organisation to develop a time-bound action and remediation plan. We expect the supplier to implement actions to resolve the issue and monitor the outcome. If the issue is not connected to our supply chain, the relevant Unilever team will monitor the remediation plan implemented by the relevant parties.

Reported grievances are recorded in our People and Nature Grievance Tracker and details are published on our website. The tracker includes potential cases of non-respect of the UNGPs, categorised under the grievance types 'Land & Community' and 'Labour Rights'. There are 260 sub-cases in our database based on grievances that have been raised to us since 2014, of which 18% relate to Land & Community and 6% to Labour Rights.

Another mechanism through which we may identify potential cases of non-respect of the UNGPs in relation to affected communities is through our anti-corruption and bribery scanning. These mechanisms did not indicate any cases of severe human rights incidents in 2024.

Managing impacts on affected communities

Land rights

We drive actions relating to land rights through our policies and fundamental principles as set out in the RPP and People & Nature Policy. In 2024, we have:

- Co-convened and continued to actively participate in the Social Issues Working Group (SIWG), part of the Palm Oil Collaboration Group, and the subgroup that focuses on supporting and respecting the rights of Indigenous Peoples and Local Communities (IPLC) affected by agricultural production in Indonesia.
- Continued to support smallholder cocoa farmers to formalise the rights to their land through an affordable land tenure documentation process. This work is being carried out by the Côte d'Ivoire Land Partnership (CLAP), which brings together Unilever, other organisations and industry bodies, the Ivorian and German governments, and agri-technology company Meridia.
- Provided training to employees in Indonesia to increase their knowledge and understanding of local land rights issues. This training equipped participants with the tools to support informed decision-making when dealing with issues or complaints related to land rights in our supply chain.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

Other actions

In the context of our impacts related to plastic pollution (see Resource Use and Circular Economy disclosures on page 258), we have conducted baseline human rights risk assessments of our plastics value chain in India, Indonesia, Ghana and Brazil. This included on-the-ground engagement with various stakeholders, including waste picker organisations representing the views of rightsholders. These assessments, along with our existing global programmes, informed the development of our Global Human Rights Framework for Plastics Value Chains.

We collaborated with The Circulate Initiative to support the development of its Harmonized Responsible Sourcing Framework, promoting a collaborative and aligned industry-wide approach that reduces duplication and maximises collective efforts to transform the sector. We also shared key learnings from our work to support the wider peer group during the development of the common industry framework.

Specific actions with regards to our impact on biodiversity, and the downstream impacts on affected communities, are included in our Biodiversity and Ecosystems disclosures on page 255.

Tracking and monitoring effectiveness

We track and monitor the effectiveness of our actions and initiatives for affected communities as detailed in 'Monitoring actions relating to Human Rights' on page 271. The People and Nature Grievance tracker, detailed above also helps us to track grievances and the effectiveness of our responses to them.

METRICS AND TARGETS

Targets

Unilever does not have formal targets related to affected communities defined at a global level because we have in place reporting and grievance mechanisms which allows us to engage with these impacts (potential or actual) on an ongoing basis, as set out above, and in our approach to human rights on page 270.

Specific targets with regards to our impact on biodiversity, and the downstream impacts on affected communities, are included in our Biodiversity and Ecosystems disclosures on page 256.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

Consumers and End-Users

Unilever's success depends on the value and relevance of our brands and products to consumers worldwide. We monitor trends and gather insights from consumers, customers and shoppers to develop our brand strategies and build competitive advantage.

This disclosure includes all Unilever consumers and end-users in our downstream value chain who are likely to be materially impacted by our operations. These include:

- consumers who rely on the quality and safety of our products, including those who may be particularly dependent on accurate and accessible product information, such as those with allergies; and
- children, who are increasingly exposed to online promotional content from a broad range of industries and may be reached by our brand messaging.

IMPACT, RISK AND OPPORTUNITY MANAGEMENT

Our material Social impacts, risks and opportunities resulting from the double materiality assessment (DMA) and the process by which we identified these are detailed on page 267.

Policies

As set out in our general information section, page 229, Unilever's Code and Code Policies apply to all material sustainability matters, including those that impact our consumers and end-users.

Product safety

The Code sets out Unilever's commitment to providing products and services that are safe for their intended use, as well as accurately and properly labelled, advertised and communicated. Product safety begins with responsible innovation, and the Responsible Innovation Code Policy sets out our commitment to conducting responsible, safe and sustainable research and innovation that fully respects the concerns of our consumers and society. Its implementation is supported by eight standards, including one that sets out the approach to Safety Risk Assessments for ensuring Consumer, Occupational and Environmental Safety by Design, and a standard on Use of Ingredients and Control of Contaminants. The Product Safety & Product Quality Code Policy covers our commitment to producing safe, high-quality products and services that meet all applicable standards and regulations. This is supported by our Safe Product Framework, which sets out the processes for identifying and mitigating product safety risks at each stage of our value chain.

As described in the environmental policies section on page 232, our Responsible Partner Policy (RPP) sets out the requirements for suppliers in the value chain. Specifically, within the Business Integrity & Ethics pillar, this includes requirements to meet agreed specifications and notifying Unilever of any product quality or safety concerns originating from the business partner, or its supply chain without delay.

Responsible marketing

The Responsible Marketing Code Policy sets out our commitment to developing, producing, marketing and selling all our products and services responsibly.

In addition, the Principles on Responsible Food & Beverage Marketing to Children apply to Unilever's food and beverage marketing communications globally. Our commitments include not intentionally targeting any paid marketing communications to children under 16 years old (including on social media) and restricting certain ice cream marketing activities to products that meet our Responsibly Made for Kids promise. Our marketing teams are responsible for working with legal, regulatory affairs and external affairs to ensure compliance with these principles. The Presidents of our Foods and Ice Cream Business Groups are responsible for the implementation of these principles, which we make publicly available on our website.

We also recognise Unilever's role in partnering with others to drive a safer consumer experience online. The Responsibility Framework sets out our approach to building a positive digital media ecosystem for our brands and consumers. Compliance with the framework is tracked through a global network of Unilever and agency employees, who work together as our Digital Ecosystem Network (DEN) team. The Chief Growth and Marketing Officer is responsible for implementing this framework.

Human rights

Responsible business is a key part of Unilever's Human Rights Policy Statement, which applies to all our rightsholders. Our commitment to conducting business with integrity while respecting human rights is driven through Unilever's Code and Code Policies, including commitments to our consumers and society, and the RPP, which requires our business partners to identify and manage their own potential human rights impacts.

We consider that, of the salient human rights issues identified on page 267, the issue relevant to our consumers is health, in relation to which, we have explained our approach to product safety below. Our approach to human rights is outlined in more detail on page 270.

Engaging with consumers and end-users

We engage with our consumers and end-users, including those groups considered vulnerable, through a range of communication channels on a continuous basis, reaching over 3 million consumer contacts in 2024 through our various platforms.

We operate consumer care lines around the world for our consumers to share any comments or concerns (including any potential adverse human rights impacts), with details provided on packs and through our websites. We monitor feedback provided by consumers on Unilever's brands and products on social media and through product reviews on digital commerce sites. We also use consumer research from partners such as Kantar, Nielsen and Ipsos, who we engage through their regular surveys and panels. This engagement takes place under the ultimate oversight of our Chief Growth and Marketing Officer. We use these insights to support our aim of providing superior products and delivering great consumer experiences.

In addition, we use a range of mechanisms to monitor and consider evolving societal preferences, including media and social media reviews and NGO engagement. This is overseen by the Global Head of Communications and Corporate Affairs (overseen by the Chief Corporate Affairs and Sustainability Officer from 1 January 2025).

Our approach to identifying and assessing the potential impacts on consumers with allergies is through product safety assessments and product labelling, rather than direct engagement. Similarly, potential impacts in relation to marketing to children are assessed through reviewing their media consumption behaviour.

Processes to remediate impacts and channels to raise concerns

The communication channels referenced above, including our consumer care lines and websites, offer consumers multiple mechanisms through which to raise any concerns. Trained consumer communication agents respond to questions where appropriate, and their use and effectiveness are tracked by monitoring performance against set indicators and through consumer feedback surveys.

Product safety

Concerns raised to Unilever in relation to product safety are shared with relevant internal experts for further investigation. By closely monitoring consumer feedback data, we can detect emerging issues and respond quickly. In the event of a marketplace incident relating to consumer safety or product quality, an incident management team is activated to ensure timely and effective action.

We are committed to continually improving our quality performance; however, sometimes we fall short of our product safety and quality standards. A product might, for example, have a quality defect. Or there may be a contamination of the raw materials, or a mislabelling of ingredients. If this happens, protecting consumers' safety is our number one priority. When necessary, we will issue a public recall of the affected products from the marketplace, even if only small quantities of products are involved.

In the case of a public recall, we use multiple channels to ensure consumers have the required information regarding the product affected (e.g. national press advertising, store communications for retailers, email for direct-to-consumer sales, and relevant websites) and that they can get answers to any questions or concerns via our care lines.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

Responsible marketing

Our marketing teams are responsible for ensuring compliance with our Marketing to Children Principles. Where non-compliance is identified through our processes, our teams work to make the necessary changes, such as changes to artwork, to ensure adherence to the principles. Compliance with our Responsibility Framework is tracked through our DEN team. Where issues are identified, we support our media partners in developing their capabilities and taking the necessary action to enable their adherence.

Code of Business Principles

Anyone may report more serious concerns about potential breaches of Unilever's Code and Code Policies through our Code reporting channels. Our investigation standards require us to record and assess all potential breaches reported. Additional details, including our non-retaliation requirements, can be found in our Governance disclosures on page 288.

Managing impacts and risks related to consumers and end-users

Product safety

Unilever has comprehensive product quality processes and controls in place as part of our Safe Product Framework. The framework is supported by standards, including those covering Safety Risk Assessments and the Use of Ingredients and Control of Contaminants. Safety risk assessments ensure consumer, occupational and environmental safety by design, and require materials used in our product formulations to be registered in Unilever's Safety Systems, supported by defined tools and guidance for assessing consumer safety risks. The use of ingredient standards applies global exclusions or restrictions to certain substances based on safety, regulatory or reputational concerns. These standards are maintained based on external developments and subsequently implemented within our portfolio.

Our Safe Product Framework and the standards which underpin this also encompass product labelling. This includes instructions for use, product composition and additional labelling, such as the presence of allergens. We have labelling approval processes in place to ensure compliance with external regulations and Unilever's policies.

Suppliers of the materials for our products must meet the standards set within Unilever's Supplier Quality Approval process. Our Quality Management System then defines the requirements to be followed for the manufacture of safe products, covering topics such as cleaning and disinfection, hygienic engineering and maintenance, allergen management and foreign matter prevention. Processes and controls are verified annually and regularly monitored through performance indicators that drive improvement activities.

In the event of a non-conforming product reaching the market, we have a global process for identifying and managing marketplace incidents to ensure we act fast, investigate fully and embed learnings to prevent future recurrence. Where necessary, we will issue a public recall of the affected products from the marketplace even if only small quantities of products are involved.

In 2024, we issued five public recalls. One of these related to external manufacturers (cross-packaging), and four related to our own manufacturing facilities (two were caused by foreign matter contamination, one caused by undeclared allergens, and one barcoding-related issue). Wherever and whenever mistakes occur, we take action to identify the root cause and share lessons learned with all relevant parties to prevent a recurrence. For example, during 2024, we established an allergens community where best practices and lessons learned from incidents are shared.

Unilever is defending a portfolio of legal claims alleging asbestos contamination in certain products which Unilever no longer sells. Unilever disputes these allegations, which it does not consider are substantiated.

We monitor the effectiveness of our product safety processes and controls in a number of ways, including leadership scorecards and tracking key metrics such as marketplace incidents/recalls, consumer-safety-related complaints, and the completion of audits and associated actions. We also track the completion of our corrective and preventive actions, for example, those related to marketplace incidents/recalls and consumer-safety-related manufacturing incidents, to ensure that our processes for learning from incidents are effective in preventing future recurrence. The quality and safety of our products are also managed through our enterprise risk process.

We also work to improve consumer safety by engaging beyond our business with the scientific community and regulators. A focus area is the development and application of leading-edge advanced non-animal safety science, where we work closely with authorities around the world, including regulators, government scientists and academic experts. We actively disseminate the research we do to guarantee that our products are safe, without the need for animal testing, to support others in also building new capabilities based on advanced science. In 2024, we engaged in collaborative research with the US National Institute of Environmental Health Sciences (NIEHS) and, as the industry co-chair of the European Partnership for Alternative Approaches to Animal Testing (EPAA), contributed to the European Union transformational programme on non-animal chemical safety assessment regulation. We also continued our collaboration with the US Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), initiated in 2015, on pioneering approaches to chemical safety assessment using advanced science. More information on our approach to eliminating animal testing without compromising on safety is set out within our Governance Disclosures.

Our actions on product safety are supported by the expertise of our Safety, Environmental and Regulatory Science (SERS) Capability group, which is our global centre of excellence in safety and sustainability science, and our Quality expertise teams. Our dedicated team of safety and environmental scientists, including many who are internationally recognised as leaders in their fields, have expertise in allergy, chemistry, exposure science, microbiology, risk assessment, toxicology, process safety, computational modelling and data science, and environmental safety and sustainability science.

Responsible marketing

To aid understanding of our Principles on Responsible Food & Beverage Marketing to Children, Unilever provides training on these Principles to its marketers and the agencies it engages with.

To put the principles of Unilever's Responsibility Framework into practice, we maintain a Brand Safety and Suitability Guide, updated on an ongoing basis and distributed to our media partners. We use this guide to drive a quality digital ecosystem for our brands, ensuring our ads are viewable, by a person, on target, with the right context and brand safety. Unilever has committed to support media partners who respond to our Responsibility Framework with action and intent, including resources, policies, principles and timelines.

METRICS AND TARGETS

Targets

No formal targets have been defined for our consumers and end-users with respect to the impacts, risks and opportunities identified in our sustainability statement. However, we are committed to continually improving our performance against our product safety and quality standards, monitoring the effectiveness of our processes and controls in multiple ways as set out above. As a result of our sustained focus on continuous improvement, we reduced the number of marketplace incidents by more than 10% versus 2023. In relation to responsible marketing, we aim to achieve 100% compliance with our Principles on Responsible Food & Beverage Marketing to Children. Our approach to tracking compliance with our Responsibility Framework is set out above.

SOCIAL DISCLOSURES

ENTITY-SPECIFIC DISCLOSURES

Nutritional product quality

Policies

Continuously improving the nutritional profile of our products and helping consumers adopt better diets without compromising on enjoyment are fundamental to the strategies of our Foods and Ice Cream Business Groups.

Although no formal policy is in place, the implementation of this strategy is guided by Unilever's Nutrition Standards, an internally developed set of standards that drives portfolio improvement based on the latest scientific understanding of the role of nutrition for good health and wellbeing.

- Unilever's Science-based Nutrition Criteria (USNC) are our standards for nutrients to limit, which guide the nutritional quality of our products to healthier options. They consist of product-specific criteria with thresholds for calories, salt, sugar and saturated fat. These threshold values have been modelled against dietary intakes in five countries to quantify their impact and published in a peer-reviewed scientific journal.
- Our Positive Nutrition Standards are our standards for ingredients and nutrients that people are encouraged to consume more of – for example, they consist of product-specific criteria for increasing fruit and vegetables, wholegrains, protein, fibre and micronutrients.

Engaging with consumers and end-users

We engage with consumers about nutritional product quality through the mechanisms already described. In addition, we use international dietary guidelines from groups such as the World Health Organization (WHO) and CODEX, along with scientific modelling, to assess the impact of nutritional product quality on consumers and inform our business strategy.

Managing impacts on consumers and end-users

We work to improve the nutritional quality of products on an ongoing basis, innovating and reformulating our products against the USNC and our Positive Nutrition Standards. For example, in 2024, we launched new flavours for Knorr Sides in the US, as well as reformulating bouillon cubes in Pakistan to deliver iron fortification against the backdrop of heightened levels of iron deficiency anaemia. By investing in improvement and innovation, we aim to make our products nutritionally better while continuing to meet people's expectations for delicious products.

In addition to our own Science-based Nutrition Criteria, we publish a scoring of our portfolio against six externally endorsed Nutrient Profiling Models, contributing to greater transparency in nutrition disclosure.

Benchmarks

Unilever does not have formal targets relating to nutritional product quality. However, we set ourselves benchmarks against which we monitor our strategic progress on nutritional product quality, as set out below.

Unilever's Science-based Nutrition Criteria (USNC) is a set of criteria and threshold values established by Unilever nutrition experts in line with WHO standards. The threshold values determine the amount that can be present in a Foods or Ice Cream product to meet USNC. Products that do not exceed any of the criteria or thresholds are considered to be compliant. Threshold values have been determined for: sodium, saturated fat, sugar and calories.

Unilever's Positive Nutrition Standards is a set of technical criteria and threshold values for selected ingredients, macronutrients and micronutrients, established in line with external global and regional standards, such as those set by the World Health Organization (WHO), which are important for human health. The threshold values determine the amount of ingredients, macronutrients and micronutrients that need to be present in a Foods or Ice Cream product to deliver positive nutrition. A product that contains ingredients, macronutrients or micronutrients meeting at least one of the threshold values is considered to deliver Positive Nutrition. The presence of other ingredients that do not meet the threshold values does not disqualify a product.

The selected ingredients, macronutrients and micronutrients are as follows:

- Ingredients: fruits, vegetables, legumes, pulses, fungi, nuts, seeds, wholegrains, and dairy in products designed for kids.
- Macronutrients: protein, fibre, and omega-3.
- Micronutrients: iron, iodine, zinc, vitamin A, vitamin D, calcium, magnesium, potassium, vitamin B12, folate, vitamin B2, vitamin C and vitamin E.

Servings sold is sales volumes measured in tonnes divided by product serving size. Where no serving size is available, we apply a standard serving size. Actual data is used for January to November, and December data is estimated by extrapolating the average sales of the previous 11 months.

Metrics	Ambition	2024	2023	2022
Percentage of our portfolio meeting Unilever's Science-based Nutrition Criteria, including Pepsi Lipton joint venture (% of servings sold)[(a)(c)]	85% by 2028	84%	81%	–
Number of products sold that deliver positive nutrition, including Pepsi Lipton joint venture (% of servings sold)[(b)(c)]	54% by 2025	52%	52%	48%

(a) The percentage of our portfolio meeting Unilever's Science-based Nutrition Criteria excluding Pepsi Lipton joint venture in 2024 is 84%.
(b) The number of products sold that deliver positive nutrition excluding Pepsi Lipton joint venture in 2024 is 52%.
(c) 2023 and 2022 figures measured for the 12-month period ended 30 September.

Products responding to changing consumer demands

We are continually working to reduce the impact of our products, serving evolving consumer preferences and driving progress against our sustainability goals. As consumer demand evolves, there is a longer-term opportunity to deliver product innovations that serve consumers who want superior products at great value, with a lower environmental impact.

As part of our approach to developing consumer insights and monitoring market trends, we engage with consumers through the mechanisms already described. Responding to emerging consumer demand patterns with superior products is core to our Business Group strategies, supported by our R&D capabilities, rather than guided by policy.

We understand that consumers increasingly want more reassurance about the impact of the products they use, including more recycled and recyclable packaging, trusted ingredients, and product safety that is ensured without animal testing.

In 2024, our Vaseline brand launched a new recyclable pump for Vaseline Intensive Care bottles in North America, while Sunlight dishwash has introduced formulations with naturally derived bio-enzymes and RhamnoClean technology.

The ingredients in our products are included at levels that are safe in use; nevertheless, we also monitor consumer ingredient preferences, regulatory hazard classification changes, and emerging scientific data to update our safety and sustainability assessments where relevant. Our long-term investment in non-animal safety science has enabled some of our biggest brands to be certified by People for the Ethical Treatment of Animals (PETA) as 'PETA-approved', including Dove, Axe, TRESemmé and Sunsilk. We have over 15 brands that comply with the criteria set out in PETA's Global Beauty Without Bunnies Programme.

Delivering against our ambitious sustainability goals requires innovation; however, we do not have targets in place in relation to the innovation of products to meet changing demands regarding reduced environmental impact. Our ongoing progress is measured through the implementation and monitoring of our strategic plans.

Governance Disclosures

Business Conduct

GOVERNANCE

The role of administrative, management and supervisory bodies

The ultimate responsibility for Unilever's conduct is with Unilever's Board who are responsible for both setting and monitoring the culture of the business. The Board is supported in this by the Corporate Responsibility and Audit subcommittees. Please refer to the general information section on page 224 and the Corporate Governance Report on pages 70 to 84 for the composition and expertise of the Board and its subcommittees.

The Chief Executive Officer is accountable to the Board for the implementation of Unilever's culture and standards of conduct, which we refer to as 'business integrity', and is supported in this by the Chief Legal Officer, Chief Business Integrity Officer, Global Code and Policy Committee, and Business Integrity Committees. The key elements of Unilever's standards of conduct are set out in Unilever's Code and Code policies, which provide a set of mandatory rules that govern how we run our business.

Responsibility for the day-to-day implementation of the Code and Code Policies is delegated to the Unilever Leadership Executive and all senior management leading Unilever's Business Groups, business units and functions. They are supported in this by cross-functional Business Integrity Committees.

IMPACT, RISK AND OPPORTUNITY MANAGEMENT

Description of the processes to identify and assess material impacts, risks and opportunities

The process for assessing and identifying our material impacts, risks and opportunities is informed by our double materiality assessment (DMA), as set out in our general information on page 226. Risks identified are reviewed and assessed on an ongoing basis and formally at least once per year. For each of our principal risks, including Ethical and Legal & Regulatory risks, we reviewed the risk management frameworks detailing risk descriptions and mitigating controls in place. These frameworks are updated annually and monitored throughout the year to identify changes in the risk profile.

From a governance perspective, this process incorporates several inputs, such as a global fraud risk assessment conducted at both a functional and market level to identify risks, including corruption and bribery risks. In addition, a geopolitical working group has been established with representatives from different functions to proactively identify and escalate issues for high-risk markets, and external screening is undertaken to monitor changes to the risk landscape.

The output of our 2024 DMA for our Governance impacts, risks and opportunities is included below:

Material impact, risk or opportunity		Description
Business integrity and ethical conduct	Risk (OO) (VC)	Failure to act in an ethical manner and foster a culture where our employees and value chain feel empowered to speak up, consistent with the expectations of customers, consumers and other stakeholders, may result in reputational damage.
Anti-bribery and corruption	Risk (OO) (VC)	There is a risk that a breach of anti-bribery and corruption laws or failure to prevent bribery, fraud or tax evasion may result in legal and financial consequences for Unilever and individuals.
Use of non-animal safety science	Positive Impact (VC)	Unilever is a global leader advocating for regulatory use of modern non-animal safety science in place of animal testing, working with government groups and other stakeholders.
Changing regulatory landscape	Risk (OO) (VC)	Changes to laws and regulations relating to sustainability matters can have a significant positive or negative impact on our business. For example, they may reduce the cost of a process or ensure that all players in a market face a cost so an activity we undertake is not uncompetitive. On the other hand, they may prevent Unilever from doing something that it wants to do or increase compliance costs. Failure to comply could also lead to increased claims against Unilever and potentially incur penalties, legal costs or harm revenue due to reputational damage.
Advocacy	Positive Impact (OO) (VC)	Unilever is actively lobbying governments, regulators and other third parties to influence policies and regulations that will help to drive change in four key areas: climate, nature, plastics and livelihoods.
Supplier payments and relationships	Risk (OO)	Inappropriate or untimely processing of payments may result in incorrect payments to suppliers, fraudulent transactions, late payments, regulatory penalties or disputes.

OO Own Operations, VC Value Chain

Business conduct policies and corporate culture

As a purpose-led company, our values and culture are the foundation of our success. Our approach to business integrity is designed to ensure that how we do business is fully aligned with our values and the applicable laws and regulations in countries where we operate.

Our business integrity framework is comprised of three pillars:
- Prevention – we seek to embed a culture of integrity at all levels.
- Detection – we encourage employees to speak up, and identify potential issues through auditing and monitoring processes.
- Response – we have the tools to investigate and, if necessary, sanction confirmed breaches, and use what we learn to continually improve our processes to increase the level of prevention.

This approach is underpinned by Unilever's Code of Business Principles, with each principle supported by a Code Policy setting out what employees must and must not do to ensure they are living the code.

We also set out what Unilever requires of business partners in our Responsible Partner Policy (RPP), so that we can do business together responsibly. Further detail on the RPP is set out in our Environmental policies section on page 232.

Corporate culture

Our Code sets out clear requirements for the standards of conduct we expect from our employees.

Everyone at Unilever is expected to be an ambassador for the high standards set out in the Code, with the tone set from the top. Our CEO communicates regularly with senior leaders and all employees on business integrity, making clear that adherence to the Code and Code Policies is non-negotiable. On an annual basis, multiple initiatives aim to embed this culture across our business, ranging from mandatory training and a global pledge – where our employees actively pledge to uphold these values – to employee town hall and leadership awareness sessions.

We aim to continuously improve and further embed a culture of business integrity. We analyse the results of investigations, market assessments and audit findings to identify trends and opportunities for improvement. Lessons learned are then shared extensively across the business integrity community, Unilever's leadership, and with employees.

GOVERNANCE DISCLOSURES

Employee surveys are also used as a tool to monitor this culture. Business integrity questions are included within Unilever's annual global UniVoice survey, and in more regular UniPulse surveys administered to smaller randomised groups of employees. Responses are reviewed by our Global Code and Policy Committee and at Business Integrity Committee meetings. These responses provide further insight into how strongly business integrity is embedded into the business, driving future engagement and action plans.

Business conduct policies

Our Code and Code Policies define the ethical behaviours that everyone must demonstrate when working for Unilever. They help us to address key potential external and internal risks to the business such as fraudulent behaviour or a failure to respect, uphold and advance human rights, as well as playing a key role in ensuring compliance with laws and regulations. As a result, they help us to protect our brands and reputation, and to prevent harm to people or the environment.

The Code and Code Policies are available in multiple languages and designed to be readily applied by employees in their day-to-day work. They are mandatory for all employees and others working for Unilever, and apply to all Unilever companies, subsidiaries and organisations over which Unilever has management control. While our Code and Code Policies are for internal use, we also publish them externally in support of transparency.

We undertake a comprehensive review of our Code and Code Policies every five years when the Code is reviewed and approved by the Unilever Board. Potential changes needed to the Code and Code Policies are monitored on an ongoing basis to ensure they appropriately reflect the internal and external context, in addition to incorporating the latest legal requirements, and the Board is informed of any amendments. As an input to this process, the Board's Corporate Responsibility Committee meets quarterly and reviews external developments that may be relevant to Unilever's ability to conduct its business appropriately as a responsible corporate citizen.

We also seek to work with suppliers, customers, agents, distributors and other partners who uphold these standards throughout our value chain. Our Responsible Partner Policy outlines our requirements for business partners.

Business conduct training

Everyone who works at Unilever is required to know our Code and Code Policies and understand how to apply them in their work. We design and conduct annual mandatory training for all office-based employees and have tailored training for those employees working in factories and more remote areas. Completion of training is tracked, and we follow up with employees who fail to complete mandatory training and take further action where required.

Corruption and bribery are risks that may affect any employee, and therefore our mandatory training, deployed for all employees, includes a focus on anti-corruption, in particular related to learnings from investigations, risk assessments and business partnering.

Identifying and reporting breaches, including whistleblower protection

Unilever's Code Policies specifically include the requirement to immediately report actual or potential breaches of the Code or Code Policies. Key to identifying and reporting breaches is training, to ensure familiarity with the Code, and the provision of appropriate infrastructure to facilitate reporting. We make a variety of internal and external reporting platforms available to all employees and those we partner with.

To report a concern, employees can contact a number of internal channels. Alternatively, employees and third parties can use our independently managed, confidential Unilever Code Support Line (whistleblowing line) via telephone or our online Speak Up platform, which is available directly via a web address.

The available reporting channels are set out within our Code Policies and highlighted during Business Integrity training and in our communications. The Speak Up platform web address is signposted on Unilever's website and our internal portals, and hotline numbers are displayed in various locations, such as factory walls, building access cards and payslips.

In 2024, 43% of cases were reported directly to Business Integrity Officers, which reassures us that we continue to embed a strong process with trust in our Business Integrity Officers. In addition, we highlight to employees that if they prefer not to use the direct or anonymised channels provided by Unilever, they can utilise other external reporting channels and report directly to the authorities.

We are committed to a culture of transparency and have a prohibition on retaliation in any format against those who report or seek guidance on ethical or compliance issues or report cases under our Code, compliant with the EU Whistleblower Directive.

Our Code and Code Policies set out that Unilever will not retaliate against employees who raise issues with us and that any attempted or actual retaliatory action by employees is in itself considered to be a breach of our Code. This approach to non-retaliation is emphasised in global employee training and local town halls. Additional non-retaliation guidance for employees is also published on both internal and external platforms.

After any Code concern is reported, reporters are reminded of what retaliation could look like and asked if they think they have experienced this. All Business Integrity Committees are also accountable for ensuring that individuals who report Code breaches or assist with investigations are properly protected from retaliation and that confidentiality is maintained.

Investigating potential breaches

Our investigation standards require us to record and assess all Code concerns reported, however they are raised. Once a report is received, it is formally acknowledged and directed to a Business Integrity Officer to determine whether a Business Integrity investigation is required.

Investigations are led by the responsible Business Integrity Officers, who ensure fair, unbiased and independent investigations are undertaken. All Business Integrity Officers are trained on Unilever's standards and processes and are required to uphold these at all times. Business Integrity has officers posted around the world to respond to cases, with oversight from a central Business Integrity team.

Investigation reports link the allegation made to the specific requirements under the Code, summarising the evidence, findings in respect of any breach, corrective measures, and recommended sanctions. Completed investigation reports and associated evidence are submitted to Business Integrity Committees for approval. In cases involving public bribery or senior executives, our Chief Legal Officer and Chief Business Integrity Officer oversee investigations and an ad hoc Business Integrity Committee determines any sanctions, regardless of where such executives are located.

We encourage engagement from the initial reporter to facilitate the investigation while maintaining any confidentiality. Where appropriate and possible, we aim to provide transparency with regard to the investigation's progress and anticipated completion. It is the responsibility of the Business Integrity Committees to ensure the timely investigation of all potential Code breaches raised by an individual employee, with a view to reaching a final determination within 60 days, depending on the nature and complexity of the concern raised.

Breaches of the Code or Code Policies are shared with various oversight committees, including the Unilever Board's Corporate Responsibility and Audit Committees, the Unilever Leadership Executive, and the Global Code and Policy Committee.

Animal welfare policies

Unilever uses leading-edge safety science, not animals, to evaluate the safety of our products. We believe that animal testing is not needed to make sure that our products and their ingredients are safe for consumers, our workers and the environment. For over 40 years, we have been working to eliminate animal testing without compromising on safety. This is set out in our public position statement on animal testing, owned by the Chief Research & Development Officer on behalf of the Unilever Leadership Executive.

Unilever's mandatory standard on animal testing sets out the strict internal approval and control procedures in place to ensure our position is upheld. This standard is one of several that underpins Unilever's Responsible Innovation Code Policy, which requires that all employees involved in scientific research and innovation must comply with all standards relevant to their area of work.

To ensure the safety of our products, we develop and advance the use of safety assessment approaches based on modern science that do not rely on new animal data. Occasionally, across our wider product portfolio, some of the ingredients we use have to be tested by our suppliers to comply with legal and regulatory requirements in some markets, and some governments still test certain products on animals as part of their regulations. We do not agree that this animal testing is necessary to assure the safety of our products or the ingredients in them. We work with our suppliers, government authorities and non-governmental organisations (NGOs) across the world to increase the acceptance and use of non-animal approaches for regulatory compliance purposes.

Our Responsible Partner Policy, which sets out what Unilever requires of our business partners, contains mandatory requirements in relation to animal testing, as well as outlining leading practices for suppliers to work towards. In support of this, we partner with our ingredient suppliers to proactively share our non-animal safety science and non-animal approaches for chemicals registration.

GOVERNANCE DISCLOSURES

We share our scientific approaches with regulatory authorities and NGOs around the world to promote their broader acceptance and maximise the impact of our science in replacing animal testing. People for the Ethical Treatment of Animals (PETA) lists Unilever as a 'company working for regulatory change' in recognition of our ongoing work on alternatives to animal testing and our commitment to promoting their adoption worldwide.

Farm animal welfare forms part of Unilever's Sustainable Agriculture Code (SAC), which is designed to codify key aspects of sustainability in farming and apply them to our supply chain. The Chief Business Operations Officer is responsible for the implementation of the SAC, and it is applicable to all agricultural suppliers. The SAC is supported by specific additional guidance, such as the Unilever Sustainable Livestock Implementation Guide, and its implementation by suppliers is audited by a third party.

Farm animal welfare also forms part of our Responsible Partner Policy (RPP), which helps us to manage our relationship with suppliers. Unilever's Responsible Sourcing and Business Partnering Code Policy underpins this approach, setting out the responsibilities of employees to ensure that third parties are subject to our RPP policies and controls.

Management of relationships with suppliers

Procurement processes, including fair behaviour with suppliers

Our Code and Code Policies govern what we require of our employees in terms of fair behaviour in relation to Unilever's suppliers and procurement processes. The Code Policies include specific requirements in relation to areas such as anti-bribery, communication with suppliers, fair competition, conflicts of interest and treatment of suppliers' information, as well as the obligation to source only from suppliers that are compliant with our RPP.

Responsible partnerships

Our RPP, sponsored by our Chief Procurement Officer, helps us to manage our relationship with suppliers. The RPP describes what Unilever requires of its business partners across the three interconnected pillars of business integrity & ethics, human rights, and the planet. It consists of mandatory requirements and management systems for all suppliers and gives advance notice of future mandatory requirements designed to build greater resilience as well as leading practices. This approach recognises the evolving nature of our third parties and value chains, while driving business growth and improved outcomes for people and planet.

The scope of our RPP goes beyond our direct supplier universe, which directly invoice Unilever for goods and services, by including our expectation for suppliers to cascade equivalent requirements within their own supply chains by carrying out human rights and environmental due diligence.

All our suppliers undergo continuous assessment against our RPP requirements and general terms and conditions. If an existing supplier fails to remain compliant with our requirements, Unilever may restrict the ability to raise new purchase orders for business until they can once again meet all our requirements. If a new supplier cannot meet our terms, we will not onboard them into our systems and will not be able to do business with them.

We verify RPP alignment through self-declarations on registration, annual re-registration to our systems, routine due diligence and risk-based audits. We take a continuous improvement approach to our risk assessment and undertake regular risk-mapping so we can accurately identify where specific risks occur across geographies and within different supplier types. This leads to more targeted due diligence and auditing based on the goods and services we source and the country where the sourcing site is located and ensures we know where to act to drive change if issues arise.

We encourage suppliers to contact the Unilever team if they face challenges in meeting our requirements through implementing their own approaches, so that we can endeavour to provide support and guidance. We also encourage suppliers to share any insights that will help us improve our programmes, and how we govern and monitor our value chain, embracing partnership in areas where we can collaborate in a pre-competitive environment to address endemic issues in our industries.

Prevention of late payments, specifically to SMEs

Payment terms are contractually agreed between Unilever and each supplier, including SME suppliers. Further detail on payments to SMEs is set out within the section on payment practices below.

Prevention and detection of corruption and bribery

Anti-corruption and anti-bribery policies

Our Code and Code Policies set out Unilever's zero-tolerance approach towards corruption and bribery. These prohibit both public and commercial bribery, to or from any third party, and irrespective of financial values involved and also explicitly prohibit facilitation payments.

Detailed written anti-corruption guidance and standards are also in place that expand on our Code and Code Policies in relevant areas, including interactions with public officials, brand protection, corporate transactions (M&A), customer incentives, gifts and hospitality, grants and donations, and conflicts of interest.

As previously set out, our anti-corruption and bribery policies are communicated and designed to be readily applied by employees. The Code and Code Policies are available in multiple languages, and lessons are included in the annual mandatory training.

Our partners must adhere to Unilever's anti-corruption and bribery policies, as defined in the RPP.

Preventing, detecting and addressing allegations or incidents of corruption and bribery

The core processes to prevent, detect and address allegations or incidents of corruption and bribery are the same as the processes in place for Unilever's overall Code and Code Policies. All potential cases of corruption and bribery related to public officials are reported to our Chief Legal Officer and Chief Business Integrity Officer, who oversee investigations, and the Global Code and Policy Committee determines any sanctions.

As previously set out, breaches, lessons learned, and remedial actions related to the Code or Code Policies are shared with various oversight committees, including the Unilever Board's Corporate Responsibility and Audit Committees, the Unilever Leadership Executive, and the Global Code and Policy Committee.

In order to prevent incidents from taking place, we conduct periodic bespoke anti-corruption and anti-bribery risk assessment exercises to determine the business activities and geographies that require specific actions to enhance our controls and respond to changes in our risk exposure. A range of tailor-made measures are continuously introduced to mitigate these risks, along with additional bespoke training.

Anti-corruption and anti-bribery training

As part of our annual mandatory Business Integrity learning programme, anti-corruption and anti-bribery training is deployed to all employees. Unilever Board members also receive specific training on this subject.

The training content is based on our learnings from investigations, risk assessments and business partnering. Additional bespoke training is offered for employees who may face a greater risk in their activities in respect of corruption or bribery, such as those in external-facing commercial roles.

The anti-corruption and anti-bribery training programme is sponsored by the Chief Legal Officer and Chief Business Integrity Officer and led by the Chief Counsel – Ethics & Compliance. It is overseen by the Unilever Board's Corporate Responsibility Committee.

GOVERNANCE DISCLOSURES

METRICS AND TARGETS

Incidents of corruption or bribery

There have been no incidents of corruption or bribery resulting in convictions or fines for Unilever Group companies due to violation of applicable anti-corruption and anti-bribery laws in 2024.

In addition, there have been no deferred prosecution agreements or other significant enforcement activity involving Unilever Group companies in 2024 that required us to take actions to address breaches in procedures and standards of anti-corruption and anti-bribery.

Political influence and lobbying activities

Unilever engages with governments, policymakers, regulators, non-governmental organisations and other stakeholders involved in policy and government through our advocacy and lobbying activities. This engagement forms a key part of promoting and protecting Unilever's legitimate business interests, and takes place directly and indirectly through bodies such as trade associations and industry groups.

Our Code and Code Policies set out how employees must manage their business relationship with political groups. Such activity must be conducted with honesty, integrity, openness and in compliance with local and international laws.

Oversight of political engagement

In 2024, Unilever's Global Head of Communications and Corporate Affairs oversaw national government engagement and lobbying activity. Unilever's Chief Corporate Affairs and Sustainability Officer (CSO) oversaw engagement with intergovernmental organisations and non-governmental organisations. Both roles report directly to the Chief Executive Officer (CEO).

At Board level, two Non-Executive Directors hold, or have held, comparable positions in public administration:

- Susan Kilsby is on the UK Takeover Panel and was a non-executive director at NHS England between 2021–2023.
- Adrian Hennah was appointed as an independent member to the Council of Imperial College London in 2024.

Neither the CEO nor any other member of the Board not listed above has held similar roles in public administration within the two years preceding this reporting period.

Political contributions

Unilever companies are prohibited from supporting or contributing to political parties or candidates. All Unilever Executive and Non-Executive Directors have confirmed that they have not made any political contributions on behalf of Unilever in 2024 and we do not have any reported cases of breaches with the Political Activities & Political Donations Code Policy.

Main topics covered by Unilever's political engagement

The scale of Unilever's business operations and the fact that many areas of the consumer goods industry are regulated means we engage regularly with governments and policymakers. We do this both independently and as part of industry groups and coalitions. The main topics covered by these engagements during 2024 are set out below.

Topic	Main positions on this topic	Linkages with material impacts, risks and opportunities
Nutrition, diet and health	Unilever works with governments to create policy environments that help consumers make healthier diet choices. Unilever supports policies that restrict the marketing of food and beverages to children under 16, aligning with our global commitment.	▪ Nutritional product quality ▪ Safe products ▪ Business integrity and ethical conduct ▪ Changing regulatory landscape
Plastic pollution	Unilever supports public policy that aligns with our approach to reducing packaging waste and creating a circular economy. This includes Extended Producer Responsibility schemes, whereby producers are held accountable for the management of their packaging after it has been used. Unilever also supports the introduction of packaging design rules and recycled content targets that will help increase recycling rates. Both these policies are dependent on governments working with industry to increase the availability of high-quality recycled plastic. We also work with governments to identify the enabling conditions to help scale reuse and refill models. Unilever is advocating for a legally binding UN Treaty to end plastic pollution, which will help harmonise regulatory standards and policies across markets through global rules and mandatory targets.	▪ Plastic pollution ▪ Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) schemes for packaging and other plastic taxes ▪ Changing regulatory landscape
Climate	Unilever advocates for changes to public policy frameworks consistent with the 1.5°C ambition of the Paris Agreement. Unilever's main positions are that governments should raise national climate ambition, scale up renewable energy and non-fossil chemical feedstocks, and phase out fossil fuels, including fossil fuel subsidies. Furthermore, Unilever works with governments to accelerate enabling conditions, including encouraging the protection and restoration of land, forests and oceans, and putting forward policies that incentivise regenerative agriculture. Unilever advocates for the adoption of ISSB sustainability reporting standards as the global baseline for non-financial reporting.	▪ All climate change material impacts, risks and opportunities identified ▪ Changing regulatory landscape
Safety regulation	Chemical and product regulations are being revised to incorporate modern safety science and data. Unilever provides input to consultations on regulatory changes, sharing new scientific approaches and how we apply them to safety decision-making. We aim to have less complex regulations that promote 'safe by design' innovation and the highest standards of human health and environmental protection.	▪ Changing regulatory landscape ▪ Safe products
Business operations and trade issues	Unilever works with governments, policymakers, regulators and other stakeholders to ensure our supply chains operate efficiently and to protect our business interests and workforce, such as trade restrictions that impact our supply chain. Changes to laws and regulations can have a positive or negative impact on our business and how we operate.	▪ Changing regulatory landscape